GRAMMAR · VOCABULARY · USAGE

English for Competitive Exams

BCS · Bank Jobs · University Admission
with SAT, GRE & GMAT concepts

Part A — Grammar (Chapters 01–44)
Part B — Vocabulary & Usage (Chapters 45–53)
Part C — Miscellaneous (Chapter 54)

How to read the boxes: **Rule** boxes state a rule; **Exam Tip** boxes show traps set in BCS, Bank and admission papers; **Note** boxes give exceptions; **SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner** boxes connect the topic to international tests. In examples, ✘ marks an incorrect sentence and ✔ its correct form. In the word lists, ★ marks very frequent exam words and Bangla meanings are given in brackets.

Contents

Part A · Grammar

01 Parts of Speech & Its Identification 4

23 Subject-Verb Agreement 10

Part B · Vocabulary & Usage

45 Vocabulary with Synonyms & Antonyms 23

PART A

Grammar

Chapters 01 – 44

Parts of speech, sentence structure, tenses, agreement, voice, narration, transformation, error detection and punctuation — every rule with exam examples.

CHAPTER 01

Parts of Speech & Its Identification

Part A · Grammar

1.1 What Is a Part of Speech?

Every word in an English sentence does a particular **job**. Some words name things, some show action, some describe, some join, and some show relationships. The **job** a word does in a sentence is called its **part of speech**. Traditional grammar — the grammar followed in BCS, Bank and university admission question papers — divides English words into **eight parts of speech**:

No.	Part of Speech	Its Job	Examples
1	Noun	names a person, place, thing, idea	Rahim, Dhaka, book, honesty
2	Pronoun	stands in place of a noun	he, she, it, they, who, this
3	Adjective	describes / qualifies a noun or pronoun	good, tall, five, every, this
4	Verb	shows action, being or possession	run, write, is, have, seem
5	Adverb	modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb	quickly, very, often, here
6	Preposition	shows relation of a noun/pronoun to another word	in, on, at, by, with, from
7	Conjunction	joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, or, because, though
8	Interjection	expresses sudden feeling	Alas! Hurrah! Oh! Bravo!

Modern grammars (and the SAT, GRE and GMAT) also treat **determiners** (*a, an, the, this, my, some, every*) as a separate class. Traditional grammar calls them *adjectives* (articles are called "demonstrative adjectives" or simply "articles"). In Bangladeshi exams, if an option list has no "determiner", choose **adjective** for words such as *this, every, some, my* when they come before a noun.

> **The Golden Rule of Identification:** A word has **no fixed part of speech**. What a word *is* depends on what it *does* in that particular sentence. *"We cannot tell what part of speech a word is until we see it in a sentence."* — this principle (stated by J. C. Nesfield and repeated in every standard grammar) is the key to the whole chapter.

- I bought a **round** table. (adjective — describes *table*)
- The boxer won the first **round**. (noun — names a thing)
- The ship will **round** the cape tomorrow. (verb — action)
- The earth moves **round** the sun. (preposition — relates *earth* and *sun*)
- The wheel turned **round**. (adverb — modifies *turned*)

1.1.1 Content Words and Function Words

It helps to divide the eight classes into two big groups:

- **Content words (open classes):** nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs. They carry the main meaning; new ones are created all the time (*selfie, google, unfriend*).
- **Function words (closed classes):** pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, determiners and auxiliary verbs. They build grammar; the list is almost fixed, and they are tested heavily in error-detection questions.

1.2 The Eight Parts of Speech in Detail

1.2.1 Noun

A **noun** is a word used as the **name** of a person, place, thing, animal, quality, action or idea.

- **Person:** Nazrul, teacher, farmer, girl
- **Place:** Sylhet, village, market, Asia
- **Thing:** pen, river, computer, rice
- **Animal:** tiger, cow, hilsa
- **Quality / Idea:** honesty, beauty, freedom, wisdom
- **Action / State:** arrival, laughter, sleep, childhood

A noun can work as the **subject** (*The **boy** runs*), the **object** of a verb (*I saw the **boy***), the **object of a preposition** (*Give it to the **boy***), the **complement** (*He is a **doctor***) or an **apposition** (*Rahim, the **captain**, scored*). Full details are in Chapter 02.

1.2.2 Pronoun

A **pronoun** is a word used **instead of a noun** to avoid repetition.

- Rina is a student. **She** reads in class ten. (*She* = Rina)
- The book is old, but **it** is useful.
- **Who** broke the glass? (interrogative pronoun)
- This is the man **who** helped me. (relative pronoun)
- **This** is my pen. (demonstrative pronoun — stands alone)

> **Pronoun or adjective?** *This, that, these, those, each, either, neither, some, any, many, few, all, both, one, what, which* are **pronouns** when they stand **alone** and **adjectives (determiners)** when they come **before a noun**. *This is good* (pronoun) / *This book is good* (adjective). *Each got a prize* (pronoun) / *Each boy got a prize* (adjective).

1.2.3 Adjective

An **adjective qualifies** (adds to the meaning of) a noun or pronoun. It answers *What kind? Which one? How many? How much?*

- She is a **clever** girl. (what kind — before the noun: *attributive* use)
- The girl is **clever**. (after a linking verb: *predicative* use)
- I have **three** pens. (how many)

- He has **little** money. (how much)
- **That** house is ours. (which one)

1.2.4 Verb

A **verb** says something about the subject: it shows **action** (*run, eat*), **state of being** (*be, seem, become*) or **possession** (*have, own*). Without a verb there is no sentence.

- The baby **cries**.
- He **is** honest.
- They **have** a car.
- She **seems** tired.
- The meeting **will be held** tomorrow. (verb phrase: auxiliaries + main verb)

1.2.5 Adverb

An **adverb** modifies (adds to the meaning of) a **verb**, an **adjective**, another **adverb**, a **preposition**, a **conjunction** or a **whole sentence**. It answers *How? When? Where? How often? How much?*

- He runs **fast**. (modifies the verb *runs*)
- She is **very** beautiful. (modifies the adjective *beautiful*)
- He ran **very** fast. (modifies the adverb *fast*)
- The bird flew **just** over the house. (modifies the preposition *over*)
- He came **only** because he was invited. (modifies the conjunction *because*)
- **Fortunately**, nobody was hurt. (modifies the whole sentence — sentence adverb)

1.2.6 Preposition

A **preposition** is placed **before** a noun or pronoun to show its relation to some other word in the sentence (place, time, direction, cause, manner etc.). The noun or pronoun after it is called its **object**.

- The cat is **under** the table.
- He was born **in** 1990.
- She went **to** school **by** bus.
- I am fond **of** music.
- He sat **between** you and me. (✘ between you and I — the object of a preposition must be in the objective case)

1.2.7 Conjunction

A **conjunction joins** words, phrases, clauses or sentences.

- Rahim **and** Karim are friends. (joins words)
- He is poor **but** honest.
- I stayed at home **because** it was raining. (joins clauses)
- **Though** he is rich, he is not happy.
- **Either** you **or** he is guilty. (correlative conjunction)

1.2.8 Interjection

An **interjection** is a word that expresses a **sudden feeling or emotion**. It has no grammatical connection with the rest of the sentence and is usually followed by an exclamation mark.

- **Alas!** He is dead. (grief)
- **Hurrah!** We have won. (joy)
- **Bravo!** Well done. (approval)
- **Oh!** I forgot my keys. (surprise)
- **Hush!** The baby is sleeping. (call for silence)

1.3 How to Identify Parts of Speech: Four Reliable Tests

Exam questions usually underline a word and ask *"What part of speech is the underlined word?"* Use these four tests one after another.

1.3.1 Test 1 — The Function Test (Most Important)

Ask what the word is **doing**:

1. Is it **naming** something? → Noun.
2. Is it standing **in place of** a noun? → Pronoun.
3. Is it **describing / limiting** a noun? → Adjective.
4. Is it saying what the subject **does or is**? → Verb.
5. Is it telling **how / when / where / how much** about a verb, adjective or adverb? → Adverb.
6. Does it have a **noun/pronoun object after it** and show a relation? → Preposition.
7. Does it **join** two clauses or words? → Conjunction.
8. Is it a **cry** of feeling? → Interjection.

1.3.2 Test 2 — The Position (Slot) Test

English has a fairly fixed word order, so the **position** of a word gives a strong clue.

Slot (frame sentence)	Part of speech that fits	Example
The ___ is/was good.	Noun	The **book** is good.
a/the very ___ person	Adjective	a very **kind** person
He/They will ___ (it).	Verb	They will **win**.
He did it ___.	Adverb	He did it **carefully**.
___ the table (shows place)	Preposition	**under** the table

Clue words: a word right after *a, an, the, my, his, this, some* is usually a **noun** or an **adjective + noun**. A word right after *to* (infinitive) or after a modal (*can, will, must*) is a **verb**. A word right after *very, too, so, quite, rather* is an **adjective or adverb**.

1.3.3 Test 3 — The Suffix (Word Ending) Test

Many words carry endings that signal their class. This test is helpful but **not perfect** (see the traps in 1.4).

Class	Typical suffixes	Examples
Noun	-tion, -sion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -ty, -ance, -ence, -ship, -hood, -dom, -ism, -ist, -er, -or, -ee, -age, -al, -th, -ure, -cy	information, decision, movement, kindness, ability, cruelty, importance, silence, friendship, childhood, freedom, heroism, scientist, teacher, actor, employee, marriage, arrival, growth, failure, privacy

Class	Typical suffixes	Examples
Adjective	-ous, -ful, -less, -able, -ible, -al, -ic, -ical, -ive, -ish, -y, -ant, -ent, -ary, -ory, -some, -ly (from nouns)	famous, beautiful, careless, readable, visible, national, heroic, historical, active, childish, rainy, important, different, necessary, compulsory, troublesome, friendly
Verb	-ize/-ise, -ify, -en, -ate	modernise, beautify, strengthen, activate
Adverb	-ly (from adjectives), -ward(s), -wise	quickly, homeward(s), clockwise, otherwise

1.3.4 Test 4 — The Substitution Test

Replace the word with a word whose class you are sure of. If the sentence still works grammatically, the two words belong to the same class.

- He came **after** the meeting. → He came **before** / **during** the meeting. (both prepositions → *after* is a preposition)
- He came **after** we had left. → He came **when** we had left. (*when* is a conjunction → *after* is a conjunction)
- He came **after**. → He came **later**. (*later* is an adverb → *after* is an adverb)

1.4 The Same Word as Different Parts of Speech: Exam Favourites

These words are the most frequently tested in BCS and admission tests. Learn each pattern. (Chapter 42 gives a larger list.)

1.4.1 *That*

- **That** is my house. → **Demonstrative pronoun** (stands alone)
- **That** house is mine. → **Adjective/Determiner** (before a noun)
- This is the book **that** I bought. → **Relative pronoun** (refers to *book*, introduces an adjective clause)
- I know **that** he is honest. → **Conjunction** (introduces a noun clause)
- He was **that** tired that he slept at once. → **Adverb** (= so; informal)
- I am so tired **that** I cannot walk. → **Conjunction** (of result)

Exam Tip — Relative pronoun or conjunction? If *that* can be replaced by *which/who/whom*, it is a **relative pronoun**: *the book that (= which) I bought*. If it cannot, and the clause after it is complete in itself, it is a **conjunction**: *I know that he is honest* (✘ I know which he is honest).

1.4.2 *But*

- He is poor **but** honest. → **Conjunction**
- All **but** him were present. → **Preposition** (= except; note the objective *him*)
- He is **but** a child. → **Adverb** (= only)
- There is no one **but** loves his country. → **Relative pronoun** (= who … not; literary)
- No **buts**, please. / Ifs and **buts**. → **Noun**
- **But** me no buts. → **Verb** (archaic; rarely tested)

1.4.3 *Since, Before, After, Till/Until*

These four can be **prepositions** (followed by a noun/pronoun), **conjunctions** (followed by a clause with a subject and verb) or **adverbs** (followed by nothing).

- I have been here **since** Monday. → Preposition
- It is two years **since** he died. → Conjunction
- I have not seen him **since**. → Adverb
- **Since** you are tired, you may go. → Conjunction (= because)
- He came **before** me. → Preposition
- He came **before** I left. → Conjunction
- I have seen him **before**. → Adverb

1.4.4 *Like*

- I **like** mangoes. → Verb
- He runs **like** a deer. → Preposition
- We shall not see his **like** again. → Noun
- They are of **like** minds. → Adjective (= similar)
- He talks **like** he knows everything. → Conjunction (informal; formal English prefers *as if*)

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — *Like* vs *As*: In GMAT Sentence Correction, *like* is accepted only as a **preposition** (followed by a noun/pronoun) and *as* is used before a **clause**. ✘ *Like I said, the plan failed.* ✔ *As I said, the plan failed.* ✘ *She sings like her mother does.* ✔ *She sings as her mother does* / *She sings like her mother.* Also, *like* compares things (*Like Dhaka, Karachi is crowded*), while *such as* gives examples (*cities such as Dhaka and Karachi*).

1.4.5 *What*

- **What** do you want? → Interrogative pronoun
- **What** book is this? → Interrogative adjective
- I know **what** you mean. → Relative pronoun (= that which)
- **What**! You failed again? → Interjection
- **What** a beautiful scene! → Adjective (exclamatory)
- **What** with illness and **what** with poverty, he was ruined. → Adverb (= partly)

1.4.6 *Well*

- She sings **well**. → Adverb
- I am quite **well** now. → Adjective (= in good health)
- The village **well** has dried up. → Noun
- **Well**, what can I do for you? → Interjection
- Tears **welled** up in her eyes. → Verb

1.4.7 *Down, Up, In, Out, Near, Round, Off*

- He fell **down** the stairs. → Preposition
- Sit **down**. → Adverb
- the **down** train → Adjective
- He has had many ups and **downs**. → Noun
- They **downed** tools. → Verb
- The house is **near** the river. → Preposition
- The day is **near**. → Adjective
- Come **near**. → Adverb
- The ship **neared** the coast. → Verb

1.4.8 *Fast, Hard, Late, Early, High, Long, Straight, Daily*

These are both **adjectives** and **adverbs** with the same form.

- He is a **fast** runner. (adj) / He runs **fast**. (adv) / He **fasts** in Ramadan. (verb) / He broke his **fast**. (noun)
- This is a **hard** question. (adj) / He works **hard**. (adv)
- He came by a **late** train. (adj) / He came **late**. (adv)
- I take an **early** walk. (adj) / I get up **early**. (adv)
- *The Daily Star* is a **daily**. (noun) / a **daily** newspaper (adj) / It is published **daily**. (adv)

> **Do not confuse:** *hard* (= with effort) ≠ *hardly* (= scarcely); *late* (= not on time) ≠ *lately* (= recently); *high* (= at a high level) ≠ *highly* (= very much); *near* (= close) ≠ *nearly* (= almost); *short* ≠ *shortly* (= soon); *free* (= without paying) ≠ *freely* (= without restriction); *deep* (= far down) ≠ *deeply* (= greatly). *He works **hard*** ✔ / *He hardly works* = he works very little.

1.4.9 Words Ending in *-ly* That Are NOT Adverbs

Many students think every *-ly* word is an adverb. The following are **adjectives** (formed from nouns + *-ly*):

friendly, lovely, lonely, lively, ugly, silly, costly, deadly, cowardly, manly, womanly, motherly, brotherly, scholarly, heavenly, holy, orderly, elderly, likely, unlikely, timely, homely, worldly, jolly, chilly, hilly, bodily, kingly, beastly, leisurely, sickly, surly, burly.

- She is a **friendly** girl. (adj) — We cannot say ✘ *She behaved friendly*. ✔ *She behaved **in a friendly manner/way***.
- He gave a **cowardly** reply. ✔ / He replied **in a cowardly way**.
- It was a **costly** mistake.
- *Daily, weekly, monthly, yearly, early, kindly, only, likely* can be both adjectives and adverbs: *a **kindly** old man* (adj) / *Kindly help me* (adv).

1.4.10 Nouns Used as Adjectives and Adjectives Used as Nouns

A **noun** placed before another noun to describe it works as an **adjective** (sometimes called a *noun adjunct*). Such a noun normally stays **singular**.

- a **gold** watch, a **village** school, a **cotton** shirt, a **college** student, a **ten-taka** note, a **five-year** plan, a **shoe** shop (✘ shoes shop), a **two-mile** walk (✘ two-miles walk)

An **adjective** preceded by *the* can work as a **plural noun** for a class of people: *the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the blind, the dead, the brave, the wise, the honest*. Such a phrase takes a **plural verb** and has **no -s**.

- **The rich are** not always happy. (✘ The rich is / ✘ The riches are)
- **The poor need** our help.
- **The brave deserve** the fair.
- *The unknown* / *the beautiful* (abstract idea) → singular: **The beautiful is** not always good.

1.4.11 *-ing* Words: Verb, Noun (Gerund) or Adjective (Participle)?

- He **is swimming** now. → **Verb** (part of the verb phrase *is swimming*)
- **Swimming** is a good exercise. → **Noun (Gerund)** — subject
- I like **swimming**. → **Noun (Gerund)** — object
- Look at the **swimming** fish. → **Adjective (Present Participle)** — describes *fish*
- a **swimming** pool → **Gerund** used as an adjective (= a pool *for* swimming, not a pool that swims)

> **Exam Tip — Gerund or participle before a noun?** Ask: *Is the noun itself doing the action?* A **sleeping** child = a child who is sleeping → **participle (adjective)**. A **sleeping** bag = a bag *for* sleeping → **gerund** (a noun used to form a compound). Similarly: *a walking stick, a dining table, a reading room, drinking water, a frying pan, a swimming pool* are gerunds; *a barking dog, a rising sun, a falling leaf, a running train* are participles.

1.4.12 Past Participle: Verb or Adjective?

- The window **was broken** by the boys. → **Verb** (passive)
- He looked at the **broken** window. → **Adjective** (describes *window*)
- I am **tired**. / She looks **worried**. → **Adjective** (after linking verbs)
- **Written** in simple English, the book is popular. → **Participle** (adjectival; describes *book*)

1.4.13 Words Whose Stress Changes the Class

Some two-syllable words are **nouns/adjectives** with stress on the **first** syllable and **verbs** with stress on the **second**:

Noun / Adjective (stress 1st)	Verb (stress 2nd)
REcord (a record)	re**CORD** (to record)
PREsent (a gift; now)	pre**SENT** (to give)
OBject (a thing)	ob**JECT** (to oppose)
CONduct (behaviour)	con**DUCT** (to lead)
PROduce (crops)	pro**DUCE** (to make)
PERmit (a licence)	per**MIT** (to allow)
CONtract (an agreement)	con**TRACT** (to shrink)
INsult / **PRO**test / **RE**bel / **CON**flict / **SUB**ject	in**SULT** / pro**TEST** / re**BEL** / con**FLICT** / sub**JECT**

1.4.14 Other Frequently Tested Words

- **Enough:** I have **enough** money (adj). / He is old **enough** (adv). / I have had **enough** (noun/pronoun).
- **Very:** He is **very** good (adv). / This is the **very** book I wanted (adj = exact).
- **Much: Much** water (adj). / He is **much** better (adv). / **Much** has been done (noun/pronoun).
- **Only:** He is an **only** child (adj). / He **only** smiled (adv). / I would go, **only** I am busy (conj = but).
- **Still:** The water is **still** (adj = calm). / He is **still** here (adv). / the **still** of the night (noun). / **Still**, I love her (conj/adv = nevertheless).

- **Yet:** He has not come **yet** (adv). / He is poor, **yet** he is honest (conj).
- **For:** He works **for** money (prep). / He was sad, **for** his son had died (conj = because).
- **As:** He is **as** tall **as** I (adv … conj). / **As** he was ill, he stayed home (conj). / He worked **as** a clerk (prep). / Such men **as** are honest (relative pronoun).
- **Either: Either** pen will do (adj). / **Either** of them will do (pronoun). / **Either** you or I (conj). / He does not like it **either** (adv).
- **Back:** My **back** aches (noun). / Come **back** (adv). / the **back** door (adj). / They **backed** the plan (verb).
- **Last:** the **last** boy (adj) / He came **last** (adv) / He was the **last** to leave (noun/pronoun) / The food will **last** a week (verb).
- **Over:** The plane flew **over** the city (prep). / The game is **over** (adj/adv). / an **over** in cricket (noun).
- **Off:** He fell **off** the horse (prep). / Switch **off** the light (adv/particle). / an **off** day (adj).
- **Before / After / Since** — see 1.4.3.
- **Love, Work, Name, Book, Water, Hand, Head, Face, Eye, Fish:** each can be noun or verb: *Please **book** two tickets. **Water** the plants. She **headed** the team. He **eyed** me suspiciously.*

1.5 Phrases and Clauses Can Also Act as Parts of Speech

A **group** of words can do the job of a single part of speech. This idea links Chapter 01 with Chapters 30 and 31.

- **To tell lies** is a sin. → noun phrase (= *Lying* is a sin)
- He is a man **of great wisdom**. → adjective phrase (= a *wise* man)
- He did the work **with great care**. → adverb phrase (= *carefully*)
- **What he said** is true. → noun clause
- This is the house **where I was born**. → adjective clause
- I will wait **till you return**. → adverb clause
- **In front of**, **on account of**, **in spite of**, **because of** → phrase prepositions
- **As soon as**, **as long as**, **so that**, **in order that**, **even if** → phrase conjunctions
- **Alas!**, **Good heavens!**, **Oh dear!** → interjection phrases

1.6 Worked Examples: Identify the Underlined Word

Read the explanation for each. This is exactly how BCS and admission questions are set.

1. He is **above** meanness. → *Preposition* (object: *meanness*).
2. The **above** statement is false. → *Adjective* (qualifies *statement*).
3. The sky is **above**. → *Adverb* (no object follows).
4. He **lives** in Dhaka. → *Verb*.
5. Many **lives** were lost. → *Noun* (plural of *life*).
6. She sang **sweetly**. → *Adverb* (modifies *sang*).
7. The rose smells **sweet**. → *Adjective* (after linking verb *smells*; it describes the rose, not the action). ✘ The rose smells sweetly.
8. **Each** of the boys got a prize. → *Pronoun*.
9. **Each** boy got a prize. → *Adjective/Determiner*.
10. **Walking** is good for health. → *Noun (Gerund)*.
11. I saw a **walking** doll. → *Adjective (Participle)*.
12. **Hush!** Don't make a noise. → *Interjection*.
13. He worked hard **lest** he should fail. → *Conjunction*.
14. Do you **mind** my smoking? → *Verb*; **smoking** → *Gerund*; **my** → *Possessive adjective/determiner*.
15. **Better** late than never. → *Adverb*.
16. He is **better** today. → *Adjective* (= in better health).
17. Our **betters** deserve respect. → *Noun* (= superiors).
18. He **bettered** his record. → *Verb*.
19. He gave me a **light**. → *Noun*.
20. This bag is **light**. → *Adjective*.
21. **Light** the lamp. → *Verb*.
22. He travels **light**. → *Adverb*.
23. **Rich** and poor alike came. → *Adjective used as noun* (= rich people).
24. He is a **man** of his word. → *Noun*.
25. **Man** the boats! → *Verb* (= put people on).
26. **Who** is there? → *Interrogative pronoun*.
27. I know the man **who** came here. → *Relative pronoun*.
28. **Whose** pen is this? → *Interrogative adjective* (before noun *pen*).
29. **Whatever** you do, do it well. → *Relative pronoun* (compound).
30. He has **no** money. → *Adjective/Determiner*. / **No**, I won't go. → *Adverb (sentence word)*. / He is **no** better. → *Adverb* (modifies *better*).
31. Wait a **little**. → *Noun/Pronoun*. / He is **little** known. → *Adverb*. / I have **little** time. → *Adjective*.
32. It is **quite** wrong. → *Adverb* (modifies adjective).
33. **Out** of sight, **out** of mind. → *Preposition* (*out of* = phrase preposition).
34. The truth will **out**. → *Verb* (= become known).
35. **Behind** the house there is a garden. → *Preposition*. / He stayed **behind**. → *Adverb*.
36. He is **a** cunning **fellow**. → *a*: article (adjective); *cunning*: adjective; *fellow*: noun.
37. **Indeed**, he is honest. → *Adverb* (sentence adverb).
38. **Notwithstanding** his efforts, he failed. → *Preposition* (= in spite of).
39. He failed; **notwithstanding**, he tried again. → *Adverb* (= nevertheless).
40. **Considering** his age, he did well. → *Preposition* (a participle used as preposition, like *regarding, concerning, pending, during, barring, excepting*).

> **Participle prepositions:** Some *-ing* or *-ed* words have become prepositions: *regarding, concerning, considering, during, pending, barring, excepting, including, notwithstanding, touching, owing to, given, provided. During the war* = preposition (✘ not a gerund or participle in this use).

1.7 Common Errors in the Use of Parts of Speech

1. ✘ He is a very good runner and runs very good. ✔ … runs very **well**. (*good* = adjective; *well* = adverb for manner)

2. ✘ She dresses beautiful. ✔ She dresses **beautifully**.
3. ✘ I feel badly about the matter. ✔ I feel **bad** about the matter. (*feel* is a linking verb here → adjective)
4. ✘ The food tastes deliciously. ✔ The food tastes **delicious**.
5. ✘ He behaved friendly with me. ✔ He behaved **in a friendly manner** with me.
6. ✘ He came lately to the class. ✔ He came **late** to the class.
7. ✘ He is enough strong to lift it. ✔ He is **strong enough** to lift it. (*enough* follows an adjective/adverb but precedes a noun: *enough money*)
8. ✘ The poors are suffering. ✔ **The poor are** suffering.
9. ✘ Between you and I, he is wrong. ✔ Between you and **me** …
10. ✘ He is more cleverer than his brother. ✔ He is **cleverer** than his brother.
11. ✘ He ran quick to the station. ✔ He ran **quickly** to the station.
12. ✘ She is real happy. ✔ She is **really** happy. (adverb needed to modify an adjective)
13. ✘ I can't hardly see. ✔ I can **hardly** see. (*hardly* is already negative)
14. ✘ This is a two-days programme. ✔ This is a **two-day** programme.
15. ✘ He is an university student. ✔ He is **a** university student. (sound, not spelling, decides *a/an*)

1.8 Connecting to the SAT, GRE and GMAT

International tests do not ask "Name the part of speech", but every verbal question assumes you can recognise it instantly:

- **SAT Writing & Language / Standard English Conventions:** questions on *adjective vs adverb* (*a remarkably* (✔) *clear explanation*), *pronoun case*, and *parallel structure* (verbs must be parallel with verbs, nouns with nouns).
- **GRE Text Completion & Sentence Equivalence:** the blank must be filled with a word of the right part of speech. If the blank is preceded by *a/an/the* and followed by a noun, an **adjective** is needed; if followed by an object, a **verb**. Eliminating options of the wrong class is the fastest first step.
- **GMAT Sentence Correction:** tests *modifier* placement (Chapter 29), *noun vs verb* forms (*the ability **to** do* ✔; *the ability **of** doing* ✘), and *like vs as* (1.4.4).

> **Final Advice:** Never memorise a word's class in isolation. Always ask **"What is this word doing here?"** If it names → noun; replaces a noun → pronoun; describes a noun → adjective; acts/is → verb; describes the action/quality → adverb; relates → preposition; joins → conjunction; exclaims → interjection. This single question solves almost every identification problem.

CHAPTER 23

Subject-Verb Agreement

Part A · Grammar

23.1 What Is Subject-Verb Agreement?

Every complete sentence has a **subject** (the person or thing we are talking about) and a **verb** (what the subject does or is). *Subject-verb agreement* means that **the verb must match its subject in number and person.**

- **Number** means *singular* (one) or *plural* (more than one).
- **Person** means *first person* (I, we), *second person* (you) or *third person* (he, she, it, they, Rahim, the book, the students).

So, a singular subject needs a singular verb, and a plural subject needs a plural verb. This sounds very easy, and in short sentences it is. The difficulty appears when the subject is hidden, long, compound, collective, or separated from its verb by many words. Almost every competitive exam in Bangladesh — BCS Preliminary, Bank (Officer, Senior Officer, AD of Bangladesh Bank), university admission tests (DU, JU, RU, CU) and international exams like the SAT, GRE and GMAT — tests this topic every year, mainly through *Error Detection*, *Sentence Correction*, *Right Form of Verbs* and *Fill in the Blanks*.

- The boy **plays** football. (singular subject → singular verb)
- The boys **play** football. (plural subject → plural verb)
- She **is** a doctor. / They **are** doctors.
- I **am** ready. / We **are** ready.

23.1.1 Why the "s" Confuses Learners

In English, an **-s/-es** at the end of a **noun** usually makes it *plural* (book → books). But an **-s/-es** at the end of a **present-tense verb** makes it *singular* (they play → he play**s**). So in a correct present simple sentence, the "s" usually appears **only once** — either on the noun or on the verb, not on both.

- The dog bark**s**. (s on the verb → singular)
- The dog**s** bark. (s on the noun → plural)
- ✘ The dogs barks. ✔ The dogs bark.

> **Exam Tip — The "one s" trick:** In a simple present sentence with a normal noun subject, if both the subject and the verb end in -s, check again — one of them is probably wrong. (This trick does not work for nouns like *news*, *physics*, *police*, *people*, *children*, so learn those rules below.)

23.1.2 Where Agreement Matters

Agreement only shows in a few places in English, so you must know exactly where to look:

1. **Present simple tense** — *he works / they work.*
2. **The verb *be*** — *am / is / are* (present) and *was / were* (past).
3. **The verb *have*** — *has / have*.
4. **The verb *do*** — *does / do*.
5. **Present perfect and present continuous** — *has gone / have gone; is going / are going*.
6. **Past continuous** — *was going / were going*.

Modal auxiliaries (*can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to*) **never change** with the subject: *He can swim. They can swim.* The **past simple** of ordinary verbs also does not change: *He went. They went.*

Subject	be (present)	be (past)	have	do	Main verb (present)
I	am	was	have	do	write
We / You / They	are	were	have	do	write
He / She / It	is	was	has	does	writes
Singular noun (Rahim, the book)	is	was	has	does	writes
Plural noun (the boys)	are	were	have	do	write

> **Remember:** *You* always takes a plural verb even when it refers to one person: *You **are** my friend* (✘ You is). *I* takes *am* in the present but *was* in the past: *I **was** there* (✘ I were there — except in the subjunctive: *If I **were** you*).

23.2 Step One: Find the True Subject

Most agreement errors happen because the learner matches the verb with the wrong word. So before applying any rule, **find the real (head) subject**. Ask: *"Who or what is doing the action / being described?"* Then strip away everything that only describes it.

23.2.1 Words That Are Never the Subject

The subject of a sentence is **never** inside:

- a **prepositional phrase** (of the students, in the box, with his friends, for the poor);
- an **appositive** set off by commas (*Mr. Karim, our teachers' leader, …*);
- a **relative clause** (*who live next door, which were damaged*);
- a **participial phrase** (*sitting under the trees, written by Tagore*).

Cross these out mentally and look at what is left.

- The quality of the mangoes **is** (✘ are) excellent. → *quality* is the subject; *of the mangoes* is a prepositional phrase.
- The box of chocolates **was** (✘ were) stolen.
- The boys in the last bench **are** talking.
- The cost of all these books **has** (✘ have) risen.
- One of my friends **lives** (✘ live) in Sylhet.
- The leader of the workers, together with his followers, **was** (✘ were) arrested.
- A list of the successful candidates **has** (✘ have) been published.
- The use of mobile phones in classrooms **is** (✘ are) prohibited.

- The houses that stand beside the river **are** (✘ is) old.

SAT / GRE / GMAT Corner — The "Long-Distance" Trap: Standardised tests love to put 10–20 words between the subject and the verb so that a plural noun sits right before a singular verb (or vice versa). Example (GMAT style): *"The rise in the prices of essential commodities such as rice, lentils and edible oils **have** hurt low-income families."* The subject is *rise* (singular), so the correct verb is **has hurt**. Always ask: *What exactly has hurt the families? — The rise.*

23.2.2 Subject After the Verb (Inverted Order)

In some sentences the verb comes **before** the subject. You must look **after** the verb to find the subject.

(a) Sentences beginning with *There* or *Here*. *There* and *here* are never subjects; the real subject comes after the verb.

- There **is** a book on the table.
- There **are** many books on the table.
- There **was** a lot of noise.
- There **were** a lot of people.
- Here **is** your ticket. / Here **are** your tickets.
- ✘ There's three reasons for this. ✔ There **are** three reasons for this.

(b) Questions. The subject usually follows the auxiliary.

- Where **is** the key? / Where **are** the keys?
- **Does** your brother live here? / **Do** your brothers live here?
- **Has** any of the guests arrived? / **Have** all the guests arrived?
- What **are** the causes of the war? (subject = *the causes*)

(c) Inversion after adverbs or adverbial phrases of place (literary style, common in SAT/GRE reading).

- On the hill **stands** an old temple. (subject = *an old temple*)
- On the hill **stand** two old temples.
- Among the guests **was** the Prime Minister.
- In the middle of the room **were** a table and two chairs.
- Down **came** the rain. / Away **flew** the birds.

(d) Inversion after negative adverbs (*never, seldom, rarely, hardly, scarcely, no sooner, not only, nor, little*). The auxiliary still agrees with the subject that follows it.

- Never **has** he told a lie. / Never **have** they told a lie.
- Not only **does** she sing, but she also dances.
- Seldom **do** we see such honesty nowadays.

23.2.3 Long Subjects (Phrases and Clauses as Subjects)

When a **gerund phrase**, an **infinitive phrase** or a **noun clause** is the subject, it is treated as **one idea**, so the verb is **singular**.

- Swimming in rivers **is** good exercise.
- Reading books **makes** a man perfect.
- Taking long walks in the evening **helps** her relax.
- To err **is** human; to forgive **is** divine.
- To read many books **is** useful.
- What he says **is** true.
- That he is honest **is** known to all.
- Whether they will come **is** uncertain.
- Who stole the money **remains** a mystery.

Two gerunds joined by *and* usually take a plural verb because they are two different activities: *Reading and writing **are** essential skills.* But if they form one combined activity, use singular: *Eating and drinking too much **is** harmful.* (Both are accepted in modern usage; in exams the plural is safer for two clearly separate activities.)

Special case — *What*-clauses with plural complements. When a *what*-clause is followed by a plural noun complement, many grammarians accept a plural verb: *What we need **are** more teachers.* The traditional (safe) answer for BCS is singular: *What we need **is** more teachers.* Both are seen in good writing; SAT and GMAT avoid testing this.

23.3 Rules for Compound Subjects

A **compound subject** has two or more nouns/pronouns joined by *and, or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also*, etc.

Rule 1: Subjects joined by *and* → plural verb

Rule 1. Two or more subjects joined by **and** generally take a **plural verb**.

- Rahim and Karim **are** friends.
- My father and my uncle **were** present.
- He and I **are** classmates.
- Honesty and hard work **are** the keys to success.
- Bangladesh and Nepal **are** neighbouring countries.
- The teacher and the students **have** gone to the museum.

There are several important **exceptions** to Rule 1. These are among the most frequently tested points in BCS and Bank exams.

Rule 2: Two nouns, one person → singular

Rule 2. If two nouns joined by *and* refer to the **same person or thing**, the verb is **singular**. The sign: **the article (a/an/the) or possessive is used only once**, before the first noun.

- The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one man who is both a poet and a philosopher)
- The poet and the philosopher **are** dead. (two different men)
- The Headmaster and Secretary **is** present. (one person)
- The Headmaster and the Secretary **are** present. (two persons)
- My friend and benefactor **has** come.
- A black and white cow **is** grazing. (one cow with two colours)
- A black and a white cow **are** grazing. (two cows)
- The writer and director of the film **was** awarded.

Rule 3: One idea or one dish → singular

Rule 3. When two nouns joined by *and* express **one idea**, **one unit**, or **one combined thing** (often a dish, a pair or a proverb), the verb is **singular**.

- Bread and butter **is** his usual breakfast.
- Rice and curry **is** my favourite food.
- Bread and milk **is** good for children.
- Slow and steady **wins** the race.
- Fish and chips **is** popular in England.
- Law and order **has** deteriorated.
- The horse and carriage **is** at the door. (one vehicle)
- The long and the short of the matter **is** this.
- Gin and tonic **is** a common drink.
- Ups and downs **are** part of life. (*ups and downs* is plural in form and meaning)

Traditional proverb exception: *Time and tide **wait** for none.* Here *time* and *tide* are treated as two separate things, so the verb is plural. Learn it as it is, since it appears often in BCS papers.

Bread and butter in its idiomatic sense *(means of livelihood)* is also singular: *Teaching **is** my bread and butter.*

Rule 4: *Each / Every / No* before *and*-subjects → singular

Rule 4. If **each, every, many a** or **no** comes before singular subjects joined by *and*, the verb is **singular**.

- Every man and woman **is** equal before the law.
- Each boy and each girl **has** a book.
- Every teacher and every student **was** present.
- No man and no woman **was** spared.
- Every house and every shop **was** searched.
- Each day and each night **brings** its own problems.

Rule 5: *As well as, with, along with* etc. → verb follows the FIRST subject

Rule 5. When two subjects are joined by **as well as, with, along with, together with, accompanied by, in addition to, besides, including, like, unlike, rather than, more than, no less than, and not, but not, except, but, plus**, the verb agrees with the **first subject**. The second part is only extra information and is usually set off by commas.

- The teacher, as well as the students, **was** present. (✘ were)
- The students, as well as the teacher, **were** present.
- The captain, along with his players, **has** arrived.
- The minister, with his secretaries, **is** coming.
- Rina, together with her sisters, **is** going to Cox's Bazar.
- He, and not you, **is** to blame.
- You, and not he, **are** to blame.
- The ship, with its crew, **was** lost.
- Mr. Hasan, accompanied by his wife, **was** at the party.
- The house, including its furniture, **was** sold.
- Karim, like his brothers, **is** a doctor.
- Gold, no less than silver, **has** fallen in price.
- He, rather than his friends, **deserves** punishment.
- The President, in addition to his ministers, **was** present.
- Nobody except the guards **was** allowed inside.

SAT / GMAT Corner — The "False Compound" trap: Test-makers use *along with, as well as, in addition to, together with* to make a singular subject *look* plural. E.g. *"The CEO, in addition to several board members, **were** accused of fraud."* ✘ → **was** accused. Only **and** can create a true compound (plural) subject. GMAT often uses this with long intervening phrases.

Rule 6: *Or, nor, either…or, neither…nor* → nearer subject (Proximity Rule)

Rule 6. When two subjects are joined by **or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also, not…but**, the verb agrees with the subject **nearer (closer) to it**. This is called the **Law of Proximity**.

- Either Rahim or Karim **has** done it. (both singular → singular)
- Either the boys or their father **has** done it. (nearer = father)
- Either the father or his sons **have** done it. (nearer = sons)
- Neither he nor I **am** guilty. (nearer = I)
- Neither you nor he **is** responsible.
- Neither he nor you **are** responsible.
- Not only the students but also the teacher **was** surprised.
- Not only the teacher but also the students **were** surprised.
- Not the principal but the teachers **are** responsible.
- Either you or your brother **has** to go.
- **Has** either Rahim or Karim seen this? (In a question the auxiliary stands nearest to the *first* subject, so if one subject is plural, rewrite: *Have his friends or Rahim seen this?*)
- Ali or his brothers **are** coming.
- My brothers or Ali **is** coming.

Exam Tip — Placing the plural subject last: When one subject is singular and the other plural, good style puts the **plural subject nearer the verb** and uses a **plural verb**: *Neither the captain nor the players **were** happy.* This sounds more natural than *Neither the players nor the captain was happy*, though both are grammatically correct.

Person problem. When the subjects joined by *or/nor* are of different persons (*you* and *I*, *he* and *I*), the verb still agrees with the nearer subject. But because such sentences sound awkward, it is better to repeat the verb:

- Either you or I **am** wrong. → Better: Either you **are** wrong, or I **am**.
- Neither he nor you **are** to blame. → Better: He **is** not to blame, nor **are** you.

Order of persons with *and*. When pronouns of different persons are joined by *and*, the polite order in good English is **231** for ordinary/positive sentences: second person first, then third, then first (*You, he and I*). When admitting a fault or in negative sense, the order is **123** (*I, you and he are to blame*). The verb is always plural.

- You, he and I **are** good friends.
- I, you and he **are** guilty.

Rule 7: *Both…and* → plural

Both…and always joins two subjects firmly, so the verb is always **plural**.

- Both Rahim and Karim **are** absent.
- Both the cat and the dog **were** hungry.

23.4 Indefinite Pronouns and Distributive Words

Indefinite pronouns refer to people or things in a general way. Some are always singular, some always plural, and some can be either.

Rule 8: Always singular indefinite pronouns

> **Rule 8.** The following words are **always singular** and take a **singular verb**: **each, every, either, neither, one, everyone, everybody, everything, someone, somebody, something, anyone, anybody, anything, no one, nobody, nothing, another, much, many a, more than one, little (amount).**

- Everybody **knows** the answer.
- Everyone **was** happy.
- Somebody **has** taken my pen.
- Nobody **likes** to be insulted.
- Nothing **is** impossible.
- Anyone **is** allowed to apply.
- Something **is** wrong with the engine.
- Much **has** been said about the matter.
- Each of the boys **was** given a prize.
- Every one of the students **has** passed.
- Either of the two roads **leads** to the station.
- Neither of the answers **is** correct.
- One of the girls **is** absent.
- One of the most important problems **is** unemployment.

> **Exam Tip — "One of the + plural noun + singular verb":** *One of the boys **is*** (✘ one of the boy is / ✘ one of the boys are). Note two things: (i) the noun after *one of the* must be **plural**; (ii) the verb must be **singular** because the subject is *one*. Both errors are tested regularly.

Either / Neither are used for **two** persons or things only. For more than two, use *any one / none*.

- Either of the two brothers **is** suitable.
- Any one of the five candidates **is** suitable. (✘ Either of the five)
- Neither of the two sisters **sings** well.
- None of the ten students **has/have** passed. (✘ Neither of the ten)

> In informal English, *neither of* + plural noun with a plural verb is common (*Neither of them **are** coming*). In BCS, Bank and admission exams, always use the **singular** verb: *Neither of them **is** coming.*

Rule 9: *Each* after a plural subject

When *each* comes **after** a plural subject (as an appositive), the verb is **plural**, because the subject is still plural. When *each* comes **before** (as the subject), the verb is singular.

- They each **have** a car. (subject = *they*)
- Each of them **has** a car. (subject = *each*)
- The students each **have** their own computers.
- We each **have** a different opinion.
- Each student **has** a different opinion.

Rule 10: Always plural indefinite pronouns

> **Rule 10. Both, few, a few, many, several, others** are always **plural**.

- Both **are** guilty.
- Few **were** present at the meeting.
- Many **have** come, but a few **have** gone back.
- Several of the books **are** missing.
- Others **think** differently.

Rule 11: SANAM pronouns — singular or plural

> **Rule 11 (The SANAM Rule). S**ome, **A**ny, **N**one, **A**ll, **M**ost (and also *half, part, rest, enough, more, lot, plenty, majority, percent, fractions*) can be singular or plural. Look at the noun **after *of*** (or the noun they refer to): if it is **uncountable or singular → singular verb**; if it is **countable plural → plural verb**.

- Some of the milk **is** sour. / Some of the mangoes **are** sour.
- All of the money **was** stolen. / All of the books **were** stolen.
- Most of the work **is** done. / Most of the workers **are** absent.
- Any of the food **is** fine. / Are any of the boys here?
- Half of the cake **has** been eaten. / Half of the cakes **have** been eaten.
- Part of the building **was** damaged. / Part of the walls **were** damaged.
- The rest of the story **is** boring. / The rest of the students **are** in the hall.
- A lot of water **is** wasted. / A lot of people **are** waiting.
- Plenty of time **is** left. / Plenty of seats **are** available.
- All that glitters **is** not gold. (*all* = everything → singular)
- All **are** not thieves that dogs bark at. (*all* = all persons → plural)
- All is well. / All are well.

Rule 12: *None*

None means *not one* or *not any*. Traditional grammar treated it as singular, but modern usage (and most Bangladeshi exam keys) follows the SANAM rule:

- None of the information **was** useful. (uncountable → singular)
- None of the money **is** mine.
- None of the students **were/was** present. (countable plural → both accepted; plural is more common, singular is more formal)
- None **were** present. (= no persons)

- None but the brave **deserves** the fair. (famous line of Dryden — learn as it is)
- None of these two answers… ✘ → Neither of these two answers **is** correct.

> **Exam Tip on *none*:** If an option says *"None of the boys were present"* or *"None of the boys was present"*, both can be correct. Look for another clear error in the sentence. If you must choose, the singular is the "classic" formal answer, while the plural matches modern usage (SAT/GRE accept both). With an uncountable noun, only the singular is correct.

Rule 13: *Many a* → singular verb and singular noun

> **Rule 13. Many a / many an** is followed by a **singular noun** and a **singular verb** (and a singular pronoun), though its meaning is "many".

- Many a man **has** lost his life in this war.
- Many a student **was** absent yesterday.
- Many a flower **is** born to blush unseen. (Thomas Gray)
- Many an opportunity **has** been lost.
- ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a boy **was** present.

Compare: **A great many / a good many** take a **plural noun** and **plural verb**: *A great many students **were** present.* And **many** alone is plural: *Many students **were** present.*

Rule 14: *More than one* → singular; *More + plural noun + than one* → plural

- More than one boy **was** absent. (✘ More than one boys were)
- More than one student **has** failed.
- More boys than one **were** absent. (the subject is *boys*)
- More than two boys **were** absent. (*two* is plural)

Rule 15: *A number of* vs *The number of*

> **Rule 15. A number of** (= many) + plural noun → **plural verb**. **The number of** (= the total figure) + plural noun → **singular verb**.

- A number of students **are** absent today.
- The number of students **is** increasing day by day.
- A number of accidents **have** occurred on this road.
- The number of road accidents **has** risen sharply.
- A large number of people **were** killed.
- The number of unemployed youths **is** alarming.

The same logic applies to similar expressions:

- A variety of fruits **are** sold here. / The variety of fruits **is** amazing.
- A total of fifty people **were** injured. / The total **is** fifty.
- A majority of voters **support** him. / The majority **is** in favour.
- A couple of days **have** passed.
- A pair of shoes **is** under the bed. (a pair = one unit; see Rule 22)

23.5 Relative Pronouns (who, which, that)

A relative pronoun has no number of its own. The verb in a relative clause agrees with the **antecedent** (the noun or pronoun the relative pronoun refers to).

Rule 16: Verb agrees with the antecedent of *who/which/that*

> **Rule 16.** In a relative clause, the verb agrees in number **and person** with the antecedent of the relative pronoun.

- I, who **am** your friend, will help you. (✘ who is)
- You, who **are** my friend, should help me.
- He, who **is** my friend, will help me.
- It is I who **am** to blame. (✘ It is I who is to blame)
- It is you who **are** to blame.
- It is he who **is** responsible.
- It is they who **have** done this.
- The girl who **sings** well is my sister.
- The girls who **sing** well are my sisters.
- This is the book that **was** missing.
- These are the books that **were** missing.

Rule 17: *One of those who* → plural; *The only one of those who* → singular

This is a favourite trap of BCS, Bank and GMAT.

> **Rule 17.** In "**one of the + plural noun + who/that/which**", the antecedent of *who* is the **plural noun**, so the verb in the relative clause is **plural**. But in "**the only one of the + plural noun + who**", the antecedent is **one**, so the verb is **singular**.

- He is one of the best players who **have** ever played for Bangladesh. (many players have played; he is one of them)
- She is one of those women who **work** hard.
- This is one of the books that **are** worth reading.
- He is one of the boys who **are** always late.
- He is the only one of the boys who **is** always late. (only he is late)
- She is the only one of the applicants who **has** a driving licence.
- Rahim is the only one of my friends who **lives** in Dhaka.

> **Quick test:** Turn the sentence around: *"Of the boys who **are** always late, he is one."* — the plural is clearly correct. But for *the only one*: *"Of the boys, he is the only one who **is** always late."* — clearly singular.

23.6 Collective Nouns

A **collective noun** names a group of persons or things: *family, team, class, committee, jury, crowd, audience, army, crew, staff, government, council, public, board, company, flock, herd, fleet, mob, parliament, party, majority, enemy, union, orchestra, band, gang, association.*

Rule 18: Collective noun as a unit → singular; as individuals → plural

> **Rule 18.** If the group acts **as one unit**, use a **singular verb** (and singular pronoun *it/its*). If the members act **separately or disagree**, use a **plural verb** (and plural pronoun *they/their*).

- The jury **has** given its verdict. (one decision)
- The jury **were** divided in their opinions. (members disagree)
- The committee **has** submitted its report.
- The committee **are** arguing among themselves.
- The team **is** playing well this season.
- The team **are** taking their seats on the bus.
- My family **is** a large one.
- My family **are** all early risers.
- The class **was** dismissed at noon.
- The class **were** busy with their own work.
- The army **is** marching forward.
- The audience **was** enormous. / The audience **were** clapping their hands.
- The crowd **has** dispersed. / The crowd **were** shouting slogans.
- The staff **is** small. / The staff **are** on leave.
- The public **is** requested not to litter. (unit) / The public **are** divided on this issue.

> **Consistency matters:** Never mix singular and plural for the same collective noun in one sentence. ✘ *The committee **has** made **their** decision.* ✔ *The committee **has** made **its** decision.* This "verb–pronoun consistency" is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT.

> **British vs American English:** In American English (the standard of the SAT, GRE and GMAT), collective nouns are **almost always singular**: *The government **is** …, The team **is** …* In British English, plural is common when we think of members: *The government **are** …, The team **are** …* Bangladeshi exams mostly follow the traditional British "unit vs individuals" rule. In international tests, choose the **singular** unless the sentence clearly shows separate action (like *disagree among themselves*).

Rule 19: Nouns that look singular but are always plural

> **Rule 19.** Some collective nouns are **always plural**, even though they have no -s: **people (= persons), police, cattle, poultry, gentry, clergy, peasantry, vermin, swine, folk, militia, livestock (often)**. They never take *a/an* and never add -s in this sense.

- The people **are** happy. (✘ The people is happy)
- Many people **were** killed.
- The police **have** arrested the thief. (✘ The police has)
- The police **are** investigating the case.
- The cattle **are** grazing in the field. (✘ cattles)
- Poultry **are** kept on this farm.
- The gentry **were** invited.
- The clergy **are** against the move.
- Vermin **are** destroying the crops.

> ***People*** meaning "a nation / an ethnic group" is countable and has a plural ***peoples***: *The Bengalis **are** a brave people. The peoples of Asia **are** diverse.* ***A policeman / a police officer*** is the singular of *police*: ✘ *A police came.* ✔ *A policeman came.*

23.7 Nouns with Tricky Forms

Rule 20: Plural in form, singular in meaning

> **Rule 20.** Some nouns end in **-s** but are **singular** in meaning and take a **singular verb**.

(a) Names of subjects / sciences: *mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, statistics, phonetics, linguistics, civics, electronics, genetics, athletics, gymnastics.*

(b) Names of diseases: *measles, mumps, rickets, diabetes, shingles, rabies, herpes.*

(c) Names of games: *billiards, darts, draughts, dominoes, cards (as a game).*

(d) Other words: *news, innings, gallows, summons, means (method), wages (in some idioms), amends.*

- Mathematics **is** my favourite subject.
- Economics **is** a social science.
- Physics **deals** with matter and energy.
- Measles **is** an infectious disease.
- Diabetes **is** common in Bangladesh.
- Billiards **is** an indoor game.
- The news **is** true. (✘ The news are true) — *a piece of news*, not *a news*.
- No news **is** good news.
- Bangladesh's first innings **was** good. / An innings **lasts** for hours.
- The gallows **was** set up.
- A summons **has** been issued. (plural: *summonses*)

> **Subject words used in other senses take a plural verb:** *His politics **are** confusing.* (his political views) *The statistics **show** a rise in crime.* (a set of figures) *The economics of the project **are** not clear.* (financial aspects) *His mathematics **are** weak.* (his calculations — some books accept). But as subjects of study: *Politics **is** a dirty game. Statistics **is** an important subject.*

Rule 21: Plural-only nouns (summation plurals)

Rule 21. Some nouns are used **only in the plural** and always take a **plural verb**: **scissors, trousers, pants, pyjamas, jeans, shorts, spectacles, glasses (eyeglasses), binoculars, tongs, pliers, bellows, shears, thanks, riches, alms, proceeds, premises, surroundings, outskirts, environs, arrears, savings, belongings, clothes, goods, contents, assets, annals, archives, credentials, earnings, remains, dregs, eaves, lodgings, odds, tidings, valuables, congratulations.**

- My trousers **are** new. (✘ my trouser is)
- Your spectacles **are** on the table.
- The scissors **are** sharp.
- Riches **do** not bring happiness.
- Alms **are** given to the poor.
- The proceeds of the show **were** donated.
- The premises **are** guarded.
- The surroundings of the lake **are** beautiful.
- His clothes **are** dirty.
- The goods **have** been dispatched.
- Thanks **are** due to the organisers.
- The contents of the letter **were** secret.

Rule 22: *A pair of* + plural noun → singular

- A pair of scissors **is** on the table.
- This pair of trousers **is** expensive.
- Two pairs of shoes **are** needed.
- My pair of spectacles **was** broken.

Rule 23: Same form in singular and plural

Some nouns have **the same form** in both numbers: *sheep, deer, swine, fish (usually), aircraft, spacecraft, series, species, means, headquarters, crossroads, works (factory), offspring, salmon, trout, cod, corps.* The determiner or context tells us the number.

- A sheep **is** grazing. / Ten sheep **are** grazing. (✘ sheeps)
- A deer **was** killed. / Many deer **were** killed.
- A series of lectures **was** arranged. / Two series of stamps **have** been issued.
- This species of bird **is** rare. / These species **are** endangered.
- Every means **has** been tried. / All means **have** been tried.
- The headquarters of the company **is/are** in Dhaka. (both accepted)
- An aircraft **was** missing. / Three aircraft **were** missing.

Rule 24: Uncountable (mass) nouns → always singular

Rule 24. Uncountable nouns take a **singular verb** and never take *a/an* or a plural ending: **information, advice, furniture, luggage, baggage, equipment, machinery, scenery, poetry, jewellery, knowledge, homework, work (= labour), stationery, traffic, weather, bread, money, evidence, mischief, damage (harm), news, hair (on the head), dust, rubbish, grass, offspring (sometimes), crockery, cutlery, business (affairs), progress, research, behaviour, wealth, health, music, fun, patience, permission.**

- The information **is** correct. (✘ The informations are)
- His advice **was** helpful. (✘ advices)
- The furniture **is** new. (✘ furnitures) → *a piece of furniture / pieces of furniture*
- My luggage **has** been lost.
- The scenery of Rangamati **is** charming. (✘ sceneries)
- The machinery **was** imported from Japan.
- Her hair **is** long and black. (✘ hairs are) — but *There are two grey hairs on his head* (individual strands)
- Poetry **is** the music of the soul.
- The evidence **is** strong.
- Much progress **has** been made.
- The traffic **is** heavy today.

The British-sense **plural of measurement** follows the countable unit: *Two pieces of advice **were** given. Three items of furniture **were** sold.*

Rule 25: Foreign (Latin / Greek) plurals → plural verb

Rule 25. Many nouns borrowed from Latin and Greek keep their foreign plurals, and those plurals take a **plural verb** in formal English.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
datum	data	syllabus	syllabi / syllabuses
criterion	criteria	crisis	crises
phenomenon	phenomena	analysis	analyses
medium	media	thesis	theses
curriculum	curricula	hypothesis	hypotheses
memorandum	memoranda	basis	bases
bacterium	bacteria	oasis	oases
stratum	strata	axis	axes
alumnus	alumni	formula	formulae / formulas
stimulus	stimuli	index	indices / indexes
radius	radii	appendix	appendices
nucleus	nuclei	bureau	bureaux / bureaus
fungus	fungi		

- These data **are** reliable. (formal) / This data **is** reliable. (accepted in modern and computing English)
- The criteria for selection **are** strict. (✘ The criteria is)
- This criterion **is** important.
- These phenomena **are** rare. / This phenomenon **is** rare.

- The bacteria **multiply** quickly.
- The media **have** a great influence. (formal) / The media **has** … (modern, accepted)
- The crises **were** handled well.
- The alumni of DU **are** meeting today.

> **GRE / GMAT note:** *Criteria* and *phenomena* are **always plural** — a common trap. *Data* and *media* are accepted with both, but the GMAT tends to treat *data* as plural in formal contexts. If an answer choice says *"the criteria is"*, it is wrong.

23.8 Quantities, Amounts and Numbers

Rule 26: Amount of time, money, distance, weight as one sum → singular

> **Rule 26.** When a plural noun of **time, money, distance, weight, volume, or measurement** is thought of as **one total amount**, the verb is **singular**.

- Ten miles **is** a long distance.
- Five hundred taka **is** too much for this shirt.
- Two thousand dollars **is** a big sum.
- Five years **is** a long time.
- Fifty kilograms **is** too heavy for a child to carry.
- Two hours **is** enough to finish the exam.
- Twenty litres of water **is** required every day.
- Three-fourths of the distance **has** been covered.

But when the units are thought of **separately (one by one)**, the verb is **plural**:

- Five years **have** passed since his death. (years passing one after another)
- Ten taka coins **were** scattered on the floor.
- Many miles **were** walked by the pilgrims.
- Two hours **have** passed since he left.

Rule 27: Arithmetic

In addition and multiplication, both singular and plural verbs are used; in subtraction and division, the singular is used.

- Two and two **make/makes** four. (both accepted; *make* is more common in BCS keys)
- Five times six **is/are** thirty.
- Ten minus four **is** six.
- Twenty divided by five **is** four.
- Six multiplied by two **is** twelve.

Rule 28: Fractions and percentages → follow the noun after *of*

> **Rule 28.** With **fractions, percentages, proportions** (two-thirds of, half of, 50 percent of, a quarter of, a proportion of, a part of), the verb agrees with the **noun after *of***.

- Two-thirds of the land **is** under water.
- Two-thirds of the people **are** illiterate.
- Fifty percent of the work **has** been completed.
- Fifty percent of the workers **have** joined the strike.
- A quarter of the cake **was** eaten.
- Three-quarters of the students **were** present.
- One-third of the mangoes **are** rotten.
- Forty percent of the population **lives/live** in villages. (*population* is collective; singular is preferred, plural acceptable)
- What percentage of students **were** successful?

Rule 29: *One and a half* and decimal numbers

Expressions like *one and a half* refer to more than one but traditional grammar treats the head (*one*) as decisive: **one and a half + plural noun + singular verb** when seen as an amount. Many modern grammars accept a plural verb. The safest exam answer:

- One and a half hours **is** enough. (amount → singular)
- One and a half years **has** passed since then. (traditional) / **have** passed (modern)
- 1.5 kilograms **is** the weight of the parcel.
- 0.5 percent **is** a small amount.

Rule 30: Numbers as names, titles, words, letters

When a number, word, letter or phrase is mentioned **as a word**, it is singular.

- "Seven" **is** a lucky number for some people.
- "Ps and Qs" **is** an idiom meaning manners.
- Two **is** an even number.
- "Mice" **is** the plural of "mouse".

23.9 Titles, Names and Special Subjects

Rule 31: Titles of books, films, newspapers, songs → singular

> **Rule 31.** The **title** of a book, film, play, newspaper, magazine, song or painting is **singular** even if it is plural in form — because it is the name of **one** work.

- *The Arabian Nights* **is** an interesting book. (✘ are)
- *Gulliver's Travels* **was** written by Jonathan Swift.
- *Great Expectations* **is** a novel by Charles Dickens.
- *The Canterbury Tales* **was** written by Chaucer.
- *Sons and Lovers* **is** a novel by D. H. Lawrence.
- *The Daily Star* **is** a popular English daily.
- *Romeo and Juliet* **is** a tragedy by Shakespeare.
- *The Three Musketeers* **is** an adventure novel.
- *The Times* **has** published the report.

Rule 32: Names of countries, organisations, firms

Names of countries, states, organisations and companies that look plural are **singular** because each is one unit.

- The United States **is** a powerful country.
- The Netherlands **is** famous for tulips.
- The Philippines **is** an island nation.
- The United Nations **was** founded in 1945.
- Ahmed and Sons **is** a well-known firm.
- General Motors **has** opened a new plant.
- The Maldives **is** a beautiful tourist destination.

Note: When we mean the islands themselves, plural is possible: *The Maldives **are** a chain of coral islands.*

Rule 33: *The + adjective* → plural verb (when it means a class of people)

> **Rule 33.** When an adjective is used with *the* to mean a **group/class of people**, it is **plural**: **the rich, the poor, the old, the young, the sick, the blind, the deaf, the dead, the wounded, the unemployed, the educated, the honest, the brave, the wise, the injured.**

- The rich **are** not always happy.
- The poor **are** getting poorer.
- The wounded **were** taken to hospital.
- The young **have** a duty to the old.
- The honest **are** respected everywhere.
- The brave **deserve** the fair.

But when *the + adjective* refers to an **abstract quality** or a **single person**, use a **singular** verb:

- The beautiful **is** not always good. (abstract quality, *beauty*)
- The unknown **is** always frightening.
- The impossible **has** happened.
- The accused **was** acquitted. (one person; *the accused were* if more than one)
- The deceased **was** a teacher.

Nationalities ending in *-sh, -ch, -ese, -ss* (*the English, the French, the Dutch, the Chinese, the Japanese, the Swiss*) are plural: *The English **are** a practical people. The Japanese **are** hard-working.*

23.10 Subject and Complement

Rule 34: The verb agrees with the subject, not the complement

> **Rule 34.** A **linking verb** (*be, become, seem, remain*) agrees with its **subject** (the word before it in a normal statement), **not** with the complement (the word after it).

- Our only hope **is** your sons. (subject = *hope*)
- Your sons **are** our only hope. (subject = *sons*)
- The main problem **was** the floods.
- The floods **were** the main problem.
- His greatest strength **is** his teammates.
- Bad roads **are** the main cause of accidents.
- The main cause of accidents **is** bad roads.
- Books **are** my best friend.
- My best friend **is** books.

Rule 35: "It" as a dummy (anticipatory) subject → always singular

- It **is** the students who **are** protesting. (*It is* singular; *who are* agrees with *students*)
- It **was** the floods that **destroyed** the crops.
- It **is** they who **are** responsible.

23.11 Distributive, Partitive and Comparative Structures

Rule 36: *Kind of / sort of / type of*

> **Rule 36. This/That + kind (sort, type) of + singular noun + singular verb; These/Those + kinds (sorts, types) of + plural noun + plural verb.**

- This kind of book **is** useful. (✘ These kind of books are)
- These kinds of books **are** useful.
- That type of man **is** dangerous.
- Those types of men **are** dangerous.
- What sort of people **are** they?

In informal speech, "*these kind of things*" is common, but it is **wrong** in exams.

Rule 37: Comparisons do not change the subject

Words introduced by *than* or *as…as* do not affect the verb.

- My brother, more than my sisters, **likes** music.
- She is taller than her sisters **are**. (verb agrees with *sisters*)
- Rahim works harder than his friends **do**.
- He sings better than I **do**. (✘ better than me do)

Rule 38: *A great deal of / A large amount of / Much / Little / Less* → singular

- A great deal of money **has** been spent.
- A large amount of rice **is** wasted every year.
- Much water **has** flowed under the bridge.
- Little knowledge **is** a dangerous thing.
- Less work **is** required now.

Compare: *A large number of trees **were** cut down.* (countable → plural)

Rule 39: *Enough / Plenty / Lots / Heaps* → follow the noun

- Lots of food **is** available. / Lots of people **are** coming.
- Plenty of money **is** needed. / Plenty of jobs **are** available.
- Enough rice **is** stored. / Enough chairs **are** available.

23.12 Special Verb Forms Affecting Agreement

Rule 40: The subjunctive breaks the normal agreement

The **subjunctive mood** uses the **base form** of the verb (no -s) and **were** for all persons in unreal conditions. It is tested in GMAT, GRE and BCS.

(a) Unreal / hypothetical *were*:

- If I **were** a bird, I would fly. (✘ If I was a bird — informal)
- If he **were** rich, he would help the poor.
- I wish I **were** a king.
- He talks as if he **were** the owner.
- Suppose she **were** here, what would you say?

(b) Mandative (formal) subjunctive after verbs and expressions of demand, suggestion, order, necessity — *suggest, recommend, insist, demand, require, propose, request, order, urge, it is essential/necessary/important/vital/imperative that*:

- The teacher suggested that he **attend** the class regularly. (✘ attends)
- The doctor recommended that she **take** rest.
- It is essential that every student **submit** the form today.
- The court ordered that the prisoner **be** released.
- They demanded that the manager **resign**.
- I insist that he **leave** at once.
- It is important that she **be** present.

> **GMAT Corner:** After *require, demand, insist, recommend, suggest, request*, the GMAT expects the **bare subjunctive**: *"The law requires that every driver **carry** a licence"* — **not** *carries*, **not** *should carry* (often marked wordy) and **not** *to carry* after *that*. Also remember: *"require X to do"* (infinitive) is fine without *that*.

(c) Formulaic subjunctive in fixed wishes and prayers:

- God **bless** you. (✘ blesses)
- Long **live** Bangladesh! (✘ lives)
- God **save** the King.
- Heaven **help** us.
- Be that as it **may**…

Rule 41: Verb after *Let's / Let him* etc.

After *let*, the verb is in the bare form: *Let him **go**. Let them **come**. Let us **work** hard.* (✘ Let him goes.)

Rule 42: Verb after "*Who / What / Which*" as subjects in questions

Who and *what* used as subjects generally take a **singular** verb unless the answer is clearly expected to be plural.

- Who **is** there? (✘ Who are there — unless you know there are several persons)
- Who **are** those people?
- What **is** the matter?
- What **are** your plans? (subject = *your plans*)
- Which of these books **is** yours? (one book expected)
- Which of these books **are** yours? (more than one expected)

23.13 Pronoun–Antecedent Agreement

Agreement is not only between subject and verb. **A pronoun must also agree with the noun it refers to (its antecedent)** in number, person and gender. This topic is closely related and is heavily tested on the SAT and GMAT, and in BCS "error detection" items.

Rule 43: Singular antecedent → singular pronoun

- Every student must bring **his or her** own pen. (formal)
- Each of the boys has done **his** duty. (✘ their duty in formal exams)
- Everyone should love **his** country. (traditional) / **their** country (modern, gender-neutral; accepted by SAT style rules today)
- Neither of the girls has finished **her** homework.
- Many a man has lost **his** life.
- One should do **one's** duty. (✘ one should do his duty in strict British usage; American English accepts *his*)

> **Singular "they":** Modern English (and the College Board/SAT) accepts *they/their* for an indefinite person: *Someone left **their** umbrella.* But a **collective noun used as a unit** or a **named thing** must not take *they*: ✘ *The company announced **their** profits.* ✔ *The company announced **its** profits.* In BCS and Bank exams, prefer the traditional *his / his or her* with *each, every, everyone, everybody, anybody, nobody*.

Rule 44: Compound antecedents

- Joined by *and* → plural pronoun: *Rahim and Karim did **their** best.*
- Joined by *or/nor* → nearest antecedent: *Neither the teacher nor the students raised **their** hands. Neither the students nor the teacher raised **his** hand.*
- *As well as / with* → first antecedent: *The captain, as well as the players, did **his** best.*

Rule 45: Collective antecedents

The pronoun must follow the same logic as the verb: *The jury **has** given **its** verdict. / The jury **are** divided in **their** opinions.* (Never: *The jury has given their verdict.*)

23.14 Agreement in Sentences with *There* and Compound Subjects

Rule 46: *There is / There are* with compound subjects

When a compound subject follows *there*, formal grammar uses a **plural** verb. However, many grammars and native speakers use a **singular** verb when the **first noun is singular** (proximity). For exam purposes:

- There **are** a pen and two pencils in the box. (formal / safest with *and*)
- There **is** a pen and two pencils in the box. (accepted informally — proximity)
- There **are** two pencils and a pen in the box. (first noun plural → plural, no debate)
- There **is** a lot of work to do.
- There **are** a lot of mistakes.
- There **is** no one in the room.
- There **is** no water in the bottle. / There **are** no books on the shelf.
- There **is** more than one reason. (*more than one* → singular)

Rule 47: Agreement in correlative sentences with *as well as* at the start

When *as well as* begins the sentence, the subject after it is still the main one:

- As well as his brother, Rahim **is** coming.
- Along with his friends, the boy **was** arrested.
- In addition to the manager, the clerks **were** absent.

23.15 Agreement of Tense and Number in Complex Sentences

Rule 48: Each clause has its own subject

In complex and compound sentences, **each verb agrees with its own subject**, not with the main subject of the sentence.

- The boy who **plays** the guitar **lives** next door.
- The man whose sons **are** doctors **is** my uncle.
- I know that the students **are** ready and that the teacher **is** coming.
- The book I gave to the girls **was** expensive.
- The girls I gave the book to **were** happy.
- Everyone thinks that the questions **were** difficult.

Rule 49: Parallel verbs share the same subject

When one subject has two or more verbs, **all** must agree.

- She **reads**, **writes** and **speaks** English fluently. (✘ She reads, write and speaks)
- The students **have** completed the work and **are** waiting for the results.
- He neither **drinks** nor **smokes**.

23.16 Miscellaneous Rules Frequently Tested in Bangladesh

Rule 50: *Each other / one another* do not affect agreement

They love each other. We help one another. The verb agrees with *they/we*.

Rule 51: *Nobody but / No one except / Nothing but* → singular

- Nobody but the teachers **was** present. (✘ were)
- No one except his parents **knows** the truth.
- Nothing but leaves **was** found on the tree.
- Nothing but trees **is** seen here.

Rule 52: *Not one of / Not a single* → singular

- Not one of the students **has** done the homework.
- Not a single tree **was** left standing.

Rule 53: Infinitive or bare verb after certain verbs

Verbs after *to* never change: *He wants **to go**.* (✘ to goes) After auxiliaries *do/does/did*, use the base form: *He **does not know**.* (✘ does not knows) *Did she **come**?* (✘ did she came) These are "agreement" errors frequently placed in Right-Form-of-Verb items.

Rule 54: *The + superlative* + plural noun + relative clause

*He is the best of all the players who **have** played here.* The relative clause refers to *players* (plural).

Rule 55: *Either / Neither* as determiners

Either and *neither* before a noun take a **singular noun** and a **singular verb**: *Neither answer **is** correct. Either side **is** acceptable.* (✘ Neither answers are correct.)

Rule 56: "*A* + adjective + *number / few / many*"

A good many / a great many / a few / a large number → plural. *A great deal / a large amount / a little / a good deal* → singular.

Rule 57: Distributive *every* with numbers

Every can be followed by a number and a plural noun to show regular intervals: *every two days, every three hours, every five years.* Here the time expression is usually an adverbial, not the subject, so the verb agrees with the real subject: *Every three hours, a bus **leaves** the terminal. The census **is** held every ten years.*

Rule 58: Double subjects with *and* in negative form

Not only… but also follows proximity (Rule 6). But "*X, and not Y*" follows **X** (Rule 5): *The students, and not the teacher, **are** responsible.*

Rule 59: Hyphenated compound adjectives do not take plural

A number used as part of a compound adjective before a noun stays singular: *a five-year plan* (✘ five-years plan), *a ten-taka note* (✘ ten-takas note), *a two-mile walk, a three-day tour*. This is closely related to agreement and is a very common BCS error item.

- He made a ten-minute speech. (✘ ten-minutes speech)
- She has a five-year-old son. (✘ five-years-old son)
- Bangladesh launched its first five-year plan in 1973.

Rule 60: Nouns of number after a numeral: *dozen, score, hundred, thousand, million, pair, stone, head (of cattle), gross*

When these words follow a definite number, they take **no -s**: *two dozen eggs, three hundred people, five thousand taka, four score years, ten head of cattle.* (✘ two dozens eggs). With *of* and no number, -s is used: *dozens of eggs, hundreds of people, thousands of taka.*

- Two dozen pens **were** bought.
- Three hundred students **are** taking the test.
- Dozens of people **were** injured.
- Millions of people **live** in Dhaka.

23.17 Common Error Patterns: Incorrect vs Correct

The following sentences show the errors that appear most often in Bangladeshi competitive exams and in the error-identification sections of the SAT and GMAT. Study the reason for each correction.

1. ✘ The news are very sad. ✔ The news **is** very sad. — *news* is singular.
2. ✘ Each of the students have a book. ✔ Each of the students **has** a book. — *each* is singular.
3. ✘ Neither of the two boys were present. ✔ Neither of the two boys **was** present.
4. ✘ One of my friend is a doctor. ✔ One of my **friends** is a doctor.
5. ✘ The number of students are increasing. ✔ The number of students **is** increasing.

6. ✘ A number of boys was absent. ✔ A number of boys **were** absent.
7. ✘ Many a boys were present. ✔ Many a **boy was** present.
8. ✘ The police has arrested the thief. ✔ The police **have** arrested the thief.
9. ✘ The cattle is grazing. ✔ The cattle **are** grazing.
10. ✘ Mathematics are a difficult subject. ✔ Mathematics **is** a difficult subject.
11. ✘ The teacher as well as his students were present. ✔ … **was** present.
12. ✘ Either Rahim or his brothers has done it. ✔ … **have** done it.
13. ✘ Neither he nor I are guilty. ✔ Neither he nor I **am** guilty.
14. ✘ It is I who is to blame. ✔ It is I who **am** to blame.
15. ✘ He is one of the best boys who has ever studied here. ✔ … who **have** ever studied here.
16. ✘ He is the only one of the boys who have passed. ✔ … who **has** passed.
17. ✘ Bread and butter are his daily food. ✔ Bread and butter **is** his daily food.
18. ✘ Slow and steady win the race. ✔ Slow and steady **wins** the race.
19. ✘ The poet and the philosopher is dead. ✔ … **are** dead. (two persons) / The poet and philosopher **is** dead. (one person)
20. ✘ Every boy and girl were present. ✔ Every boy and girl **was** present.
21. ✘ Ten miles are a long distance. ✔ Ten miles **is** a long distance.
22. ✘ The Arabian Nights are a famous book. ✔ The Arabian Nights **is** a famous book.
23. ✘ The rich is not always happy. ✔ The rich **are** not always happy.
24. ✘ My trouser is torn. ✔ My **trousers are** torn.
25. ✘ A pair of shoes were bought. ✔ A pair of shoes **was** bought.
26. ✘ The furnitures are expensive. ✔ The **furniture is** expensive.
27. ✘ He gave me many advices. ✔ He gave me **much advice / many pieces of advice**.
28. ✘ The criteria is unclear. ✔ The criteria **are** unclear.
29. ✘ These kind of books are useful. ✔ **This kind of book is** useful. / **These kinds of books are** useful.
30. ✘ Everybody have done their duty. ✔ Everybody **has** done **his/his or her** duty.
31. ✘ More than one boys were absent. ✔ More than one **boy was** absent.
32. ✘ Two-thirds of the city are flooded. ✔ Two-thirds of the city **is** flooded.
33. ✘ Most of the milk have gone bad. ✔ Most of the milk **has** gone bad.
34. ✘ There is many mistakes in the letter. ✔ There **are** many mistakes in the letter.
35. ✘ Where is my glasses? ✔ Where **are** my glasses?
36. ✘ The quality of the products are poor. ✔ The quality of the products **is** poor.
37. ✘ The committee have submitted its report. ✔ The committee **has** submitted its report.
38. ✘ If I was a king, I would help the poor. ✔ If I **were** a king, …
39. ✘ I suggested that he goes home. ✔ I suggested that he **go** home.
40. ✘ He has a ten-years-old son. ✔ He has a **ten-year-old** son.
41. ✘ Two dozens eggs were bought. ✔ Two **dozen** eggs were bought.
42. ✘ The people is happy. ✔ The people **are** happy.
43. ✘ Either of these five roads lead to the city. ✔ **Any one** of these five roads **leads** to the city.
44. ✘ Nobody but the boys were punished. ✔ Nobody but the boys **was** punished.
45. ✘ What he says are true. ✔ What he says **is** true.
46. ✘ Long lives Bangladesh! ✔ Long **live** Bangladesh!
47. ✘ The leader, with his followers, were arrested. ✔ … **was** arrested.
48. ✘ Physics are my favourite subject. ✔ Physics **is** my favourite subject.
49. ✘ The sheeps are grazing. ✔ The **sheep** are grazing.
50. ✘ Measles are a contagious disease. ✔ Measles **is** a contagious disease.

23.18 A Step-by-Step Method for Any Agreement Question

When you face any agreement item in an exam, follow these steps in order:

1. **Find the verb(s)** in the sentence. Underline every finite verb (*is, are, was, were, has, have, does, do* and present-tense main verbs).
2. **Find the true subject** of each verb. Cross out prepositional phrases (*of…, in…, with…*), appositives and relative clauses. Look *after* the verb in sentences beginning with *There/Here*, in questions and in inverted sentences.
3. **Check the joining words.** *And* → usually plural (but check Rules 2, 3, 4). *Or/nor/either…or/neither…nor/not only…but also* → nearer subject. *As well as/with/along with/together with/besides* → first subject.
4. **Check special words.** Is the subject an indefinite pronoun (each, every, either, neither, everyone, none, all, some, most)? A collective noun? A noun of the *news/mathematics/measles* type? An uncountable noun? A *people/police/cattle* type noun? A Latin plural?
5. **Check amounts and titles.** Money, time, distance and weight as one sum → singular. Titles of books and names of countries → singular. Fractions → follow the noun after *of*.
6. **Check the relative clause.** *Who/which/that* → agrees with its antecedent (and in person: *I who am, you who are*). *One of the … who* → plural; *the only one of the … who* → singular.
7. **Check the mood.** *If I were / I wish I were*; mandative *that he go / that she be*; *Long live, God bless*.
8. **Check the pronouns.** A pronoun referring back to the subject must match it (*the committee … its; each … his*).

> **Final Advice:** Read the sentence **aloud in your mind without the extra words**. *"The box ~~of old and rusty iron nails~~ is heavy."* Once the "noise" is removed, the correct agreement becomes obvious. This single habit will solve more than half of all agreement questions in BCS, Bank, admission, SAT, GRE and GMAT papers.

PART B

Vocabulary & Usage

Chapters 45 – 53

Synonyms and antonyms, spelling, phrasal verbs, idioms, foreign phrases, one-word substitution, analogy, confusable words and proverbs.

CHAPTER 45

Vocabulary with Synonyms & Antonyms

Part B · Vocabulary

45.1 What Are Synonyms and Antonyms?

A **synonym** is a word that has the **same or nearly the same meaning** as another word in a particular context. *Big* and *large*, *begin* and *commence*, *brave* and *courageous* are synonyms.

An **antonym** is a word that has the **opposite meaning** of another word. *Big* and *small*, *begin* and *end*, *brave* and *cowardly* are antonyms.

In the Preliminary tests of BCS, in Bank recruitment tests (Officer, Senior Officer, Cash, AD of Bangladesh Bank), in university admission tests and in the verbal sections of the SAT, GRE and GMAT, vocabulary is tested directly (*"Choose the word closest in meaning to …"* or *"The antonym of … is"*) and indirectly through sentence completion, reading comprehension, analogy and one-word substitution. A strong vocabulary therefore pays off across many sections at once.

45.1.1 Perfect Synonyms Are Rare

Very few words mean **exactly** the same thing in every context. Most synonyms differ in **degree**, **tone (connotation)**, **formality** or **usage**:

- **Degree:** *dislike → hate → abhor → loathe* (each is stronger than the last). *Happy → glad → elated → ecstatic.*
- **Connotation (positive / negative feeling):** *thrifty* (good: careful with money) vs *stingy / miserly* (bad: unwilling to spend). *Confident* (good) vs *arrogant* (bad). *Curious* (neutral/good) vs *nosy* (bad).
- **Formality:** *buy* (everyday) vs *purchase* (formal); *begin* vs *commence*; *end* vs *terminate*.
- **Usage / collocation:** We say *a large amount* but *a big mistake*; *heavy rain*, not *strong rain*; *strong tea*, not *powerful tea*.

So, in an exam, you are not looking for a "perfect" synonym — you are looking for the option that is **closest** in meaning **in that context**.

45.1.2 Kinds of Antonyms

1. **Complementary (absolute) antonyms** — one excludes the other: *alive / dead, true / false, pass / fail, present / absent.*
2. **Gradable antonyms** — two ends of a scale with middle points: *hot / cold* (warm, cool in between), *rich / poor, young / old, large / small.*
3. **Relational (converse) antonyms** — one implies the other: *buy / sell, teacher / student, give / receive, husband / wife, above / below.*
4. **Antonyms made with prefixes** — *happy / unhappy, legal / illegal, possible / impossible, regular / irregular, honest / dishonest, sense / nonsense, understand / misunderstand.*

45.2 How to Solve Synonym and Antonym Questions

45.2.1 Ten Golden Strategies

1. **Know the part of speech.** A synonym must be the same part of speech as the question word. If the word is a verb (*abate*), the answer must be a verb (*diminish*), not a noun (*diminution*).
2. **Make a sentence.** Put the word into a short sentence of your own, then replace it with each option. The one that keeps the meaning is right. *The storm **abated**. → The storm **subsided**.* ✔
3. **Use roots, prefixes and suffixes.** *Bene-* = good (benevolent, benefactor); *mal-* = bad (malevolent, malice); *-cide* = killing (homicide); *omni-* = all (omnipotent); *loqu/locu* = speak (loquacious, eloquent); *chron* = time (chronic, chronology). (See Chapter 40 for a full list.)
4. **Decide the "charge".** Is the word positive (+) or negative (−)? A positive word cannot have a negative synonym, and its antonym must be negative. *Laudable* (+) → synonym *praiseworthy* (+); antonym *contemptible* (−).
5. **Eliminate wrong options.** Remove options that are unrelated, that are the wrong part of speech, or that are synonyms when the question asks for antonyms (a very common trap: test-makers deliberately place a synonym among the antonym options).
6. **Watch the "related but not equal" trap.** For *frugal*, the option *poor* is related but wrong; *thrifty* is correct. For *verbose*, the option *verbal* is a look-alike trap; *wordy* is correct.
7. **Look-alike (homonym) traps.** *Eminent* (famous) vs *imminent* (about to happen); *elicit* (draw out) vs *illicit* (illegal); *complement* vs *compliment*; *venal* (corrupt) vs *venial* (forgivable). (See Chapter 52.)
8. **Multiple meanings.** *Grave* = serious (adj) or tomb (n); *Fair* = just / light-coloured / an exhibition; *Sound* = healthy / noise / a narrow sea channel. Choose the meaning that matches the options.
9. **Know common "false friends".** Some words look as if they mean one thing but mean another (see 45.2.3).
10. **Read widely and revise often.** Reading an English daily (editorials), magazines and good novels, and revising word lists in small daily doses, is the only long-term solution.

> **Exam Tip — The "opposite" options trick:** In an MCQ for antonyms, if two options are opposites of each other (e.g. *praise* and *criticise*), the answer is very often one of them. In a synonym question, if two options mean the same thing as each other, usually **neither** is the answer (because only one answer can be right).

45.2.2 Contronyms (Words That Are Their Own Opposites)

Some English words have two meanings that are opposite to each other. The GRE and SAT love them.

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Sanction	to approve / permit	a penalty / to punish
Cleave	to split apart	to stick closely to
Oversight	supervision	a mistake of not noticing
Dust	to remove dust	to sprinkle powder on
Left	departed	remaining
Fast	moving quickly	fixed firmly, not moving
Bolt	to fasten / lock	to run away suddenly
Screen	to show (a film)	to hide / shield
Weather	to wear away	to come through safely
Trim	to cut off	to add decorations
Garnish	to decorate food	to take money (wages) by law
Fine	excellent	a penalty
Overlook	to supervise / look over	to fail to notice
Temper	to soften / moderate	to harden (steel) / anger

45.2.3 False Friends (Commonly Misunderstood Words)

Word	It does NOT mean	It actually means
Enervate	energise	weaken, drain of energy
Noisome	noisy	offensive, foul-smelling
Restive	restful	restless, impatient
Fulsome	full, plentiful	excessive and insincere (praise)
Nonplussed	calm, unbothered	puzzled, confused
Disinterested	uninterested	impartial, unbiased
Enormity	enormousness	great wickedness
Peruse	skim quickly	read carefully
Ingenuous	ingenious	innocent, frank, naive
Prodigal	prodigy	wasteful, extravagant
Sanguine	bloody	optimistic, hopeful
Inflammable	not flammable	easily set on fire
Bemused	amused	bewildered, confused
Notorious	famous (good)	famous for something bad
Presently	(always) now	soon, shortly (BrE); now (AmE)
Officious	official	too eager to give orders/advice
Pristine	old	spotless, in original condition
Plethora	small amount	excess, too much
Temerity	timidity	reckless boldness
Factious	factual	causing disagreement
Fortuitous	fortunate	happening by chance
Histrionic	historic	overly dramatic
Penury	penalty	extreme poverty
Ravenous	ravishing	extremely hungry
Tortuous	torturous	twisting, winding

45.2.4 Forming Antonyms with Prefixes and Suffixes

Prefix / Suffix	Examples
un-	able–unable, fair–unfair, kind–unkind, known–unknown
in-	active–inactive, correct–incorrect, sane–insane, visible–invisible
im- (before b, m, p)	balance–imbalance, mature–immature, polite–impolite, possible–impossible
il- (before l)	legal–illegal, legible–illegible, literate–illiterate, logical–illogical
ir- (before r)	rational–irrational, regular–irregular, relevant–irrelevant, responsible–irresponsible
dis-	agree–disagree, honest–dishonest, obey–disobey, order–disorder
mis-	fortune–misfortune, understand–misunderstand, use–misuse
non-	sense–nonsense, violent–nonviolent, existent–nonexistent
anti- / counter-	social–antisocial, clockwise–anticlockwise, act–counteract
mal-	function–malfunction, nutrition–malnutrition, treat–maltreat
-ful / -less	careful–careless, useful–useless, hopeful–hopeless, meaningful–meaningless

> **Careful:** Not every *in-* word is negative. *Inflammable* = flammable; *invaluable* = extremely valuable (✘ not "without value"); *inhabit* = live in. And *valuable / invaluable* are near-synonyms, not antonyms — the antonym of *valuable* is *worthless*.

45.3 The Master Word List

How to use this list. Each entry gives: the **word**, its **part of speech** — *(n)* noun, *(v)* verb, *(adj)* adjective, *(adv)* adverb — its **Bangla meaning**, a simple **English meaning**, **SYN** (synonyms), **ANT** (antonyms) and an **example** sentence. A star ★ marks words that appear **very frequently** in Bangladeshi competitive exams. A GRE tag marks advanced words especially common in the SAT, GRE and GMAT. Learn the example sentence along with the word: words are remembered best in context.

A

Abandon ★ *(v)* পরিত্যাগ করা — to leave completely and for ever.
SYN desert, forsake, quit, relinquish, renounce. ANT keep, retain, maintain, adopt, cherish. *Ex:* The crew abandoned the sinking ship.

Abase *(v)* হেয় করা, মর্যাদা হ্রাস করা — to lower in rank or dignity.
SYN degrade, humiliate, demean, belittle. ANT elevate, exalt, honour, dignify. *Ex:* He would not abase himself by begging for favours.

Abate ★ *(v)* কমা, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to become less strong or intense.
SYN subside, diminish, decrease, wane, ebb, lessen. ANT increase, intensify, aggravate, augment. *Ex:* The storm abated by evening.

Abdicate *(v)* সিংহাসন বা পদ ত্যাগ করা — to give up a throne, power or responsibility. SYN renounce, resign, relinquish, abandon. ANT assume, usurp, claim, retain. *Ex:* Edward VIII abdicated the British throne in 1936.

Aberration GRE *(n)* বিচ্যুতি, স্বাভাবিকতা থেকে সরে যাওয়া — a departure from what is normal. SYN deviation, anomaly, irregularity, abnormality. ANT norm, regularity, conformity. *Ex:* His rude remark was an aberration from his usual polite behaviour.

Abeyance *(n)* স্থগিত অবস্থা — a state of temporary suspension. SYN suspension, dormancy, pause, latency. ANT operation, continuation, activity. *Ex:* The project is in abeyance until funds are found.

Abhor ★ *(v)* ঘৃণা করা — to hate very strongly. SYN detest, loathe, abominate, despise, execrate. ANT love, adore, admire, cherish. *Ex:* Every civilised person abhors cruelty.

Abject *(adj)* হীন, শোচনীয় — extremely bad, miserable or humiliating. SYN wretched, miserable, pitiful, degraded, base. ANT dignified, proud, noble, exalted. *Ex:* The refugees lived in abject poverty.

Abjure GRE *(v)* শপথপূর্বক ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up a belief or claim. SYN renounce, recant, forswear, repudiate. ANT affirm, embrace, uphold, espouse. *Ex:* He abjured his former political views.

Abolish ★ *(v)* বিলোপ করা — to end a law, system or custom officially. SYN eradicate, annul, abrogate, repeal, revoke. ANT establish, institute, create, found. *Ex:* Slavery was abolished in the British Empire in 1833.

Abominable *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য, জঘন্য — causing disgust or hatred. SYN detestable, loathsome, odious, atrocious, vile. ANT admirable, delightful, pleasant, lovable. *Ex:* The prisoners were kept in abominable conditions.

Abortive *(adj)* ব্যর্থ, নিষ্ফল — failing to produce the intended result. SYN unsuccessful, futile, fruitless, vain. ANT successful, fruitful, effective. *Ex:* They made an abortive attempt to escape.

Abound *(v)* প্রচুর পরিমাণে থাকা — to exist in large numbers. SYN teem, overflow, proliferate, swarm. ANT lack, be scarce, dwindle. *Ex:* Fish abound in the rivers of Bangladesh.

Abridge ★ *(v)* সংক্ষেপ করা — to shorten a text without losing its sense. SYN shorten, condense, abbreviate, curtail, truncate. ANT expand, lengthen, elaborate, amplify. *Ex:* This is an abridged edition of the novel.

Abrogate GRE *(v)* বাতিল করা, রদ করা — to cancel a law or agreement formally. SYN repeal, revoke, annul, nullify, rescind. ANT enact, ratify, establish, uphold. *Ex:* The new government abrogated the treaty.

Abrupt *(adj)* আকস্মিক; রূঢ় — sudden and unexpected; rude and short in manner. SYN sudden, unexpected, hasty; curt, brusque. ANT gradual, expected; polite, courteous. *Ex:* The meeting came to an abrupt end.

Absolve *(v)* দায়মুক্ত করা, ক্ষমা করা — to declare free from guilt or blame. SYN acquit, exonerate, pardon, forgive, exculpate. ANT condemn, convict, blame, accuse. *Ex:* The court absolved him of all charges.

Abstain ★ *(v)* বিরত থাকা — to keep oneself from doing something. SYN refrain, desist, forgo, avoid, eschew. ANT indulge, participate, partake. *Ex:* Muslims abstain from food and drink while fasting.

Abstruse GRE *(adj)* দুর্বোধ্য — very difficult to understand. SYN obscure, esoteric, recondite, arcane, incomprehensible. ANT clear, simple, lucid, obvious. *Ex:* The lecture on quantum theory was too abstruse for us.

Absurd *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক, হাস্যকর — completely unreasonable or silly. SYN ridiculous, preposterous, ludicrous, irrational, senseless. ANT sensible, logical, reasonable, rational. *Ex:* It is absurd to blame the weather for your laziness.

Abundant ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর — existing in large quantities. SYN plentiful, ample, copious, profuse, bountiful, plenteous. ANT scarce, scanty, meagre, sparse, deficient. *Ex:* Bangladesh has abundant water resources.

Abysmal *(adj)* অতি নিকৃষ্ট; অতল — extremely bad; immeasurably deep. SYN dreadful, appalling, awful; bottomless. ANT excellent, superb; shallow. *Ex:* The team's performance was abysmal.

Accede *(v)* সম্মত হওয়া; পদে আসীন হওয়া — to agree to a demand; to take office. SYN consent, assent, comply, acquiesce. ANT refuse, reject, deny, dissent. *Ex:* The authority acceded to the students' demands.

Acclaim *(v/n)* প্রশংসা করা; প্রশংসা — to praise publicly and enthusiastically. SYN applaud, hail, laud, commend, extol. ANT criticise, condemn, censure, denounce. *Ex:* The film was acclaimed by critics.

Accolade *(n)* সম্মাননা, প্রশংসা — an award or expression of praise. SYN honour, tribute, award, praise, distinction. ANT criticism, condemnation, censure. *Ex:* Winning the Nobel Prize is the highest accolade for a writer.

Accord *(n/v)* সম্মতি, ঐক্য; প্রদান করা — agreement; to give or grant. SYN agreement, harmony, concord, treaty; grant. ANT disagreement, discord, conflict; deny. *Ex:* The two parties signed a peace accord.

Acerbic GRE *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, কটু — sharp and bitter in speech or tone. SYN caustic, acrid, sarcastic, biting, trenchant. ANT mild, gentle, kind, sweet. *Ex:* The columnist is known for his acerbic wit.

Acme *(n)* শীর্ষবিন্দু, চূড়া — the highest point of achievement. SYN peak, pinnacle, zenith, apex, summit, culmination. ANT nadir, bottom, base, low point. *Ex:* He was at the acme of his career.

Acquiesce GRE *(v)* নীরবে মেনে নেওয়া — to accept something reluctantly without protest. SYN consent, comply, submit, accede, yield. ANT resist, protest, object, oppose. *Ex:* She acquiesced in her parents' decision.

Acquit ★ *(v)* খালাস দেওয়া — to declare someone not guilty. SYN absolve, exonerate, discharge, free, clear. ANT convict, condemn, sentence, punish. *Ex:* The jury acquitted the accused.

Acrimony *(n)* তিক্ততা — bitterness or ill feeling. SYN rancour, bitterness, animosity, hostility, resentment. ANT goodwill, harmony, friendliness, amity. *Ex:* The divorce was settled without acrimony.

Acumen *(n)* বিচক্ষণতা, তীক্ষ্ণবুদ্ধি — the ability to make good judgements quickly. SYN shrewdness, astuteness, insight, sagacity, keenness. ANT stupidity, ignorance, obtuseness. *Ex:* She has great business acumen.

Adamant ★ *(adj)* অনমনীয়, একগুঁয়ে — refusing to change one's mind. SYN unyielding, inflexible, obstinate, resolute, firm. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, pliant. *Ex:* He was adamant that he would not resign.

Adept *(adj)* দক্ষ — very skilled. SYN expert, proficient, skilful, adroit, accomplished. ANT inept, clumsy, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is adept at solving puzzles.

Adhere *(v)* লেগে থাকা, মেনে চলা — to stick to; to follow a rule or belief. SYN stick, cling; obey, follow, observe. ANT detach; disobey, violate, defy. *Ex:* All players must adhere to the rules.

Adjourn ★ *(v)* মুলতবি করা — to stop a meeting for a time. SYN postpone, suspend, defer, put off, prorogue. ANT continue, resume, convene. *Ex:* The court adjourned the hearing till Monday.

Admonish *(v)* মৃদু ভর্ৎসনা করা, সতর্ক করা — to warn or scold gently. SYN reprimand, rebuke, reprove, caution, chide. ANT praise, commend, approve, applaud. *Ex:* The teacher admonished the boy for being late.

Adroit *(adj)* চতুর, নিপুণ — clever or skilful in using hands or mind. SYN deft, dexterous, adept, skilful, nimble. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* He is an adroit negotiator.

Adulation *(n)* অতিরিক্ত প্রশংসা, তোষামোদ — excessive admiration or praise. SYN flattery, adoration, worship, fawning. ANT criticism, contempt, censure, disdain. *Ex:* The singer enjoyed the adulation of her fans.

Adversary *(n)* প্রতিপক্ষ, শত্রু — an opponent in a contest or conflict. SYN enemy, foe, opponent, rival, antagonist. ANT ally, friend, supporter, partner. *Ex:* He defeated his adversary in the election.

Adverse ★ *(adj)* প্রতিকূল — harmful or unfavourable. SYN unfavourable, hostile, detrimental, harmful, contrary. ANT favourable, beneficial, advantageous, propitious. *Ex:* The drug has no adverse effects.

Advocate *(v/n)* সমর্থন করা; উকিল — to support publicly; a supporter or lawyer. SYN support, champion, endorse, recommend; proponent. ANT oppose, discourage, criticise; opponent. *Ex:* She advocates free education for girls.

Affable *(adj)* অমায়িক, সদালাপী — friendly and easy to talk to. SYN amiable, genial, cordial, sociable, courteous. ANT unfriendly, surly, aloof, hostile. *Ex:* Our new manager is an affable man.

Affluent ★ *(adj)* ধনী, সচ্ছল — wealthy. SYN rich, prosperous, wealthy, well-off, opulent. ANT poor, needy, impoverished, indigent, destitute. *Ex:* Gulshan is an affluent area of Dhaka.

Aggravate ★ *(v)* আরও খারাপ করা — to make a problem worse; (informal) to annoy. SYN worsen, intensify, exacerbate, compound; irritate. ANT alleviate, ease, mitigate, improve; soothe. *Ex:* Smoking aggravated his illness.

Agile *(adj)* চটপটে — able to move quickly and easily. SYN nimble, quick, sprightly, lithe, spry. ANT clumsy, sluggish, stiff, awkward. *Ex:* The goalkeeper was remarkably agile.

Alacrity GRE *(n)* তৎপরতা, উৎসাহপূর্ণ দ্রুততা — eager and cheerful readiness. SYN eagerness, readiness, promptness, enthusiasm, zeal. ANT reluctance, apathy, slowness, sluggishness. *Ex:* She accepted the invitation with alacrity.

Alleviate ★ *(v)* লাঘব করা, উপশম করা — to make pain or a problem less severe. SYN relieve, ease, mitigate, allay, assuage, lessen. ANT aggravate, worsen, intensify, exacerbate. *Ex:* The government took steps to alleviate poverty.

Allure *(n/v)* আকর্ষণ; প্রলুব্ধ করা — attractiveness; to attract or tempt. SYN charm, attraction, appeal; entice, tempt, lure. ANT repulsion; repel, deter, disgust. *Ex:* The allure of city life draws many villagers to Dhaka.

Aloof *(adj)* নির্লিপ্ত, দূরত্ব বজায় রাখা — not friendly; keeping at a distance. SYN distant, detached, reserved, unsociable, remote. ANT friendly, sociable, warm, approachable. *Ex:* He remained aloof from party politics.

Altruistic *(adj)* পরার্থপর, পরহিতৈষী — caring unselfishly for others. SYN selfless, unselfish, philanthropic, benevolent, humane. ANT selfish, egoistic, self-centred, mean. *Ex:* Her altruistic work in the slums is admired.

Amalgamate *(v)* একত্রিত করা, মিশ্রিত করা — to combine into one. SYN merge, unite, combine, integrate, fuse. ANT separate, divide, split, disunite. *Ex:* The two banks amalgamated last year.

Ambiguous ★ *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থক, অস্পষ্ট — having more than one possible meaning. SYN equivocal, vague, unclear, obscure, cryptic. ANT clear, explicit, definite, unequivocal, lucid. *Ex:* His answer was deliberately ambiguous.

Ameliorate ★ GRE *(v)* উন্নত করা — to make something bad better. SYN improve, better, enhance, amend, reform. ANT worsen, deteriorate, aggravate, impair. *Ex:* Steps were taken to ameliorate the condition of the workers.

Amenable *(adj)* বাধ্য, সহজে রাজি — willing to accept or be influenced. SYN agreeable, compliant, cooperative, tractable, docile. ANT stubborn, obstinate, intractable, resistant. *Ex:* He is amenable to reason.

Amiable *(adj)* বন্ধুভাবাপন্ন, অমায়িক — friendly and pleasant (of a person). SYN affable, genial, friendly, good-natured, likeable. ANT unfriendly, hostile, disagreeable, surly. *Ex:* She is an amiable girl liked by all.

Amicable *(adj)* সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — friendly and without disagreement (of relations or agreements). SYN friendly, cordial, harmonious, peaceable. ANT hostile, antagonistic, unfriendly, acrimonious. *Ex:* The dispute was settled amicably.

Ample *(adj)* পর্যাপ্ত — more than enough. SYN plentiful, abundant, sufficient, copious, generous. ANT insufficient, scanty, meagre, inadequate. *Ex:* There is ample time to finish the work.

Anarchy *(n)* নৈরাজ্য — total lack of government or order. SYN lawlessness, chaos, disorder, turmoil, mayhem. ANT order, law, government, discipline. *Ex:* The country fell into anarchy after the coup.

Animosity *(n)* শত্রুতা, বিদ্বেষ — strong hostility. SYN enmity, hostility, hatred, antagonism, rancour. ANT friendship, goodwill, amity, sympathy. *Ex:* There is no personal animosity between the two leaders.

Annihilate *(v)* ধ্বংস করা, নিশ্চিহ্ন করা — to destroy completely. SYN destroy, obliterate, exterminate, eradicate, wipe out. ANT create, build, preserve, protect. *Ex:* The enemy forces were annihilated.

Anomaly GRE *(n)* অসংগতি, ব্যতিক্রম — something unusual or not expected. SYN irregularity, aberration, deviation, oddity, exception. ANT norm, rule, regularity, standard. *Ex:* The auditor found several anomalies in the accounts.

Antipathy *(n)* বিতৃষ্ণা, বিরাগ — a strong feeling of dislike. SYN aversion, hostility, dislike, repugnance, animosity. ANT sympathy, affection, liking, fondness. *Ex:* He has an antipathy to modern art.

Antiquated *(adj)* সেকেলে — old-fashioned or outdated. SYN obsolete, outdated, archaic, outmoded, old-fashioned. ANT modern, new, up-to-date, contemporary. *Ex:* The office still uses antiquated machines.

Apathy ★ *(n)* উদাসীনতা — lack of interest or concern. SYN indifference, unconcern, passivity, lethargy, listlessness. ANT interest, enthusiasm, concern, zeal, passion. *Ex:* Voter apathy led to a low turnout.

Appease *(v)* শান্ত করা, তুষ্ট করা — to calm someone by giving what they want. SYN pacify, placate, mollify, conciliate, soothe. ANT provoke, enrage, incite, antagonise. *Ex:* The ruler tried to appease the angry mob.

Apprehensive *(adj)* শঙ্কিত — anxious that something bad may happen. SYN anxious, worried, uneasy, fearful, nervous. ANT confident, calm, assured, carefree. *Ex:* She was apprehensive about the interview.

Arbitrary ★ *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছাচারী, খেয়ালখুশিমতো — based on personal whim, not reason or rule. SYN random, capricious, whimsical, despotic, unreasoned. ANT rational, reasoned, logical, systematic, lawful. *Ex:* The arbitrary arrest of journalists was condemned.

Arduous ★ *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, দুরূহ — requiring great effort. SYN laborious, strenuous, difficult, onerous, gruelling. ANT easy, effortless, simple, facile. *Ex:* Climbing Everest is an arduous task.

Arrogant ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — having an exaggerated sense of one's importance. SYN haughty, proud, conceited, overbearing, insolent. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* His arrogant behaviour annoyed everyone.

Articulate *(adj/v)* স্পষ্টভাষী; স্পষ্ট করে বলা — able to express ideas clearly; to express clearly. SYN eloquent, fluent, lucid; express, voice. ANT inarticulate, tongue-tied, incoherent. *Ex:* She is an articulate speaker.

Ascend *(v)* আরোহণ করা — to go up. SYN climb, rise, mount, soar, scale. ANT descend, fall, drop, sink. *Ex:* The plane ascended into the clouds.

Ascetic *(adj/n)* তপস্বী, সংযমী — practising severe self-discipline and avoiding pleasure. SYN austere, abstinent, self-denying; hermit, monk. ANT self-indulgent, hedonistic, sensual; hedonist. *Ex:* The monk led an ascetic life.

Assiduous GRE *(adj)* অধ্যবসায়ী, পরিশ্রমী — showing great care and persistence. SYN diligent, industrious, sedulous, painstaking, persevering. ANT lazy, negligent, careless, indolent. *Ex:* Assiduous study helped him top the exam.

Astute *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — clever at understanding situations and people. SYN shrewd, sharp, perceptive, sagacious, canny. ANT stupid, naive, foolish, obtuse. *Ex:* He is an astute politician.

Atrocious *(adj)* নৃশংস, জঘন্য — extremely cruel or very bad. SYN brutal, barbaric, heinous, monstrous, abominable. ANT kind, humane, admirable, pleasant. *Ex:* The army committed atrocious crimes in 1971.

Audacious *(adj)* দুঃসাহসী — very bold; willing to take risks (sometimes rudely bold). SYN daring, bold, fearless, intrepid; impudent. ANT timid, cautious, cowardly, meek. *Ex:* It was an audacious plan to cross the ocean on a raft.

Augment ★ *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা — to make larger or greater. SYN increase, enlarge, expand, boost, amplify, supplement. ANT decrease, reduce, diminish, curtail. *Ex:* He took a part-time job to augment his income.

Auspicious ★ *(adj)* শুভ, মাঙ্গলিক — showing signs of future success. SYN favourable, promising, propitious, fortunate, lucky. ANT inauspicious, ominous, unfavourable, sinister. *Ex:* Pahela Baishakh is an auspicious day for Bengalis.

Austere *(adj)* কঠোর, আড়ম্বরহীন — severe; simple and without comfort. SYN strict, stern, harsh; plain, spartan, frugal. ANT lenient, mild; luxurious, ornate, lavish. *Ex:* He lived an austere life in a small room.

Authentic *(adj)* প্রামাণিক, খাঁটি — genuine; real. SYN genuine, real, bona fide, true, reliable. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, bogus. *Ex:* This is an authentic painting by Zainul Abedin.

Avarice ★ *(n)* লোভ, অর্থলিপ্সা — extreme greed for wealth. SYN greed, cupidity, covetousness, rapacity, acquisitiveness. ANT generosity, liberality, charity, munificence. *Ex:* Avarice is the root of many evils.

Averse *(adj)* বিরূপ, অনিচ্ছুক — strongly disliking or opposed (to). SYN opposed, reluctant, unwilling, hostile, loath. ANT eager, keen, willing, inclined. *Ex:* He is not averse to hard work.

Avid *(adj)* আগ্রহী, উৎসুক — very enthusiastic. SYN keen, eager, ardent, passionate, zealous. ANT indifferent, apathetic, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* She is an avid reader of detective novels.

B

Baffle *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা, হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse completely. SYN puzzle, perplex, bewilder, confound, mystify. ANT clarify, enlighten, explain, elucidate. *Ex:* The magician's trick baffled the audience.

Banal GRE *(adj)* গতানুগতিক, মামুলি — so ordinary as to be boring. SYN trite, commonplace, hackneyed, clichéd, platitudinous, insipid. ANT original, novel, fresh, innovative, striking. *Ex:* The speech was full of banal remarks.

Baneful *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, অনিষ্টকর — harmful or destructive. SYN harmful, pernicious, deleterious, injurious, noxious. ANT beneficial, wholesome, salutary, harmless. *Ex:* Drugs have a baneful effect on the youth.

Barbarous *(adj)* বর্বর — extremely cruel; uncivilised. SYN savage, brutal, cruel, barbaric, uncivilised. ANT civilised, humane, cultured, gentle. *Ex:* It was a barbarous act of terrorism.

Barren ★ *(adj)* অনুর্বর, বন্ধ্যা — unable to produce crops or offspring. SYN infertile, sterile, arid, unproductive, desolate. ANT fertile, fruitful, productive, fecund, lush. *Ex:* The desert is a barren land.

Belie GRE *(v)* মিথ্যা প্রতিপন্ন করা, ভুল ধারণা দেওয়া — to give a false impression of; to show to be false. SYN contradict, disguise, misrepresent, refute. ANT reveal, confirm, attest, prove. *Ex:* His cheerful face belied his sorrow.

Belligerent ★ *(adj)* যুদ্ধংদেহী, কলহপ্রিয় — hostile and aggressive; engaged in war. SYN aggressive, hostile, bellicose, combative, pugnacious. ANT peaceful, friendly, conciliatory, pacific. *Ex:* The belligerent nations agreed to a ceasefire.

Benevolent ★ *(adj)* দয়ালু, পরোপকারী — kind and generous. SYN kind, charitable, generous, philanthropic, humane. ANT malevolent, cruel, unkind, spiteful. *Ex:* The benevolent man built a school for poor children.

Benign *(adj)* সদয়; নিরীহ (রোগ) — gentle and kind; (of disease) not harmful. SYN kind, gentle, benevolent; harmless, non-cancerous. ANT malign, hostile; malignant, harmful. *Ex:* Fortunately, the tumour was benign.

Berate *(v)* কঠোরভাবে তিরস্কার করা — to scold angrily. SYN scold, rebuke, reprimand, castigate, upbraid. ANT praise, commend, laud, compliment. *Ex:* The coach berated the players for their poor performance.

Bewilder *(v)* হতবুদ্ধি করা — to confuse. SYN baffle, puzzle, confuse, perplex, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The complex rules bewildered the new students.

Bias *(n)* পক্ষপাত — an unfair preference for or against someone. SYN prejudice, partiality, favouritism, partisanship, leaning. ANT impartiality, fairness, neutrality, objectivity. *Ex:* A judge must decide without bias.

Blatant *(adj)* নির্লজ্জ, স্পষ্ট — done openly and shamelessly. SYN flagrant, obvious, glaring, brazen, overt. ANT hidden, subtle, covert, inconspicuous. *Ex:* It was a blatant lie.

Bleak *(adj)* অন্ধকারাচ্ছন্ন, নিরানন্দ — cold and empty; without hope. SYN desolate, grim, dismal, gloomy, hopeless. ANT bright, promising, hopeful, cheerful. *Ex:* The future looks bleak for the industry.

Blithe *(adj)* উৎফুল্ল; উদাসীন — happy and carefree; casually indifferent. SYN cheerful, carefree, light-hearted; casual, heedless. ANT gloomy, sad; careful, concerned. *Ex:* He showed blithe disregard for the rules.

Bliss *(n)* পরম আনন্দ — perfect happiness. SYN joy, ecstasy, rapture, delight, euphoria. ANT misery, sorrow, woe, agony, despair. *Ex:* Ignorance is bliss.

Boisterous *(adj)* হৈচৈপূর্ণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — noisy, lively and energetic. SYN rowdy, noisy, unruly, exuberant, clamorous. ANT quiet, calm, restrained, sedate. *Ex:* The children were boisterous at the picnic.

Bold ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — brave and confident. SYN brave, daring, courageous, fearless, audacious. ANT timid, shy, cowardly, fearful, meek. *Ex:* It was a bold decision to start a business.

Bolster *(v)* সমর্থন জোগানো, শক্তিশালী করা — to support or strengthen. SYN strengthen, reinforce, support, boost, buttress. ANT weaken, undermine, sabotage, impair. *Ex:* The new evidence bolstered his claim.

Bombastic GRE *(adj)* আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ (ভাষা), দম্ভপূর্ণ — using high-sounding but empty language. SYN pompous, grandiloquent, pretentious, inflated, turgid. ANT simple, plain, modest, unpretentious. *Ex:* The politician gave a bombastic speech.

Boon ★ *(n)* আশীর্বাদ, বর — something helpful or beneficial. SYN blessing, benefit, advantage, godsend, gift. ANT bane, curse, disadvantage, blight. *Ex:* Mobile banking is a boon for rural people.

Boorish *(adj)* অভদ্র, গেঁয়ো — rough and bad-mannered. SYN rude, uncouth, coarse, vulgar, loutish. ANT refined, polite, cultured, courteous. *Ex:* His boorish behaviour embarrassed his hosts.

Brave ★ *(adj)* সাহসী — ready to face danger or pain. SYN courageous, valiant, gallant, intrepid, heroic, dauntless. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The brave freedom fighters sacrificed their lives.

Brevity *(n)* সংক্ষিপ্ততা — shortness, especially of speech or writing. SYN conciseness, briefness, succinctness, terseness. ANT verbosity, wordiness, prolixity, length. *Ex:* Brevity is the soul of wit.

Brittle *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — hard but easily broken. SYN fragile, breakable, frail, delicate, crisp. ANT flexible, durable, tough, sturdy, elastic. *Ex:* Old bones become brittle.

Brusque *(adj)* রূঢ়, কাটখোট্টা — abrupt and rude in speech or manner. SYN curt, blunt, abrupt, gruff, terse. ANT polite, courteous, gracious, gentle. *Ex:* The officer gave a brusque reply.

Bucolic GRE *(adj)* গ্রাম্য, রাখালিয়া — related to pleasant country life. SYN rural, pastoral, rustic, idyllic. ANT urban, metropolitan, industrial. *Ex:* Jasimuddin painted bucolic scenes in his poems.

Burgeon GRE *(v)* দ্রুত বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া — to grow or develop rapidly. SYN flourish, boom, mushroom, expand, thrive. ANT decline, wither, shrink, dwindle. *Ex:* The garment industry burgeoned in the 1990s.

Buoyant *(adj)* ভাসমান; প্রফুল্ল — able to float; cheerful and optimistic. SYN floating; cheerful, optimistic, lively, upbeat. ANT sinking; depressed, gloomy, despondent. *Ex:* The market remained buoyant this year.

C

Cajole *(v)* তোষামোদ করে রাজি করানো — to persuade by flattery or gentle urging. SYN coax, wheedle, persuade, entice, inveigle. ANT force, compel, coerce, bully. *Ex:* She cajoled her father into buying her a phone.

Callous ★ *(adj)* নির্দয়, অনুভূতিহীন — not caring about others' suffering. SYN heartless, unfeeling, cruel, insensitive, hard-hearted. ANT kind, compassionate, sympathetic, caring, tender. *Ex:* His callous remark hurt the widow.

Calm *(adj)* শান্ত — peaceful and quiet; not excited. SYN tranquil, serene, placid, composed, peaceful. ANT agitated, stormy, excited, turbulent, anxious. *Ex:* The sea was calm in the morning.

Candid ★ *(adj)* অকপট, স্পষ্টবাদী — honest and direct. SYN frank, open, outspoken, forthright, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* I want your candid opinion of my essay.

Candour *(n)* স্পষ্টবাদিতা, সরলতা — the quality of being honest and open. SYN frankness, honesty, openness, sincerity, directness. ANT deceit, evasiveness, secrecy, duplicity. *Ex:* He spoke with refreshing candour.

Capitulate *(v)* আত্মসমর্পণ করা — to surrender; to stop resisting. SYN surrender, yield, submit, give in, concede. ANT resist, fight, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The Pakistani forces capitulated on 16 December 1971.

Capricious ★ GRE *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — changing mood or behaviour suddenly. SYN fickle, whimsical, erratic, volatile, mercurial, unpredictable. ANT steady, stable, consistent, constant, reliable. *Ex:* The weather in April is capricious.

Captivate *(v)* মুগ্ধ করা — to attract and hold the attention of. SYN charm, enchant, fascinate, enthral, bewitch. ANT repel, bore, disgust, alienate. *Ex:* Her voice captivated the audience.

Castigate *(v)* কঠোর সমালোচনা করা, শাস্তি দেওয়া — to criticise or punish severely. SYN chastise, rebuke, reprimand, berate, censure. ANT praise, commend, reward, laud. *Ex:* The report castigated the officials for negligence.

Catastrophe *(n)* মহাবিপর্যয় — a sudden great disaster. SYN disaster, calamity, cataclysm, tragedy, debacle. ANT blessing, success, boon, fortune, triumph. *Ex:* The cyclone of 1970 was a national catastrophe.

Caustic *(adj)* ক্ষয়কারক; তীব্র ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — able to burn chemically; bitterly sarcastic. SYN corrosive; sarcastic, acerbic, biting, scathing. ANT mild, soothing; kind, gentle. *Ex:* She made a caustic comment about his work.

Cautious *(adj)* সতর্ক — careful to avoid danger. SYN careful, wary, prudent, circumspect, vigilant. ANT careless, reckless, rash, heedless, imprudent. *Ex:* Be cautious while crossing the road.

Celebrated *(adj)* বিখ্যাত — famous and praised. SYN famous, renowned, eminent, illustrious, acclaimed. ANT unknown, obscure, unsung, notorious. *Ex:* Lalon is a celebrated mystic poet.

Censure ★ *(v/n)* নিন্দা করা; নিন্দা — to express strong formal disapproval. SYN condemn, criticise, denounce, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, approve, commend, endorse, applaud. *Ex:* Parliament passed a motion of censure against the minister.

Chaos *(n)* বিশৃঙ্খলা — complete disorder and confusion. SYN disorder, confusion, mayhem, turmoil, anarchy, pandemonium. ANT order, peace, calm, organisation, system. *Ex:* The power failure caused chaos at the airport.

Charlatan GRE *(n)* ভণ্ড, প্রতারক — a person who falsely claims special knowledge or skill. SYN fraud, quack, impostor, swindler, mountebank. ANT expert, professional, genuine article. *Ex:* The "doctor" turned out to be a charlatan.

Chaste *(adj)* সতী, পবিত্র; সরল — morally pure; simple in style. SYN pure, virtuous, modest, innocent; plain, simple. ANT impure, immoral, lewd; ornate, gaudy. *Ex:* Her prose style is chaste and elegant.

Chastise *(v)* শাস্তি দেওয়া, তিরস্কার করা — to scold or punish severely. SYN punish, discipline, castigate, rebuke, reprimand. ANT praise, reward, commend, compliment. *Ex:* The father chastised his son for lying.

Cherish *(v)* লালন করা, সযত্নে রাখা — to love and protect; to keep a memory or hope. SYN treasure, value, prize, adore, nurture, harbour. ANT neglect, abandon, despise, disregard. *Ex:* We cherish the memories of our childhood.

Chicanery GRE *(n)* প্রবঞ্চনা, কূটকৌশল — the use of tricks to deceive. SYN trickery, deception, deceit, subterfuge, sophistry. ANT honesty, candour, fairness, probity. *Ex:* The election was won through chicanery.

Circumspect GRE *(adj)* সতর্ক, বিবেচক — careful to consider all risks before acting. SYN cautious, wary, prudent, careful, discreet. ANT rash, reckless, careless, imprudent, heedless. *Ex:* Diplomats must be circumspect in what they say.

Clandestine ★ *(adj)* গোপন — done secretly, often illegally. SYN secret, covert, surreptitious, furtive, hidden, underground. ANT open, public, overt, legal, above-board. *Ex:* They held clandestine meetings at night.

Clemency *(n)* ক্ষমা, দয়া — mercy shown in punishment. SYN mercy, leniency, forgiveness, compassion, pardon. ANT severity, cruelty, harshness, ruthlessness. *Ex:* The prisoner appealed to the President for clemency.

Coerce *(v)* বলপ্রয়োগ করা — to force someone to do something by threats. SYN force, compel, pressure, intimidate, bully. ANT persuade, coax, induce, allow. *Ex:* He was coerced into signing the document.

Cogent GRE *(adj)* যুক্তিযুক্ত, জোরালো — clear, logical and convincing. SYN convincing, compelling, persuasive, forceful, sound. ANT weak, unconvincing, flimsy, illogical. *Ex:* She presented a cogent argument.

Coherent *(adj)* সুসংগত — logical and consistent; clear. SYN logical, consistent, rational, lucid, orderly. ANT incoherent, confused, illogical, rambling. *Ex:* The report lacks a coherent structure.

Colossal *(adj)* বিশাল — extremely large. SYN huge, enormous, gigantic, immense, mammoth, massive. ANT tiny, minute, small, minuscule. *Ex:* The Padma Bridge is a colossal project.

Commence *(v)* শুরু করা — to begin. SYN begin, start, initiate, launch, inaugurate. ANT end, finish, conclude, terminate, cease. *Ex:* The examination will commence at 10 a.m.

Compassion ★ *(n)* সহানুভূতি, করুণা — sympathy and concern for others' suffering. SYN sympathy, pity, kindness, mercy, empathy. ANT cruelty, indifference, callousness, mercilessness. *Ex:* Doctors should treat patients with compassion.

Compatible *(adj)* সামঞ্জস্যপূর্ণ — able to exist or work together. SYN consistent, harmonious, congruous, suited, in tune. ANT incompatible, contradictory, discordant, conflicting. *Ex:* This software is compatible with all computers.

Complacent ★ *(adj)* আত্মতুষ্ট — too satisfied with oneself and unaware of danger. SYN smug, self-satisfied, contented, unconcerned. ANT concerned, dissatisfied, vigilant, alert. *Ex:* We cannot afford to be complacent about dengue.

Comply *(v)* মেনে চলা — to act according to a request or rule. SYN obey, follow, conform, adhere, observe. ANT disobey, defy, violate, resist. *Ex:* All factories must comply with safety laws.

Concise ★ *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত — giving information clearly in few words. SYN brief, succinct, terse, compact, pithy, laconic. ANT verbose, wordy, lengthy, prolix, long-winded. *Ex:* Write a concise summary of the passage.

Conciliate *(v)* মীমাংসা করা, শান্ত করা — to stop someone being angry; to reconcile. SYN pacify, placate, appease, reconcile, mollify. ANT antagonise, provoke, alienate, anger. *Ex:* The manager tried to conciliate the striking workers.

Condemn *(v)* নিন্দা করা; দণ্ড দেওয়া — to express strong disapproval; to sentence. SYN denounce, censure, deplore; convict, sentence. ANT praise, approve, commend; acquit, pardon. *Ex:* The world condemned the genocide.

Condone ★ *(v)* উপেক্ষা করা, মার্জনা করা — to accept or allow wrong behaviour. SYN overlook, excuse, pardon, forgive, disregard. ANT condemn, punish, censure, denounce. *Ex:* We cannot condone violence in any form.

Confident *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসী — sure of oneself or of something. SYN self-assured, certain, sure, positive, poised. ANT diffident, unsure, doubtful, timid, insecure. *Ex:* She felt confident about the viva.

Confiscate *(v)* বাজেয়াপ্ত করা — to take property officially as a penalty. SYN seize, impound, appropriate, sequester. ANT return, restore, release, give back. *Ex:* Customs officers confiscated the smuggled gold.

Conspicuous ★ *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট, দৃষ্টিগোচর — clearly visible; attracting attention. SYN noticeable, prominent, obvious, striking, evident, salient. ANT inconspicuous, hidden, invisible, unnoticeable. *Ex:* He was conspicuous by his absence.

Contemplate *(v)* গভীরভাবে চিন্তা করা — to think deeply about; to consider doing. SYN consider, ponder, reflect, meditate, deliberate. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect, overlook. *Ex:* He is contemplating a career change.

Contempt *(n)* ঘৃণা, অবজ্ঞা — the feeling that someone is worthless. SYN scorn, disdain, disrespect, derision, disregard. ANT respect, admiration, esteem, regard, reverence. *Ex:* He looked at the traitor with contempt.

Contemptible *(adj)* ঘৃণ্য — deserving contempt. SYN despicable, shameful, base, mean, detestable. ANT admirable, laudable, honourable, praiseworthy. *Ex:* Cheating the poor is a contemptible act.

Contentious *(adj)* বিতর্কিত; কলহপ্রিয় — causing disagreement; fond of arguing. SYN controversial, disputed, debatable; quarrelsome. ANT uncontroversial, agreed; peaceable, agreeable. *Ex:* Water-sharing is a contentious issue.

Contradict *(v)* বিরোধিতা করা, খণ্ডন করা — to state the opposite of. SYN deny, refute, dispute, oppose, gainsay. ANT confirm, agree, endorse, corroborate, support. *Ex:* The witness contradicted his earlier statement.

Convene *(v)* সভা আহ্বান করা — to call people together for a meeting. SYN assemble, summon, convoke, call, gather. ANT dismiss, adjourn, disperse, disband. *Ex:* The Speaker convened a special session.

Copious *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant in supply. SYN abundant, plentiful, profuse, ample, lavish. ANT scarce, meagre, sparse, scanty. *Ex:* She took copious notes during the lecture.

Cordial *(adj)* আন্তরিক, সৌহার্দ্যপূর্ণ — warm and friendly. SYN friendly, warm, affable, genial, hearty. ANT hostile, cold, unfriendly, frosty. *Ex:* The two leaders had a cordial meeting.

Corroborate GRE *(v)* সমর্থন করা, প্রমাণ দৃঢ় করা — to confirm with evidence. SYN confirm, verify, substantiate, support, validate. ANT contradict, refute, deny, disprove. *Ex:* Two witnesses corroborated her story.

Covert *(adj)* গোপন — not openly shown; secret. SYN secret, hidden, clandestine, surreptitious, veiled. ANT overt, open, public, manifest. *Ex:* The agency ran a covert operation.

Covet *(v)* লোভ করা — to want eagerly something belonging to another. SYN desire, crave, envy, hanker after, lust after. ANT renounce, disdain, reject, spurn. *Ex:* Do not covet your neighbour's property.

Cowardly *(adj)* ভীরু, কাপুরুষোচিত — lacking courage. SYN fearful, timid, craven, faint-hearted, pusillanimous. ANT brave, bold, courageous, valiant, heroic. *Ex:* Attacking unarmed people is a cowardly act.

Credible *(adj)* বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — able to be believed. SYN believable, plausible, reliable, trustworthy, convincing. ANT incredible, unbelievable, implausible, dubious. *Ex:* We need a credible witness.

Credulous GRE *(adj)* সহজে বিশ্বাসকারী — too ready to believe things. SYN gullible, naive, trusting, unsuspecting. ANT sceptical, suspicious, wary, incredulous. *Ex:* Credulous villagers were cheated by the fraudster.

Cryptic *(adj)* রহস্যময়, দুর্বোধ্য — mysterious or obscure in meaning. SYN enigmatic, mysterious, obscure, puzzling, arcane. ANT clear, plain, obvious, explicit. *Ex:* He left a cryptic message on the door.

Culpable *(adj)* দোষী, নিন্দনীয় — deserving blame. SYN guilty, blameworthy, responsible, at fault. ANT innocent, blameless, guiltless. *Ex:* The officials were held culpable for the fire.

Cumbersome *(adj)* ভারী ও অসুবিধাজনক — large, heavy and difficult to use; slow and complicated. SYN unwieldy, bulky, awkward, clumsy; complicated. ANT manageable, handy, convenient; simple, efficient. *Ex:* The old procedure was cumbersome.

Curb *(v)* দমন করা, নিয়ন্ত্রণ করা — to control or limit. SYN restrain, check, control, limit, suppress. ANT encourage, free, release, foster, unleash. *Ex:* The government is trying to curb inflation.

Curt *(adj)* রূঢ়, সংক্ষিপ্ত — rudely brief. SYN brusque, abrupt, terse, blunt, short. ANT polite, courteous, expansive, gracious. *Ex:* She gave a curt nod and left.

Cynical *(adj)* মানুষের সদিচ্ছায় অবিশ্বাসী — believing that people act only in self-interest. SYN sceptical, distrustful, pessimistic, sardonic. ANT trusting, optimistic, idealistic, naive. *Ex:* Many voters have grown cynical about politics.

D

Daunt *(v)* ভীত করা, দমিয়ে দেওয়া — to make someone feel afraid or discouraged. SYN intimidate, discourage, dismay, frighten, cow. ANT encourage, embolden, hearten, inspire. *Ex:* Nothing could daunt her spirit.

Dauntless *(adj)* নির্ভীক — showing fearlessness. SYN fearless, intrepid, bold, valiant, undaunted. ANT timid, fearful, cowardly, faint-hearted. *Ex:* The dauntless soldiers held their position.

Dearth ★ *(n)* অভাব, ঘাটতি — a scarcity or lack of something. SYN scarcity, shortage, lack, paucity, deficiency, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus, glut. *Ex:* There is a dearth of skilled nurses in the country.

Debacle *(n)* চরম ব্যর্থতা, বিপর্যয় — a sudden and complete failure. SYN fiasco, disaster, failure, collapse, catastrophe. ANT success, triumph, victory, achievement. *Ex:* The launch of the product was a debacle.

Debilitate *(v)* দুর্বল করা — to make very weak. SYN weaken, enfeeble, enervate, sap, exhaust. ANT strengthen, invigorate, fortify, energise. *Ex:* The long illness debilitated him.

Decadence *(n)* অবক্ষয়, পতন — moral or cultural decline. SYN decline, decay, degeneration, corruption, debauchery. ANT rise, growth, flourishing, virtue, morality. *Ex:* The decadence of the Roman Empire led to its fall.

Deceit *(n)* প্রতারণা — dishonest behaviour meant to trick. SYN deception, fraud, trickery, duplicity, guile. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, frankness. *Ex:* He won the election through deceit.

Decipher *(v)* পাঠোদ্ধার করা — to work out the meaning of something difficult. SYN decode, interpret, unravel, decrypt, solve. ANT encode, encipher, garble, confuse. *Ex:* Scholars deciphered the ancient inscription.

Decorum *(n)* শিষ্টাচার, শালীনতা — polite and correct behaviour. SYN propriety, decency, etiquette, dignity, good manners. ANT impropriety, indecorum, rudeness, vulgarity. *Ex:* Members must maintain decorum in Parliament.

Decry *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise publicly. SYN denounce, condemn, criticise, disparage, belittle. ANT praise, extol, laud, acclaim. *Ex:* Many decried the decision to cut trees for the road.

Defer *(v)* স্থগিত করা; মেনে নেওয়া — to postpone; to yield respectfully to another's opinion. SYN postpone, delay, put off, adjourn; submit, yield. ANT advance, expedite, hasten; resist, defy. *Ex:* The decision was deferred until next week.

Deference *(n)* শ্রদ্ধা, সম্মান প্রদর্শন — polite respect. SYN respect, regard, esteem, reverence, submission. ANT disrespect, contempt, disregard, defiance. *Ex:* In deference to his wishes, we kept quiet.

Defiant *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবাধ্য — openly resisting or challenging. SYN rebellious, disobedient, insubordinate, recalcitrant. ANT obedient, submissive, compliant, docile. *Ex:* The defiant prisoner refused to answer.

Deft *(adj)* দক্ষ, নিপুণ — quick and skilful. SYN adroit, dexterous, nimble, skilful, adept. ANT clumsy, awkward, inept, maladroit. *Ex:* With a deft touch, he fixed the watch.

Defunct *(adj)* অচল, বিলুপ্ত — no longer existing or working. SYN extinct, obsolete, dead, inoperative, discontinued. ANT active, alive, working, functioning, extant. *Ex:* The defunct jute mill is now a warehouse.

Delectable *(adj)* সুস্বাদু, মনোরম — delicious; delightful. SYN delicious, tasty, appetising, scrumptious, delightful. ANT unappetising, distasteful, unpleasant, revolting. *Ex:* She served a delectable plate of biryani.

Deleterious GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — causing harm. SYN harmful, detrimental, damaging, injurious, pernicious. ANT beneficial, harmless, salutary, advantageous. *Ex:* Air pollution has deleterious effects on health.

Deliberate *(adj/v)* ইচ্ছাকৃত; চিন্তা করা — done on purpose; to think carefully. SYN intentional, planned, calculated; consider, ponder. ANT accidental, unintentional, spontaneous. *Ex:* It was a deliberate attempt to mislead us.

Delineate *(v)* বর্ণনা করা, রূপরেখা দেওয়া — to describe or outline precisely. SYN outline, describe, depict, portray, sketch. ANT obscure, confuse, blur. *Ex:* The report delineates the main problems.

Demolish *(v)* ভেঙে ফেলা — to pull down; to destroy. SYN destroy, raze, tear down, wreck, level. ANT build, construct, erect, create. *Ex:* The illegal building was demolished.

Denounce *(v)* প্রকাশ্যে নিন্দা করা — to criticise strongly in public. SYN condemn, censure, decry, criticise, castigate. ANT praise, commend, support, endorse. *Ex:* The UN denounced the attack.

Deplete *(v)* নিঃশেষ করা — to use up or reduce greatly. SYN exhaust, drain, consume, reduce, use up. ANT replenish, refill, restore, increase. *Ex:* Overfishing has depleted the hilsa stock.

Deplore *(v)* দুঃখ প্রকাশ করা, নিন্দা করা — to feel or express strong disapproval. SYN condemn, regret, lament, denounce, deprecate. ANT praise, approve, celebrate, applaud. *Ex:* We deplore all acts of violence.

Depravity *(n)* নৈতিক অধঃপতন — moral corruption. SYN wickedness, corruption, immorality, vice, degeneracy. ANT virtue, morality, goodness, purity. *Ex:* The crime showed the depth of his depravity.

Derelict *(adj)* পরিত্যক্ত; কর্তব্যে অবহেলাকারী — abandoned and in poor condition; negligent. SYN abandoned, deserted, dilapidated; negligent, remiss. ANT occupied, maintained; dutiful, conscientious. *Ex:* The derelict house is said to be haunted.

Deride *(v)* উপহাস করা — to mock. SYN ridicule, mock, scoff, jeer, taunt, belittle. ANT praise, respect, admire, flatter. *Ex:* His ideas were derided at first but later accepted.

Derogatory *(adj)* অবমাননাকর — showing a critical or disrespectful attitude. SYN disparaging, insulting, offensive, pejorative, defamatory. ANT complimentary, flattering, laudatory, respectful. *Ex:* He made derogatory remarks about women.

Desecrate *(v)* অপবিত্র করা — to treat a sacred place or thing with violent disrespect. SYN profane, defile, violate, pollute, vandalise. ANT sanctify, consecrate, hallow, revere. *Ex:* Vandals desecrated the graves.

Despondent *(adj)* হতাশ, বিষণ্ণ — in low spirits from loss of hope. SYN dejected, hopeless, downcast, disheartened, gloomy. ANT hopeful, cheerful, optimistic, buoyant. *Ex:* He became despondent after failing the exam.

Despot *(n)* স্বৈরশাসক — a ruler who uses power cruelly. SYN tyrant, dictator, autocrat, oppressor. ANT democrat, liberal ruler. *Ex:* The despot crushed every protest.

Destitute ★ *(adj)* নিঃস্ব, অসহায় — extremely poor and lacking basic needs. SYN penniless, impoverished, indigent, needy, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous, opulent. *Ex:* The flood left thousands destitute.

Deter *(v)* নিবৃত্ত করা, বাধা দেওয়া — to discourage someone from doing something. SYN discourage, dissuade, prevent, hinder, restrain. ANT encourage, persuade, induce, motivate. *Ex:* Strict punishment may deter crime.

Detrimental *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর — tending to cause harm. SYN harmful, damaging, deleterious, injurious, adverse. ANT beneficial, advantageous, helpful, favourable. *Ex:* Smoking is detrimental to health.

Devious *(adj)* কুটিল, বাঁকা — dishonestly clever; not straightforward. SYN deceitful, cunning, sly, wily, crafty, tortuous. ANT honest, frank, straightforward, direct. *Ex:* He used devious means to get the job.

Devout *(adj)* ধার্মিক, নিষ্ঠাবান — deeply religious; sincere. SYN pious, religious, godly, devoted, faithful. ANT irreligious, impious, sceptical, insincere. *Ex:* His mother is a devout Muslim.

Dexterity *(n)* দক্ষতা, নৈপুণ্য — skill, especially with the hands. SYN skill, deftness, adroitness, agility, finesse. ANT clumsiness, awkwardness, ineptitude. *Ex:* The surgeon operated with great dexterity.

Diatribe GRE *(n)* তীব্র নিন্দাবাদ — a bitter verbal attack. SYN tirade, harangue, invective, denunciation, philippic. ANT praise, eulogy, panegyric, compliment. *Ex:* He launched into a diatribe against the press.

Didactic GRE *(adj)* শিক্ষামূলক; উপদেশমূলক — intended to teach, often in a moralising way. SYN instructive, educational, pedagogic, preachy, moralistic. ANT entertaining, uninstructive, amusing. *Ex:* Aesop's fables are didactic stories.

Diffident ★ *(adj)* আত্মবিশ্বাসহীন, লাজুক — shy and lacking self-confidence. SYN shy, timid, modest, bashful, reserved, unassertive. ANT confident, bold, assertive, self-assured. *Ex:* The diffident student never spoke in class.

Dilapidated *(adj)* জরাজীর্ণ — in a state of disrepair because of age or neglect. SYN ruined, decrepit, ramshackle, crumbling, run-down. ANT well-kept, sound, renovated, new. *Ex:* The school building is dilapidated.

Dilatory GRE *(adj)* দীর্ঘসূত্রী, বিলম্বকারী — slow to act; intended to cause delay. SYN slow, tardy, sluggish, procrastinating, lax. ANT prompt, quick, punctual, diligent, expeditious. *Ex:* The office is known for its dilatory tactics.

Dilemma *(n)* উভয়সংকট — a situation requiring a choice between two difficult options. SYN quandary, predicament, plight, problem. ANT solution, certainty, resolution. *Ex:* She was in a dilemma whether to study abroad or stay.

Diligent ★ *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী, অধ্যবসায়ী — careful and hard-working. SYN industrious, assiduous, hard-working, conscientious, sedulous. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, negligent, slothful. *Ex:* Diligent students rarely fail.

Diminish *(v)* হ্রাস পাওয়া — to make or become less. SYN decrease, lessen, reduce, dwindle, wane, abate. ANT increase, augment, enlarge, magnify. *Ex:* His popularity has diminished.

Discern *(v)* উপলব্ধি করা, পার্থক্য বোঝা — to perceive or recognise. SYN perceive, detect, distinguish, recognise, notice. ANT overlook, miss, confuse, ignore. *Ex:* It is hard to discern truth from rumour on social media.

Discord *(n)* বিরোধ, অনৈক্য — disagreement; lack of harmony. SYN conflict, dissension, strife, disagreement, friction. ANT harmony, accord, concord, agreement, peace. *Ex:* There was discord among the party members.

Discreet *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, সাবধানী — careful not to cause offence or reveal secrets. SYN tactful, prudent, careful, cautious, diplomatic. ANT indiscreet, tactless, careless, imprudent. *Ex:* Please be discreet about this matter.

Disdain *(n/v)* ঘৃণা, তাচ্ছিল্য — the feeling that someone is unworthy; to scorn. SYN contempt, scorn, derision, disregard; spurn. ANT respect, admiration, esteem; admire. *Ex:* She looked at the shabby room with disdain.

Disparage *(v)* হেয় করা — to speak of as having little value. SYN belittle, deprecate, denigrate, decry, underrate. ANT praise, extol, laud, commend, acclaim. *Ex:* Never disparage the efforts of others.

Disparity *(n)* বৈষম্য, পার্থক্য — a great difference. SYN inequality, difference, gap, discrepancy, imbalance. ANT equality, parity, similarity, uniformity. *Ex:* There is a huge disparity between the rich and the poor.

Disseminate GRE *(v)* প্রচার করা, ছড়িয়ে দেওয়া — to spread information widely. SYN spread, circulate, propagate, broadcast, distribute. ANT suppress, conceal, withhold, contain. *Ex:* The media disseminates news quickly.

Distinct *(adj)* স্বতন্ত্র; স্পষ্ট — clearly different; easy to see or hear. SYN different, separate, discrete; clear, evident, obvious. ANT similar, identical; vague, indistinct, blurred. *Ex:* Bangla and Assamese are related but distinct languages.

Docile *(adj)* বাধ্য, শান্ত স্বভাব — quiet and easy to control. SYN obedient, submissive, compliant, tame, meek, tractable. ANT unruly, rebellious, defiant, wild, obstinate. *Ex:* The cow is a docile animal.

Dogmatic *(adj)* গোঁড়া, মতান্ধ — insisting that one's beliefs are certainly right. SYN opinionated, doctrinaire, rigid, dictatorial, bigoted. ANT open-minded, flexible, tolerant, undogmatic. *Ex:* A good scientist is never dogmatic.

Dormant *(adj)* সুপ্ত, নিষ্ক্রিয় — temporarily inactive. SYN inactive, latent, sleeping, quiescent, inert. ANT active, awake, alive, operative. *Ex:* The volcano has been dormant for centuries.

Dubious *(adj)* সন্দেহজনক — doubtful; not to be relied on. SYN doubtful, suspicious, questionable, uncertain, shady. ANT certain, reliable, trustworthy, definite. *Ex:* He made his money by dubious means.

Durable *(adj)* টেকসই — able to last long. SYN lasting, long-lasting, enduring, sturdy, robust. ANT fragile, flimsy, perishable, brittle. *Ex:* Jute bags are cheap and durable.

E

Eccentric *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি, অদ্ভুত — unusual and slightly strange. SYN odd, peculiar, strange, quirky, idiosyncratic, bizarre. ANT normal, ordinary, conventional, typical. *Ex:* The eccentric professor wore two watches.

Eclectic GRE *(adj)* বিভিন্ন উৎস থেকে নির্বাচিত — drawing ideas or styles from many sources. SYN diverse, varied, wide-ranging, broad, heterogeneous. ANT narrow, uniform, limited, homogeneous. *Ex:* She has an eclectic taste in music.

Ecstasy *(n)* পরমানন্দ — overwhelming happiness. SYN rapture, bliss, euphoria, elation, joy. ANT misery, despair, agony, sorrow. *Ex:* The fans were in ecstasy after the victory.

Edify *(v)* নৈতিক বা বুদ্ধিবৃত্তিক উন্নতি সাধন করা — to instruct or improve morally or intellectually. SYN enlighten, educate, instruct, uplift, inform. ANT corrupt, mislead, degrade. *Ex:* The lectures were meant to edify the youth.

Efface *(v)* মুছে ফেলা — to erase a mark or memory. SYN erase, obliterate, wipe out, eradicate, delete. ANT preserve, retain, restore, create. *Ex:* Time cannot efface the memory of 1971.

Effervescent *(adj)* বুদবুদপূর্ণ; প্রাণবন্ত — bubbly; lively and enthusiastic. SYN bubbly, fizzy; lively, vivacious, exuberant, sparkling. ANT flat; dull, lifeless, apathetic. *Ex:* Her effervescent personality made her popular.

Efficacy *(n)* কার্যকারিতা — the ability to produce the intended result. SYN effectiveness, efficiency, potency, power, success. ANT inefficacy, uselessness, ineffectiveness, futility. *Ex:* The efficacy of the vaccine has been proved.

Egalitarian *(adj)* সমতাবাদী — believing that all people are equal. SYN equal, democratic, fair, impartial, unbiased. ANT elitist, hierarchical, unequal, discriminatory. *Ex:* We dream of an egalitarian society.

Egregious GRE *(adj)* চরম খারাপ, জঘন্য — outstandingly bad; shocking. SYN flagrant, glaring, outrageous, shocking, atrocious. ANT minor, trivial, slight, insignificant. *Ex:* It was an egregious error to delete the files.

Elated *(adj)* উল্লসিত — extremely happy. SYN overjoyed, jubilant, ecstatic, thrilled, euphoric. ANT dejected, depressed, sad, despondent. *Ex:* She was elated at her success.

Elegant *(adj)* মার্জিত, সুরুচিসম্পন্ন — graceful and stylish. SYN graceful, stylish, refined, polished, tasteful. ANT clumsy, crude, inelegant, gaudy, tasteless. *Ex:* She wore an elegant Jamdani sari.

Elicit *(v)* বের করে আনা — to draw out a response or information. SYN evoke, extract, draw out, obtain, provoke. ANT suppress, repress, withhold. *Ex:* The question elicited no response. (Do not confuse with *illicit* = illegal.)

Eloquent ★ *(adj)* বাগ্মী, সুবক্তা — fluent and persuasive in speaking or writing. SYN articulate, fluent, expressive, persuasive, silver-tongued. ANT inarticulate, halting, tongue-tied, faltering. *Ex:* Bangabandhu's speech of 7 March was eloquent and inspiring.

Elusive *(adj)* অধরা, ধরা-ছোঁয়ার বাইরে — difficult to find, catch or achieve. SYN evasive, slippery, fleeting, intangible, baffling. ANT obtainable, attainable, catchable, clear. *Ex:* Success remained elusive for the team.

Emaciated *(adj)* কৃশকায়, শীর্ণ — abnormally thin and weak. SYN gaunt, skinny, scrawny, haggard, wasted. ANT plump, fat, stout, well-fed, chubby. *Ex:* The famine victims were emaciated.

Emancipate *(v)* মুক্ত করা — to set free from legal, social or political restrictions. SYN liberate, free, release, deliver, unshackle. ANT enslave, subjugate, confine, oppress. *Ex:* Lincoln emancipated the slaves.

Embellish *(v)* অলংকৃত করা; রং চড়ানো — to decorate; to add untrue details to a story. SYN decorate, adorn, ornament; exaggerate, embroider. ANT simplify, strip, mar; understate. *Ex:* He embellished the story to make it exciting.

Embezzle *(v)* আত্মসাৎ করা — to steal money one has been trusted with. SYN misappropriate, steal, defraud, peculate, pilfer. ANT return, restore, safeguard. *Ex:* The cashier embezzled bank funds.

Eminent ★ *(adj)* বিশিষ্ট, প্রখ্যাত — famous and respected. SYN distinguished, renowned, prominent, illustrious, celebrated. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, insignificant. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Yunus is an eminent economist. (Do not confuse with *imminent* = about to happen.)

Empathy *(n)* সমানুভূতি — the ability to understand and share another's feelings. SYN understanding, compassion, sympathy, sensitivity, rapport. ANT indifference, apathy, callousness, insensitivity. *Ex:* A good teacher shows empathy towards weak students.

Emulate *(v)* অনুকরণ করা, সমকক্ষ হতে চেষ্টা করা — to try to equal or excel by imitating. SYN imitate, copy, follow, match, mirror. ANT ignore, disregard, neglect. *Ex:* Young cricketers try to emulate Shakib Al Hasan.

Encomium GRE *(n)* প্রশস্তি — a speech or piece of writing praising someone highly. SYN eulogy, tribute, panegyric, praise, accolade. ANT criticism, condemnation, diatribe, invective. *Ex:* The poet wrote an encomium on the national hero.

Encourage *(v)* উৎসাহ দেওয়া — to give support or hope. SYN hearten, inspire, motivate, embolden, foster, promote. ANT discourage, deter, dishearten, dissuade. *Ex:* Parents should encourage children to read.

Endorse *(v)* সমর্থন করা, অনুমোদন করা — to declare public approval of. SYN support, approve, back, sanction, champion. ANT oppose, reject, disapprove, condemn. *Ex:* The committee endorsed the proposal.

Enervate GRE *(v)* দুর্বল করা, নিস্তেজ করা — to make weak or drained of energy (NOT "energise"). SYN weaken, exhaust, debilitate, sap, enfeeble. ANT invigorate, energise, strengthen, vitalise. *Ex:* The hot, humid weather enervated us.

Enhance *(v)* বৃদ্ধি করা, উন্নত করা — to improve the quality or value. SYN improve, increase, boost, heighten, augment. ANT reduce, diminish, decrease, impair, worsen. *Ex:* The new road will enhance trade.

Enigma *(n)* রহস্য, ধাঁধা — a mysterious person or thing. SYN mystery, puzzle, riddle, conundrum, paradox. ANT certainty, explanation, solution, clarity. *Ex:* How the pyramids were built is still an enigma.

Enmity *(n)* শত্রুতা — the state of being an enemy. SYN hostility, animosity, antagonism, hatred, rancour. ANT friendship, amity, goodwill, harmony. *Ex:* There was long-standing enmity between the two families.

Enormous *(adj)* বিশাল — very large. SYN huge, vast, immense, gigantic, colossal, massive. ANT tiny, small, minute, little, minuscule. *Ex:* The project costs an enormous amount of money.

Ephemeral ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting for a very short time. SYN transient, transitory, fleeting, momentary, evanescent, short-lived. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, eternal, perennial. *Ex:* Fame on social media is often ephemeral.

Equanimity GRE *(n)* মানসিক স্থিরতা — calmness in a difficult situation. SYN composure, calmness, serenity, poise, self-possession. ANT agitation, anxiety, panic, discomposure. *Ex:* She accepted the loss with equanimity.

Equivocal GRE *(adj)* দ্ব্যর্থবোধক — deliberately unclear; ambiguous. SYN ambiguous, vague, evasive, unclear, cryptic. ANT unequivocal, clear, definite, explicit. *Ex:* The minister gave an equivocal answer.

Eradicate ★ *(v)* নির্মূল করা — to destroy completely. SYN eliminate, wipe out, uproot, abolish, exterminate, extirpate. ANT create, establish, plant, foster, nurture. *Ex:* We must eradicate corruption from society.

Erratic *(adj)* অনিয়মিত, অস্থির — not even or regular. SYN irregular, inconsistent, unpredictable, unstable, capricious. ANT regular, consistent, steady, stable, predictable. *Ex:* The power supply here is erratic.

Erudite ★ GRE *(adj)* পণ্ডিত, বিদ্বান — having great knowledge from study. SYN learned, scholarly, knowledgeable, well-read, cultured. ANT ignorant, illiterate, uneducated, unlettered. *Ex:* Dr. Muhammad Shahidullah was an erudite scholar.

Eschew GRE *(v)* পরিহার করা — to deliberately avoid. SYN avoid, shun, abstain from, forgo, renounce. ANT embrace, seek, welcome, adopt, indulge in. *Ex:* Good writers eschew unnecessary jargon.

Esoteric GRE *(adj)* গূঢ়, স্বল্পজ্ঞাত — understood only by a small group. SYN obscure, arcane, abstruse, recondite, mysterious. ANT common, popular, familiar, simple, exoteric. *Ex:* The book is full of esoteric terms.

Euphemism *(n)* কোমল শব্দের ব্যবহার — a mild word used instead of a harsh one. SYN polite term, understatement, softened expression. ANT dysphemism, blunt term. *Ex:* "Passed away" is a euphemism for "died".

Evade *(v)* এড়িয়ে যাওয়া, ফাঁকি দেওয়া — to escape or avoid, often by trickery. SYN avoid, elude, dodge, escape, sidestep. ANT face, confront, meet, encounter. *Ex:* He was jailed for evading tax.

Evanescent GRE *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী, মিলিয়ে যাওয়া — quickly fading or disappearing. SYN fleeting, ephemeral, transient, momentary, vanishing. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth is evanescent.

Exacerbate GRE *(v)* তীব্রতর করা — to make a problem worse. SYN aggravate, worsen, intensify, inflame, compound. ANT alleviate, mitigate, soothe, improve, relieve. *Ex:* Unplanned building exacerbates waterlogging in Dhaka.

Exalt *(v)* উন্নীত করা; প্রশংসা করা — to raise in rank; to praise highly. SYN elevate, promote; glorify, extol, praise. ANT degrade, demote; criticise, debase, humble. *Ex:* Poets exalt the beauty of Bengal.

Exasperate *(v)* অতিশয় বিরক্ত করা — to irritate intensely. SYN annoy, infuriate, irritate, provoke, vex. ANT soothe, calm, please, pacify. *Ex:* The constant delays exasperated passengers.

Exemplary *(adj)* দৃষ্টান্তমূলক, অনুকরণীয় — serving as a good example; (of punishment) serving as a warning. SYN ideal, model, perfect, commendable; deterrent. ANT deplorable, imperfect, poor, unworthy. *Ex:* The court awarded exemplary punishment.

Exonerate ★ *(v)* দোষমুক্ত করা — to clear someone from blame. SYN acquit, absolve, clear, vindicate, exculpate. ANT accuse, blame, convict, incriminate. *Ex:* The inquiry exonerated the officer.

Exorbitant ★ *(adj)* অত্যধিক, মাত্রাতিরিক্ত — (of price) unreasonably high. SYN excessive, extortionate, outrageous, inflated, unreasonable. ANT reasonable, moderate, fair, cheap, modest. *Ex:* Hotels charge exorbitant rates during Eid.

Expedite *(v)* ত্বরান্বিত করা — to make something happen sooner. SYN hasten, accelerate, speed up, hurry, quicken. ANT delay, hinder, slow down, impede, obstruct. *Ex:* Please expedite the delivery of the goods.

Explicit *(adj)* সুস্পষ্ট — stated clearly and in detail. SYN clear, plain, specific, unambiguous, definite. ANT implicit, vague, ambiguous, hidden, tacit. *Ex:* He gave explicit instructions.

Extol ★ *(v)* উচ্চ প্রশংসা করা — to praise enthusiastically. SYN praise, laud, acclaim, glorify, eulogise, exalt. ANT criticise, condemn, belittle, disparage, denigrate. *Ex:* The critics extolled the novel.

Extravagant ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — spending too much; excessive. SYN wasteful, lavish, spendthrift, profligate, prodigal. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, parsimonious. *Ex:* An extravagant man soon becomes poor.

F

Fabricate *(v)* বানানো (মিথ্যা); নির্মাণ করা — to invent something false; to manufacture. SYN invent, concoct, forge, falsify; construct, make. ANT tell the truth, verify; destroy, dismantle. *Ex:* The story was fabricated by the tabloid.

Facetious *(adj)* ঠাট্টাপূর্ণ (অসময়ে) — treating serious issues with inappropriate humour. SYN flippant, joking, frivolous, jocular, glib. ANT serious, solemn, earnest, grave. *Ex:* His facetious remarks at the funeral offended people.

Facile GRE *(adj)* সহজসাধ্য; অগভীর — too simple, showing little thought; easily achieved. SYN superficial, simplistic, glib, shallow; easy, effortless. ANT profound, thoughtful, complex; difficult, laborious. *Ex:* He offered a facile solution to a complex problem.

Fallacy *(n)* ভ্রান্ত ধারণা — a mistaken belief; a false argument. SYN misconception, delusion, error, myth, illusion. ANT truth, fact, reality, certainty. *Ex:* It is a fallacy that money brings happiness.

Fastidious GRE *(adj)* খুঁতখুঁতে — very attentive to detail; hard to please. SYN fussy, meticulous, particular, finicky, punctilious. ANT careless, easy-going, sloppy, undemanding. *Ex:* He is fastidious about his clothes.

Fatigue *(n)* ক্লান্তি — extreme tiredness. SYN tiredness, weariness, exhaustion, lethargy, lassitude. ANT energy, vigour, freshness, liveliness. *Ex:* He collapsed from fatigue after the march.

Feasible *(adj)* সম্ভবপর, বাস্তবায়নযোগ্য — possible to do easily or conveniently. SYN practicable, viable, achievable, workable, possible. ANT impractical, unfeasible, impossible, unworkable. *Ex:* A metro rail was found feasible for Dhaka.

Feeble ★ *(adj)* দুর্বল — lacking strength. SYN weak, frail, infirm, delicate, puny, debilitated. ANT strong, robust, sturdy, vigorous, powerful. *Ex:* The old man's voice was feeble.

Felicity *(n)* পরম সুখ; উপযুক্ততা — great happiness; the ability to find suitable words. SYN bliss, joy, happiness; aptness, appropriateness. ANT misery, sorrow; inappropriateness. *Ex:* He writes with great felicity of expression.

Ferocious *(adj)* হিংস্র — savagely fierce. SYN fierce, savage, vicious, brutal, wild. ANT gentle, tame, mild, docile. *Ex:* The Royal Bengal Tiger is a ferocious animal.

Fertile *(adj)* উর্বর — able to produce many crops or ideas. SYN fruitful, productive, rich, fecund, prolific. ANT barren, sterile, infertile, arid, unproductive. *Ex:* The land of Bangladesh is very fertile.

Fervent *(adj)* উৎসাহী, আবেগপূর্ণ — having or showing intense feeling. SYN passionate, ardent, zealous, fervid, intense. ANT apathetic, indifferent, cool, lukewarm. *Ex:* He is a fervent supporter of the national team.

Fickle ★ *(adj)* চঞ্চল, অস্থির চিত্ত — changing frequently in loyalty or interest. SYN capricious, inconstant, changeable, mercurial, volatile. ANT constant, steadfast, loyal, faithful, stable. *Ex:* Fortune is fickle.

Fictitious *(adj)* কাল্পনিক, মিথ্যা — not real or true. SYN imaginary, invented, false, fabricated, made-up, bogus. ANT real, true, genuine, factual, authentic. *Ex:* He gave a fictitious name to the police.

Flagrant *(adj)* স্পষ্ট ও নির্লজ্জ — (of wrongdoing) obvious and shocking. SYN blatant, glaring, egregious, outrageous, open. ANT hidden, subtle, concealed, minor. *Ex:* It was a flagrant violation of human rights.

Flamboyant *(adj)* জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — attracting attention by confidence and style. SYN showy, ostentatious, flashy, colourful, extravagant. ANT modest, restrained, plain, sober, understated. *Ex:* The singer is famous for his flamboyant costumes.

Flaw *(n)* ত্রুটি — a mark, fault or weakness. SYN defect, fault, imperfection, blemish, shortcoming. ANT perfection, merit, strength, virtue. *Ex:* There is a flaw in your argument.

Flimsy *(adj)* ঠুনকো, দুর্বল — weak and easily damaged; (of an excuse) unconvincing. SYN fragile, frail, weak; feeble, unconvincing, thin. ANT sturdy, strong, solid; convincing, sound. *Ex:* He gave a flimsy excuse for his absence.

Florid *(adj)* অতিরিক্ত অলংকৃত; রক্তিম — excessively decorated; reddish (complexion). SYN ornate, flowery, elaborate, baroque; ruddy, flushed. ANT plain, simple, austere; pale, pallid. *Ex:* His florid writing style is hard to follow.

Flourish ★ *(v)* সমৃদ্ধ হওয়া — to grow or develop well. SYN thrive, prosper, bloom, boom, burgeon. ANT decline, wither, fade, languish, decay. *Ex:* Trade flourished under the Mughals.

Fluctuate *(v)* ওঠানামা করা — to rise and fall irregularly. SYN vary, oscillate, swing, waver, change. ANT stabilise, remain constant, steady. *Ex:* Onion prices fluctuate every season.

Forbearance *(n)* ধৈর্য, সহিষ্ণুতা — patient self-control. SYN patience, tolerance, restraint, endurance, leniency. ANT impatience, intolerance, anger, severity. *Ex:* She showed great forbearance with her difficult neighbours.

Forlorn *(adj)* নিঃসঙ্গ, হতাশ — pitifully sad and lonely. SYN lonely, desolate, abandoned, wretched, hopeless. ANT cheerful, happy, hopeful, cared-for. *Ex:* A forlorn child stood at the station.

Formidable *(adj)* ভয়ংকর, দুর্দমনীয় — inspiring fear or respect through power; very difficult. SYN daunting, intimidating, powerful, redoubtable; arduous. ANT weak, easy, harmless, trivial. *Ex:* India posed a formidable target of 350 runs.

Fortitude *(n)* মনোবল, সহিষ্ণুতা — courage in pain or difficulty. SYN courage, endurance, resilience, grit, bravery. ANT cowardice, weakness, timidity, faint-heartedness. *Ex:* She bore her illness with fortitude.

Fragile *(adj)* ভঙ্গুর — easily broken or damaged. SYN breakable, delicate, brittle, frail, flimsy. ANT strong, sturdy, durable, robust, tough. *Ex:* Handle the glassware carefully; it is fragile.

Frail *(adj)* দুর্বল, ক্ষীণ — weak and delicate. SYN weak, feeble, infirm, delicate, fragile. ANT strong, robust, healthy, sturdy. *Ex:* My grandmother has become frail.

Frank ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্টবাদী, অকপট — honest and direct. SYN candid, open, outspoken, straightforward, blunt. ANT evasive, secretive, guarded, deceitful. *Ex:* To be frank, I did not like the film.

Frenzy *(n)* উন্মত্ততা — a state of wild excitement. SYN hysteria, madness, mania, fury, agitation. ANT calm, composure, serenity, tranquillity. *Ex:* The crowd was whipped into a frenzy.

Frivolous *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, লঘুচিত্ত — not serious; silly. SYN trivial, petty, flippant, silly, superficial. ANT serious, important, earnest, grave, sensible. *Ex:* Don't waste time on frivolous matters.

Frugal ★ *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful and economical with money or food. SYN thrifty, economical, sparing, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, lavish, prodigal, spendthrift. *Ex:* He lived a frugal life and saved money.

Furtive GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চোরাগোপ্তা — attempting to avoid notice; secretive. SYN secret, stealthy, sly, surreptitious, clandestine. ANT open, overt, candid, forthright. *Ex:* He cast a furtive glance at the answer sheet.

Futile ★ *(adj)* নিষ্ফল, বৃথা — producing no useful result. SYN useless, vain, fruitless, pointless, abortive, ineffectual. ANT useful, fruitful, effective, productive, worthwhile. *Ex:* It is futile to argue with a fool.

G

Gallant *(adj)* সাহসী; ভদ্র — brave; polite and attentive to women. SYN brave, valiant, heroic, courageous; chivalrous, courteous. ANT cowardly, craven; rude, discourteous. *Ex:* The gallant freedom fighters are our national heroes.

Garish *(adj)* চোখ-ধাঁধানো, অতি উজ্জ্বল — unpleasantly bright and showy. SYN gaudy, flashy, loud, lurid, tawdry. ANT sober, tasteful, subdued, muted, elegant. *Ex:* The room was painted in garish colours.

Garrulous ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — talking too much about unimportant things. SYN talkative, loquacious, verbose, chatty, voluble. ANT taciturn, reticent, silent, reserved, laconic. *Ex:* The garrulous old man told us his life story.

Generous *(adj)* উদার — willing to give more than expected. SYN liberal, charitable, munificent, magnanimous, bountiful. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, selfish, parsimonious. *Ex:* He made a generous donation to the hospital.

Genial *(adj)* অমায়িক, হাসিখুশি — friendly and cheerful. SYN affable, amiable, cordial, warm, friendly. ANT unfriendly, cold, hostile, surly. *Ex:* Our genial host welcomed us warmly.

Genuine ★ *(adj)* খাঁটি, আসল — truly what it is said to be. SYN real, authentic, true, bona fide, sincere. ANT fake, false, counterfeit, spurious, sham. *Ex:* Is this a genuine diamond?

Gloomy *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ; অন্ধকার — dark; sad and without hope. SYN dark, dim, dismal; sad, melancholy, depressed, despondent. ANT bright, sunny; cheerful, happy, hopeful. *Ex:* The economic outlook is gloomy.

Glorious *(adj)* গৌরবময় — having or bringing great fame; magnificent. SYN illustrious, celebrated, splendid, magnificent, triumphant. ANT shameful, inglorious, ignominious, dishonourable. *Ex:* 1971 is the most glorious chapter of our history.

Glut *(n)* অতিরিক্ত সরবরাহ — an excessive supply. SYN surplus, excess, surfeit, oversupply, plethora. ANT scarcity, shortage, dearth, lack. *Ex:* A glut of potatoes caused prices to fall.

Gracious *(adj)* সদয়, ভদ্র — courteous, kind and pleasant. SYN courteous, kind, polite, cordial, benevolent. ANT rude, ungracious, impolite, discourteous. *Ex:* She was gracious in defeat.

Gratuitous GRE *(adj)* অহেতুক; বিনামূল্যে — uncalled for, lacking good reason; free of charge. SYN unjustified, unwarranted, needless, unprovoked; free. ANT justified, warranted, necessary; paid. *Ex:* The film contains gratuitous violence.

Gregarious ★ GRE *(adj)* দলপ্রিয়, মিশুক — fond of company; sociable; (of animals) living in groups. SYN sociable, outgoing, convivial, friendly, companionable. ANT unsociable, reclusive, introverted, solitary, aloof. *Ex:* Man is a gregarious animal.

Grievous *(adj)* গুরুতর, মারাত্মক — very serious or severe. SYN serious, severe, grave, dreadful, heinous. ANT slight, minor, trivial, trifling. *Ex:* He suffered grievous injuries in the accident.

Grim *(adj)* ভয়াবহ, কঠোর — very serious, gloomy or forbidding. SYN stern, forbidding, harsh; bleak, dismal, dreadful. ANT cheerful, pleasant, genial; hopeful, bright. *Ex:* The report presents a grim picture of child labour.

Guile *(n)* ছলনা — clever but dishonest intelligence. SYN cunning, craftiness, deceit, trickery, wiliness. ANT honesty, candour, sincerity, ingenuousness. *Ex:* He used guile to win their trust.

Gullible *(adj)* সহজে প্রতারিত হয় এমন — easily deceived. SYN credulous, naive, trusting, unsuspecting, ingenuous. ANT sceptical, suspicious, shrewd, astute, wary. *Ex:* Gullible people fall for online scams.

H

Hackneyed ★ *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, গতানুগতিক — (of a phrase or idea) overused and unoriginal. SYN trite, banal, clichéd, stale, stereotyped, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, new, innovative. *Ex:* Avoid hackneyed expressions in your essay.

Haggard *(adj)* ক্লান্ত ও শীর্ণ — looking exhausted and unwell. SYN gaunt, drawn, worn, wan, careworn. ANT fresh, healthy, robust, hale. *Ex:* After days without sleep, he looked haggard.

Halcyon GRE *(adj)* শান্তিপূর্ণ ও সুখময় (অতীত) — (of a past time) idyllically happy and peaceful. SYN peaceful, serene, idyllic, golden, tranquil. ANT turbulent, stormy, troubled, chaotic. *Ex:* He remembered the halcyon days of his youth.

Hamper *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to hinder the progress of. SYN hinder, impede, obstruct, hold back, encumber. ANT help, assist, aid, facilitate, expedite. *Ex:* Heavy rain hampered the rescue work.

Haphazard *(adj)* এলোমেলো — lacking order or plan. SYN random, disorganised, chaotic, unsystematic, careless. ANT orderly, systematic, methodical, planned. *Ex:* Haphazard urbanisation is a big problem.

Harass *(v)* হয়রানি করা — to subject to repeated pressure or intimidation. SYN torment, pester, harry, bully, persecute. ANT help, comfort, assist, soothe. *Ex:* It is a crime to harass women in public.

Harbinger *(n)* অগ্রদূত — a person or thing that signals the approach of another. SYN herald, forerunner, precursor, omen, sign. ANT successor, follower, aftermath. *Ex:* The cuckoo is the harbinger of spring.

Harmony *(n)* সম্প্রীতি, মিল — agreement; peaceful co-existence. SYN accord, concord, agreement, unity, peace. ANT discord, conflict, disagreement, strife. *Ex:* People of all religions live in harmony here.

Harsh *(adj)* কঠোর, রুক্ষ — cruel or severe; unpleasantly rough. SYN severe, cruel, stern, strict; rough, grating. ANT mild, gentle, lenient, kind; soft, smooth. *Ex:* The punishment was too harsh.

Haughty ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অহংকারী — arrogantly superior. SYN arrogant, proud, conceited, disdainful, supercilious. ANT humble, modest, meek, unassuming. *Ex:* The haughty landlord ignored the poor tenants.

Hazardous *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ — risky; dangerous. SYN dangerous, risky, perilous, precarious, unsafe. ANT safe, secure, harmless, protected. *Ex:* Ship-breaking is a hazardous job.

Heinous ★ *(adj)* জঘন্য, ঘৃণ্য — (of a crime) utterly wicked. SYN atrocious, monstrous, abominable, odious, vile, nefarious. ANT admirable, good, noble, virtuous, commendable. *Ex:* Murder is a heinous crime.

Heresy *(n)* ধর্মদ্রোহিতা, প্রচলিত মতবিরোধী — a belief contrary to accepted religious or general opinion. SYN dissent, nonconformity, heterodoxy, apostasy, unorthodoxy. ANT orthodoxy, conformity, belief, doctrine. *Ex:* Galileo was accused of heresy.

Hesitate *(v)* ইতস্তত করা — to pause before acting. SYN pause, waver, falter, vacillate, dither. ANT decide, proceed, act promptly. *Ex:* Don't hesitate to ask questions.

Heterogeneous *(adj)* বিভিন্ন প্রকারের, বিষমসত্ত্ব — diverse in content. SYN diverse, varied, mixed, assorted, miscellaneous. ANT homogeneous, uniform, similar, alike. *Ex:* Dhaka has a heterogeneous population.

Hilarious *(adj)* অত্যন্ত হাস্যকর — extremely amusing. SYN very funny, comical, side-splitting, hysterical, uproarious. ANT sad, serious, solemn, tragic. *Ex:* The comedy show was hilarious.

Hinder *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to make it difficult for something to happen. SYN hamper, obstruct, impede, block, thwart. ANT help, aid, facilitate, assist, promote. *Ex:* Lack of funds hindered the project.

Holistic *(adj)* সামগ্রিক — dealing with the whole rather than parts. SYN comprehensive, integrated, overall, total. ANT partial, fragmentary, piecemeal. *Ex:* We need a holistic approach to education.

Homogeneous *(adj)* সমজাতীয়, সমসত্ত্ব — of the same kind; uniform. SYN uniform, alike, similar, identical, consistent. ANT heterogeneous, diverse, varied, different. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a largely homogeneous linguistic population.

Hostile ★ *(adj)* শত্রুভাবাপন্ন, বৈরী — unfriendly; antagonistic. SYN unfriendly, antagonistic, belligerent, inimical, adverse. ANT friendly, amicable, cordial, warm, favourable. *Ex:* The crowd was hostile to the speaker.

Humane *(adj)* মানবিক, দয়ালু — showing kindness and compassion. SYN kind, compassionate, merciful, benevolent, considerate. ANT inhumane, cruel, brutal, barbaric. *Ex:* Prisoners should be treated in a humane way.

Humble ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; নিম্ন — modest; low in rank. SYN modest, meek, unassuming; lowly, ordinary, simple. ANT proud, arrogant, haughty; noble, exalted. *Ex:* Despite his fame, he remained humble.

Hypocrisy *(n)* ভণ্ডামি — pretending to have higher standards than one actually has. SYN insincerity, pretence, duplicity, sanctimony, falseness. ANT sincerity, honesty, genuineness, candour. *Ex:* Preaching honesty while taking bribes is hypocrisy.

Hypothetical *(adj)* অনুমানভিত্তিক, কাল্পনিক — based on a suggested idea, not on facts. SYN theoretical, supposed, conjectural, speculative, assumed. ANT actual, real, factual, proven, concrete. *Ex:* Let's consider a hypothetical situation.

I

Iconoclast GRE *(n)* প্রচলিত বিশ্বাসবিরোধী ব্যক্তি — a person who attacks established beliefs. SYN rebel, dissenter, nonconformist, radical, heretic. ANT conformist, traditionalist, follower, believer. *Ex:* Nazrul was an iconoclast in Bengali literature.

Idle ★ *(adj)* অলস; অকেজো — lazy; not working; without purpose. SYN lazy, indolent, slothful; inactive, unused; pointless. ANT busy, diligent, industrious; active, employed. *Ex:* An idle brain is the devil's workshop.

Ignominy *(n)* অপমান, লজ্জা — public shame or disgrace. SYN disgrace, dishonour, shame, humiliation, infamy. ANT honour, glory, credit, esteem, dignity. *Ex:* The team suffered the ignominy of defeat.

Illicit *(adj)* অবৈধ — forbidden by law or custom. SYN illegal, unlawful, illegitimate, prohibited, criminal. ANT legal, lawful, legitimate, licit, permitted. *Ex:* Police seized illicit drugs.

Illustrious *(adj)* খ্যাতিমান, গৌরবময় — well known and respected because of past achievements. SYN famous, celebrated, distinguished, eminent, renowned. ANT unknown, obscure, undistinguished, humble. *Ex:* Sher-e-Bangla came from an illustrious family.

Imbibe *(v)* শোষণ করা, গ্রহণ করা — to drink; to absorb ideas. SYN drink, consume; absorb, assimilate, take in, learn. ANT reject, discard, ignore. *Ex:* Children imbibe values from their parents.

Immaculate *(adj)* নিষ্কলঙ্ক, নিখুঁত — perfectly clean; without fault. SYN spotless, pristine, flawless, impeccable, unblemished. ANT dirty, filthy, stained, flawed, tarnished. *Ex:* Her uniform was immaculate.

Imminent ★ *(adj)* আসন্ন — about to happen. SYN impending, approaching, forthcoming, near, looming. ANT distant, remote, far-off, unlikely. *Ex:* A cyclone is imminent; fishermen should return to shore.

Impartial ★ *(adj)* নিরপেক্ষ — treating all equally; fair. SYN unbiased, neutral, fair, objective, disinterested, just. ANT biased, partial, prejudiced, partisan, one-sided. *Ex:* An election commission must be impartial.

Impeccable *(adj)* নিখুঁত, ত্রুটিহীন — in accordance with the highest standards. SYN flawless, faultless, perfect, immaculate, exemplary. ANT flawed, imperfect, faulty, defective. *Ex:* She speaks impeccable English.

Impede *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to delay or prevent by obstructing. SYN hinder, hamper, obstruct, block, thwart. ANT help, facilitate, expedite, assist, aid. *Ex:* Corruption impedes development.

Imperative *(adj)* অপরিহার্য; আদেশসূচক — of vital importance; giving a command. SYN vital, essential, crucial, necessary, urgent; mandatory. ANT unnecessary, optional, trivial, inessential. *Ex:* It is imperative that we act now.

Imperious *(adj)* আদেশপ্রবণ, কর্তৃত্বপরায়ণ — arrogant and domineering. SYN domineering, overbearing, bossy, dictatorial, haughty. ANT humble, meek, submissive, modest. *Ex:* The manager's imperious manner upset the staff.

Impetuous *(adj)* হঠকারী, আবেগপ্রবণ — acting quickly without thought. SYN rash, impulsive, hasty, reckless, headstrong. ANT cautious, careful, prudent, circumspect, deliberate. *Ex:* His impetuous decision cost him his job.

Implicit *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত; প্রশ্নাতীত — implied, not directly stated; absolute. SYN implied, tacit, unspoken, inherent; absolute, total. ANT explicit, stated, express; partial, qualified. *Ex:* There was an implicit threat in his words. / She has implicit faith in God.

Impromptu *(adj/adv)* উপস্থিত, তাৎক্ষণিক — done without preparation. SYN spontaneous, unrehearsed, improvised, extempore, ad-lib. ANT planned, prepared, rehearsed, premeditated. *Ex:* He gave an impromptu speech.

Imprudent *(adj)* অবিবেচক — not showing care for consequences. SYN unwise, rash, reckless, injudicious, careless. ANT prudent, wise, careful, sensible, judicious. *Ex:* It was imprudent to invest all your savings in one share.

Impudent *(adj)* ধৃষ্ট, বেয়াদব — not showing due respect. SYN insolent, rude, impertinent, cheeky, brazen. ANT respectful, polite, courteous, deferential. *Ex:* The impudent boy talked back to the teacher.

Inadvertent *(adj)* অনিচ্ছাকৃত, অসাবধানতাবশত — not intentional. SYN accidental, unintentional, involuntary, careless. ANT deliberate, intentional, conscious, planned. *Ex:* It was an inadvertent mistake.

Inane *(adj)* অর্থহীন, বোকা — silly; lacking sense. SYN silly, foolish, absurd, senseless, vacuous. ANT sensible, intelligent, meaningful, sound. *Ex:* Stop asking inane questions.

Incessant ★ *(adj)* অবিরাম — continuing without pause. SYN constant, ceaseless, unending, perpetual, continuous, relentless. ANT intermittent, occasional, sporadic, periodic. *Ex:* Incessant rain flooded the streets.

Incisive *(adj)* তীক্ষ্ণ, সুস্পষ্ট — clear and sharp in thinking or expression. SYN penetrating, sharp, keen, acute, perceptive. ANT dull, vague, superficial, woolly. *Ex:* He gave an incisive analysis of the budget.

Incorrigible *(adj)* সংশোধনের অযোগ্য — not able to be corrected or reformed. SYN incurable, hopeless, inveterate, hardened, irredeemable. ANT reformable, correctable, manageable, curable. *Ex:* He is an incorrigible liar.

Indifferent *(adj)* উদাসীন; মাঝারি মানের — having no interest; mediocre. SYN apathetic, unconcerned, detached; mediocre, average. ANT interested, concerned, eager; excellent, superior. *Ex:* He is indifferent to politics.

Indigenous *(adj)* আদিবাসী, দেশীয় — native to a place. SYN native, aboriginal, local, original, endemic. ANT foreign, alien, imported, exotic. *Ex:* The Chakma are an indigenous people of the Chittagong Hill Tracts.

Indigent GRE *(adj)* দরিদ্র, অভাবী — poor; needy. SYN poor, needy, destitute, impoverished, impecunious. ANT rich, wealthy, affluent, prosperous. *Ex:* The trust gives scholarships to indigent students.

Indolent ★ *(adj)* অলস — wanting to avoid activity. SYN lazy, idle, slothful, sluggish, lethargic. ANT industrious, diligent, active, energetic, assiduous. *Ex:* An indolent student cannot expect good results.

Indomitable *(adj)* অদম্য — impossible to subdue or defeat. SYN invincible, unconquerable, unyielding, resolute, steadfast. ANT weak, submissive, defeatable, feeble. *Ex:* The Bengalis showed indomitable courage in 1952.

Industrious *(adj)* পরিশ্রমী — diligent and hard-working. SYN hard-working, diligent, assiduous, sedulous, busy. ANT lazy, idle, indolent, slothful. *Ex:* Bangladeshi farmers are very industrious.

Inevitable ★ *(adj)* অবশ্যম্ভাবী, অনিবার্য — certain to happen. SYN unavoidable, inescapable, certain, sure, inexorable. ANT avoidable, uncertain, preventable, doubtful. *Ex:* Death is inevitable.

Infamous *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — well known for a bad quality or deed. SYN notorious, disreputable, scandalous, ignominious. ANT famous, reputable, honourable, illustrious. *Ex:* He was an infamous smuggler. (Note: *infamous* is NOT the opposite of *famous* in the sense "unknown".)

Ingenious *(adj)* উদ্ভাবনী শক্তিসম্পন্ন — clever, original and inventive. SYN inventive, clever, creative, resourceful, original. ANT unimaginative, dull, stupid, uninventive. *Ex:* What an ingenious idea!

Ingenuous GRE *(adj)* সরল, অকপট — innocent and unsuspecting; frank. SYN naive, innocent, artless, guileless, frank. ANT sly, crafty, cunning, disingenuous, artful. *Ex:* The ingenuous girl believed every word.

Inherent *(adj)* অন্তর্নিহিত, সহজাত — existing as a natural, permanent part. SYN intrinsic, innate, built-in, essential, inborn. ANT extrinsic, acquired, external, incidental. *Ex:* There are risks inherent in every business.

Inhibit *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া, সংযত করা — to hinder or restrain. SYN restrain, hinder, check, curb, suppress. ANT encourage, promote, allow, foster. *Ex:* Fear inhibits creativity.

Innate *(adj)* সহজাত — inborn; natural. SYN inborn, inherent, natural, intrinsic, congenital. ANT acquired, learned, cultivated, extrinsic. *Ex:* She has an innate talent for music.

Innocuous GRE *(adj)* নিরীহ, ক্ষতিহীন — not harmful or offensive. SYN harmless, inoffensive, safe, benign, mild. ANT harmful, noxious, dangerous, offensive, pernicious. *Ex:* It was an innocuous joke.

Insipid *(adj)* স্বাদহীন; নীরস — lacking flavour; dull. SYN tasteless, bland, flavourless; dull, boring, uninteresting. ANT tasty, flavourful; interesting, lively, exciting. *Ex:* The hospital food was insipid.

Insolent ★ *(adj)* উদ্ধত, অবিনয়ী — rude and disrespectful. SYN rude, impertinent, impudent, insulting, arrogant. ANT polite, respectful, courteous, humble, civil. *Ex:* The insolent clerk was suspended.

Instigate *(v)* উসকানি দেওয়া — to bring about or provoke an action. SYN provoke, incite, initiate, foment, stir up. ANT stop, prevent, discourage, quell, suppress. *Ex:* He was arrested for instigating the riot.

Intrepid ★ *(adj)* নির্ভীক — fearless; adventurous. SYN fearless, brave, bold, daring, valiant, dauntless. ANT timid, cowardly, fearful, afraid, craven. *Ex:* The intrepid explorer reached the North Pole.

Intricate *(adj)* জটিল — very complicated or detailed. SYN complex, complicated, elaborate, involved, convoluted. ANT simple, plain, straightforward, easy. *Ex:* Nakshi kantha has intricate designs.

Inundate *(v)* প্লাবিত করা — to flood; to overwhelm. SYN flood, deluge, submerge, swamp, overwhelm. ANT drain, dry up, trickle. *Ex:* The office was inundated with complaints.

Invincible *(adj)* অজেয় — too powerful to be defeated. SYN unbeatable, unconquerable, indomitable, invulnerable. ANT beatable, vulnerable, weak, conquerable. *Ex:* The army thought it was invincible.

Irascible GRE *(adj)* বদমেজাজি, খিটখিটে — easily made angry. SYN irritable, short-tempered, testy, choleric, cantankerous. ANT calm, even-tempered, placid, good-natured. *Ex:* The irascible old man shouted at the children.

Irrational *(adj)* অযৌক্তিক — not logical or reasonable. SYN illogical, unreasonable, absurd, senseless, groundless. ANT rational, logical, reasonable, sensible. *Ex:* He has an irrational fear of cats.

Itinerant *(adj)* ভ্রাম্যমাণ, যাযাবর — travelling from place to place. SYN wandering, roving, nomadic, migrant, peripatetic. ANT settled, stationary, resident, sedentary. *Ex:* Baul singers were itinerant musicians.

J

Jaded *(adj)* ক্লান্ত, অবসন্ন — tired or lacking enthusiasm after too much of something. SYN weary, exhausted, bored, sated, world-weary. ANT fresh, eager, enthusiastic, refreshed. *Ex:* After years of routine work, he felt jaded.

Jeopardy *(n)* বিপদ, ঝুঁকি — danger of loss or harm. SYN danger, peril, risk, hazard, threat. ANT safety, security, protection. *Ex:* Many jobs are in jeopardy.

Jocular *(adj)* রসিক, কৌতুকপূর্ণ — fond of joking; humorous. SYN humorous, playful, witty, facetious, jovial. ANT serious, solemn, grave, sober. *Ex:* He was in a jocular mood.

Jovial *(adj)* হাসিখুশি, প্রাণবন্ত — cheerful and friendly. SYN cheerful, jolly, merry, genial, convivial. ANT gloomy, morose, sullen, sad. *Ex:* Our jovial uncle kept everyone laughing.

Jubilant *(adj)* উল্লসিত — feeling great happiness, especially at success. SYN joyful, elated, exultant, triumphant, overjoyed. ANT sad, dejected, despondent, depressed. *Ex:* Jubilant crowds celebrated the victory.

Judicious ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ — having good judgement. SYN wise, prudent, sensible, sagacious, discerning. ANT injudicious, foolish, rash, unwise, imprudent. *Ex:* A judicious use of resources is needed.

K

Keen *(adj)* আগ্রহী; তীক্ষ্ণ — eager; sharp. SYN eager, enthusiastic, avid; sharp, acute, piercing. ANT reluctant, indifferent; blunt, dull. *Ex:* She is keen on learning French.

Kindle *(v)* প্রজ্বলিত করা; জাগিয়ে তোলা — to light a fire; to arouse a feeling. SYN ignite, light; arouse, stir, inspire, provoke. ANT extinguish, quench, douse; dampen, suppress. *Ex:* The teacher kindled our interest in poetry.

Knave *(n)* দুর্বৃত্ত, প্রতারক — a dishonest man. SYN rogue, scoundrel, villain, rascal, cheat. ANT gentleman, hero, saint, honest man. *Ex:* The knave cheated the old woman.

Knack *(n)* দক্ষতা, কৌশল — a special skill or ability. SYN talent, skill, flair, gift, aptitude. ANT inability, ineptitude, incompetence. *Ex:* He has a knack for making friends.

L

Laconic ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, সংক্ষিপ্ত — using very few words. SYN brief, concise, terse, succinct, taciturn. ANT verbose, wordy, garrulous, loquacious, long-winded. *Ex:* His laconic reply was simply "No."

Lament *(v/n)* বিলাপ করা; শোক — to express deep sorrow. SYN mourn, grieve, bewail, deplore; elegy. ANT rejoice, celebrate, exult. *Ex:* The nation lamented the death of the poet.

Languid *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, অলস — slow and relaxed; lacking energy. SYN sluggish, lethargic, listless, lazy, weak. ANT energetic, lively, vigorous, active. *Ex:* The heat made everyone languid.

Lavish ★ *(adj/v)* প্রচুর, অমিতব্যয়ী; অকাতরে দেওয়া — rich and generous; to give freely. SYN sumptuous, luxurious, extravagant, generous; heap, shower. ANT meagre, frugal, simple, sparse; withhold. *Ex:* They held a lavish wedding party.

Lax *(adj)* শিথিল, ঢিলেঢালা — not strict or careful enough. SYN slack, careless, negligent, lenient, loose. ANT strict, rigorous, stringent, careful. *Ex:* Security at the airport was lax.

Legitimate *(adj)* বৈধ, ন্যায্য — lawful; reasonable. SYN legal, lawful, valid, rightful; justifiable, reasonable. ANT illegal, illegitimate, unlawful; unjustified. *Ex:* Workers have legitimate demands.

Lenient ★ *(adj)* নরম, উদার (শাস্তিতে) — merciful or tolerant in punishment. SYN merciful, tolerant, forgiving, clement, indulgent. ANT strict, severe, harsh, stern, rigorous. *Ex:* The judge was lenient with the first-time offender.

Lethargic *(adj)* অলস, নিস্তেজ — sluggish and apathetic. SYN sluggish, listless, lazy, languid, inert. ANT energetic, active, lively, vigorous, dynamic. *Ex:* I felt lethargic after a heavy lunch.

Liberal *(adj)* উদার; উদারপন্থী — generous; open to new ideas. SYN generous, bountiful; tolerant, broad-minded, progressive. ANT mean, stingy; conservative, bigoted, narrow-minded. *Ex:* He holds liberal views on education.

Linger *(v)* দীর্ঘক্ষণ থাকা, বিলম্ব করা — to stay longer than necessary. SYN remain, stay, loiter, dawdle, tarry, persist. ANT leave, depart, hurry, hasten. *Ex:* The smell of smoke lingered in the room.

Lofty *(adj)* সুউচ্চ; মহৎ; উদ্ধত — very tall; noble; haughty. SYN high, towering; noble, exalted, grand; arrogant, haughty. ANT low, short; base, ignoble; humble, modest. *Ex:* He has lofty ideals.

Loquacious ★ GRE *(adj)* বাচাল — very talkative. SYN talkative, garrulous, voluble, chatty, verbose. ANT taciturn, reticent, quiet, laconic, silent. *Ex:* The loquacious taxi driver talked all the way.

Lucid ★ *(adj)* স্পষ্ট, প্রাঞ্জল — easy to understand; clear. SYN clear, intelligible, plain, transparent, comprehensible. ANT obscure, confusing, vague, unclear, ambiguous. *Ex:* The book explains grammar in lucid language.

Lucrative ★ *(adj)* লাভজনক — producing a great deal of profit. SYN profitable, gainful, remunerative, rewarding, fruitful. ANT unprofitable, unrewarding, loss-making. *Ex:* Shrimp farming is a lucrative business.

Ludicrous *(adj)* হাস্যকর — so foolish as to be amusing. SYN absurd, ridiculous, preposterous, laughable, farcical. ANT sensible, reasonable, logical, serious. *Ex:* It is ludicrous to charge 500 taka for a cup of tea.

Luminous *(adj)* উজ্জ্বল, দীপ্তিমান — giving off light; very bright. SYN bright, shining, radiant, glowing, brilliant. ANT dark, dim, dull, shadowy, gloomy. *Ex:* The watch has a luminous dial.

Lurid *(adj)* ভয়ংকর; অতি উজ্জ্বল — shocking and sensational; unpleasantly bright. SYN sensational, graphic, shocking; garish, glaring. ANT mild, restrained; pale, dull. *Ex:* The newspaper printed lurid details of the murder.

Luxuriant *(adj)* ঘন ও প্রচুর — (of vegetation or hair) rich and plentiful. SYN lush, abundant, profuse, dense, thick. ANT sparse, thin, scanty, barren. *Ex:* The forest has luxuriant vegetation. (Do not confuse with *luxurious* = expensive and comfortable.)

M

Magnanimous ★ *(adj)* মহানুভব, উদারচিত্ত — generous or forgiving, especially towards a rival. SYN generous, noble, big-hearted, charitable, benevolent. ANT mean, petty, selfish, vindictive, small-minded. *Ex:* He was magnanimous in victory.

Magnificent *(adj)* চমৎকার, জাঁকালো — impressively beautiful or grand. SYN splendid, grand, superb, majestic, glorious. ANT modest, ordinary, poor, unimpressive. *Ex:* The Taj Mahal is a magnificent monument.

Malevolent *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপূর্ণ — wishing evil to others. SYN malicious, spiteful, hostile, vindictive, malignant. ANT benevolent, kind, friendly, well-meaning. *Ex:* He gave me a malevolent stare.

Malicious *(adj)* বিদ্বেষপরায়ণ — intending to do harm. SYN spiteful, malevolent, vicious, hateful, mean. ANT kind, benevolent, friendly, good-natured. *Ex:* Spreading malicious rumours is a crime.

Malign *(v/adj)* নিন্দা করা; ক্ষতিকর — to speak badly of; harmful. SYN slander, defame, vilify, disparage; evil, harmful. ANT praise, defend, extol; benign, kind. *Ex:* Do not malign a person behind his back.

Malleable GRE *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — able to be shaped; easily influenced. SYN pliable, ductile, soft; impressionable, tractable, flexible. ANT rigid, hard, brittle; intractable, stubborn. *Ex:* Gold is a malleable metal.

Mammoth *(adj)* বিশাল — huge. SYN huge, giant, enormous, colossal, gigantic. ANT tiny, small, minute, minuscule. *Ex:* Building the Padma Bridge was a mammoth task.

Mandatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by law or rules. SYN compulsory, obligatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, discretionary, elective. *Ex:* Wearing a helmet is mandatory for motorcyclists.

Manifest *(adj/v)* স্পষ্ট; প্রকাশ করা — clear and obvious; to show. SYN obvious, clear, evident, apparent, patent; display, reveal. ANT hidden, latent, obscure; conceal, hide. *Ex:* His guilt was manifest.

Meagre ★ *(adj)* স্বল্প, অপর্যাপ্ত — lacking in quantity or quality. SYN scanty, insufficient, inadequate, paltry, sparse. ANT abundant, ample, plentiful, copious, generous. *Ex:* He lives on a meagre income.

Meek *(adj)* নম্র, শান্ত — quiet, gentle and easily imposed on. SYN humble, docile, submissive, mild, gentle. ANT assertive, bold, arrogant, aggressive. *Ex:* Blessed are the meek.

Mendacious GRE *(adj)* মিথ্যাবাদী — not telling the truth. SYN lying, untruthful, dishonest, deceitful, false. ANT truthful, honest, sincere, veracious. *Ex:* The mendacious advertisement misled buyers.

Mercenary *(adj/n)* অর্থলোভী; ভাড়াটে সৈন্য — working only for money; a hired soldier. SYN greedy, venal, grasping, money-minded. ANT altruistic, unselfish, generous, idealistic. *Ex:* His motives are purely mercenary.

Meticulous ★ *(adj)* অতি যত্নশীল, খুঁটিনাটি বিষয়ে মনোযোগী — showing great attention to detail. SYN careful, precise, painstaking, scrupulous, thorough. ANT careless, sloppy, slapdash, negligent. *Ex:* She keeps meticulous records.

Mitigate ★ *(v)* প্রশমিত করা — to make less severe. SYN alleviate, reduce, lessen, ease, allay, palliate. ANT aggravate, intensify, worsen, exacerbate. *Ex:* Planting trees helps mitigate climate change.

Modest ★ *(adj)* বিনয়ী; পরিমিত — not boastful; moderate. SYN humble, unassuming, unpretentious; moderate, limited. ANT arrogant, boastful, vain; excessive, lavish. *Ex:* She is modest about her achievements.

Mollify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN pacify, placate, appease, soothe, calm. ANT provoke, enrage, anger, incite. *Ex:* The apology mollified the angry customer.

Monotonous *(adj)* একঘেয়ে — dull because unchanging. SYN boring, tedious, dull, repetitive, humdrum. ANT interesting, varied, exciting, lively. *Ex:* Factory work can be monotonous.

Morose *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গোমড়ামুখো — sullen and ill-tempered. SYN sullen, gloomy, glum, sulky, moody. ANT cheerful, happy, jovial, genial. *Ex:* He became morose after losing his job.

Mundane *(adj)* জাগতিক; সাধারণ — ordinary and dull; worldly. SYN ordinary, routine, commonplace, humdrum; worldly, earthly. ANT extraordinary, exciting, unusual; spiritual, heavenly. *Ex:* She was tired of mundane household chores.

Munificent GRE *(adj)* অতি উদার, দানশীল — very generous. SYN generous, bountiful, liberal, lavish, philanthropic. ANT mean, stingy, miserly, parsimonious. *Ex:* The munificent donor funded the whole library.

Myriad *(adj/n)* অসংখ্য — countless; a very great number. SYN countless, innumerable, numerous, multitudinous. ANT few, limited, scant. *Ex:* The night sky has myriad stars.

N

Naive *(adj)* সরল, অনভিজ্ঞ — lacking experience or judgement. SYN innocent, ingenuous, gullible, credulous, unsophisticated. ANT sophisticated, worldly, experienced, shrewd. *Ex:* It is naive to believe every news on Facebook.

Nadir *(n)* নিম্নতম বিন্দু — the lowest point. SYN bottom, lowest point, depths, rock bottom. ANT zenith, peak, acme, summit, apex. *Ex:* His career reached its nadir after the scandal.

Nascent GRE *(adj)* নবজাত, উদীয়মান — just coming into existence. SYN emerging, budding, developing, incipient, embryonic. ANT mature, developed, established, dying. *Ex:* The nascent democracy faced many challenges.

Nefarious *(adj)* জঘন্য, দুষ্ট — wicked or criminal. SYN wicked, evil, villainous, heinous, iniquitous. ANT good, virtuous, honourable, noble. *Ex:* The gang was involved in nefarious activities.

Negligent *(adj)* অবহেলাকারী — failing to take proper care. SYN careless, neglectful, remiss, lax, heedless. ANT careful, attentive, diligent, conscientious. *Ex:* The negligent driver caused the accident.

Nimble *(adj)* চটপটে — quick and light in movement or thought. SYN agile, quick, deft, sprightly, alert. ANT clumsy, slow, sluggish, awkward. *Ex:* Her nimble fingers wove the mat quickly.

Nocturnal *(adj)* নিশাচর — active at night. SYN nightly, nighttime, nighttime-active. ANT diurnal, daily, daytime. *Ex:* The owl is a nocturnal bird.

Notorious ★ *(adj)* কুখ্যাত — famous for something bad. SYN infamous, disreputable, scandalous, ill-famed. ANT reputable, honourable, respected, acclaimed. *Ex:* He is a notorious criminal.

Novice ★ *(n)* শিক্ষানবিশ, আনাড়ি — a beginner. SYN beginner, learner, apprentice, tyro, neophyte, novitiate. ANT expert, veteran, master, professional. *Ex:* This book is written for novices in grammar.

Noxious *(adj)* বিষাক্ত, ক্ষতিকর — harmful or poisonous. SYN poisonous, toxic, harmful, deadly, pernicious. ANT harmless, wholesome, beneficial, innocuous. *Ex:* The factory releases noxious fumes.

Nullify *(v)* বাতিল করা — to make legally void; to cancel out. SYN annul, cancel, invalidate, revoke, negate. ANT validate, confirm, enforce, ratify. *Ex:* The court nullified the election result.

O

Obdurate GRE *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে, কঠোরহৃদয় — stubbornly refusing to change. SYN stubborn, obstinate, unyielding, inflexible, intransigent. ANT flexible, yielding, compliant, amenable. *Ex:* The obdurate official refused every request.

Obese *(adj)* স্থূলকায় — very fat. SYN fat, overweight, corpulent, portly, stout. ANT thin, slim, lean, skinny, emaciated. *Ex:* Fast food is making children obese.

Obligatory *(adj)* বাধ্যতামূলক — required by rule or custom. SYN compulsory, mandatory, required, binding, requisite. ANT optional, voluntary, elective. *Ex:* Attendance at the seminar is obligatory.

Obscure ★ *(adj/v)* অস্পষ্ট; অখ্যাত; ঢেকে দেওয়া — not clear; not well known; to hide. SYN unclear, vague, cryptic; unknown, little-known; conceal, cloud. ANT clear, plain; famous, eminent; reveal, clarify. *Ex:* He was born in an obscure village.

Obsequious GRE *(adj)* চাটুকারপূর্ণ, তোষামুদে — too eager to please or obey. SYN servile, sycophantic, fawning, ingratiating, subservient. ANT domineering, assertive, arrogant, independent. *Ex:* The obsequious clerk bowed to every officer.

Obsolete ★ *(adj)* অপ্রচলিত, সেকেলে — no longer used; out of date. SYN outdated, outmoded, antiquated, archaic, defunct. ANT current, modern, contemporary, new, in use. *Ex:* Typewriters are now obsolete.

Obstinate ★ *(adj)* একগুঁয়ে — stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion. SYN stubborn, headstrong, obdurate, mulish, pig-headed, adamant. ANT flexible, compliant, docile, amenable, tractable. *Ex:* The obstinate child refused to eat.

Obstruct *(v)* বাধা দেওয়া — to block; to hinder. SYN block, impede, hinder, hamper, bar. ANT clear, open, assist, facilitate, help. *Ex:* Illegal shops obstruct the footpaths.

Obtuse *(adj)* স্থূলবুদ্ধি; স্থূল (কোণ) — slow to understand; (of an angle) more than 90°. SYN stupid, slow, dull, dense, imperceptive. ANT bright, sharp, acute, perceptive, astute. *Ex:* He was too obtuse to see the joke.

Ominous *(adj)* অশুভ — giving the impression that something bad will happen. SYN threatening, menacing, sinister, foreboding, inauspicious. ANT auspicious, promising, favourable, propitious. *Ex:* Ominous dark clouds gathered in the sky.

Omnipotent *(adj)* সর্বশক্তিমান — having unlimited power. SYN all-powerful, almighty, supreme, invincible. ANT powerless, impotent, weak, helpless. *Ex:* Muslims believe Allah is omnipotent.

Omniscient *(adj)* সর্বজ্ঞ — knowing everything. SYN all-knowing, all-seeing, all-wise. ANT ignorant, unknowing, uninformed. *Ex:* The novel has an omniscient narrator.

Onerous *(adj)* কষ্টসাধ্য, ভারী (দায়িত্ব) — involving heavy effort or difficulty. SYN burdensome, arduous, laborious, heavy, taxing. ANT easy, light, effortless, simple, trivial. *Ex:* Running a big family is an onerous task.

Opaque *(adj)* অস্বচ্ছ; দুর্বোধ্য — not able to be seen through; hard to understand. SYN non-transparent, cloudy; obscure, unclear, impenetrable. ANT transparent, clear, translucent; lucid, plain. *Ex:* The decision-making process is opaque.

Optimistic *(adj)* আশাবাদী — hopeful about the future. SYN hopeful, positive, sanguine, confident, upbeat. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despairing, cynical. *Ex:* We are optimistic about our economic growth.

Opulent *(adj)* ঐশ্বর্যশালী, জাঁকজমকপূর্ণ — rich and luxurious. SYN luxurious, lavish, sumptuous, affluent, wealthy. ANT poor, impoverished, humble, shabby, austere. *Ex:* The Nawab lived in an opulent palace.

Ostensible *(adj)* বাহ্যিক, আপাত — stated or appearing to be true, but not necessarily so. SYN apparent, outward, seeming, professed, supposed. ANT real, actual, genuine, true. *Ex:* The ostensible reason for the visit was trade.

Ostentatious ★ GRE *(adj)* জাঁকালো, লোক-দেখানো — showy, designed to impress. SYN showy, flamboyant, pretentious, flashy, extravagant. ANT modest, simple, unpretentious, restrained, plain. *Ex:* Their ostentatious wedding was criticised.

Ostracise *(v)* একঘরে করা — to exclude from a society or group. SYN exclude, banish, shun, boycott, exile. ANT include, accept, welcome, embrace. *Ex:* The villagers ostracised the family.

Outrageous *(adj)* অত্যন্ত আপত্তিকর — shockingly bad or excessive. SYN shocking, scandalous, atrocious, monstrous, exorbitant. ANT acceptable, reasonable, moderate, mild. *Ex:* The price of medicine is outrageous.

P

Pacify *(v)* শান্ত করা — to calm someone's anger. SYN calm, soothe, appease, placate, mollify. ANT enrage, provoke, anger, agitate. *Ex:* The mother pacified the crying baby.

Palpable *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য; স্পষ্ট — able to be touched or felt; obvious. SYN tangible, touchable; obvious, evident, clear, manifest. ANT intangible, impalpable; unclear, hidden. *Ex:* There was palpable tension in the room.

Paltry *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — (of an amount) very small; worthless. SYN meagre, trifling, negligible, insignificant, petty. ANT considerable, substantial, large, significant. *Ex:* Workers are paid a paltry wage.

Panacea GRE *(n)* সর্বরোগহর ঔষধ — a solution for all problems. SYN cure-all, remedy, universal solution, elixir. ANT poison, bane, affliction. *Ex:* Education is not a panacea for all social ills.

Paradox *(n)* আপাতবিরোধী সত্য — a statement that seems absurd but may be true. SYN contradiction, anomaly, inconsistency, enigma, puzzle. ANT consistency, truism, certainty. *Ex:* "The child is father of the man" is a paradox.

Paragon *(n)* আদর্শ, উৎকৃষ্ট দৃষ্টান্ত — a perfect example of a quality. SYN model, ideal, epitome, exemplar, archetype. ANT failure, disgrace, mediocrity. *Ex:* He is a paragon of honesty.

Parsimonious GRE *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend money; extremely frugal. SYN stingy, miserly, mean, tight-fisted, niggardly, penurious. ANT generous, extravagant, lavish, munificent, liberal. *Ex:* The parsimonious man refused to buy new shoes.

Partisan *(adj/n)* পক্ষপাতদুষ্ট; দলীয় সমর্থক — strongly supporting a party; biased. SYN biased, partial, one-sided, prejudiced; supporter, adherent. ANT impartial, neutral, unbiased, objective. *Ex:* The media should not be partisan.

Paucity ★ *(n)* স্বল্পতা, অভাব — the presence of something in small quantities. SYN scarcity, dearth, shortage, lack, insufficiency. ANT abundance, plenty, profusion, surplus. *Ex:* The research was weak due to a paucity of data.

Peevish *(adj)* খিটখিটে — easily irritated. SYN irritable, petulant, cross, grumpy, testy. ANT good-natured, easy-going, cheerful, genial. *Ex:* The sick child was peevish all day.

Penitent *(adj)* অনুতপ্ত — feeling sorry for wrongdoing. SYN repentant, remorseful, contrite, regretful, apologetic. ANT unrepentant, impenitent, remorseless, defiant. *Ex:* The penitent thief returned the money.

Pensive *(adj)* চিন্তামগ্ন — engaged in deep, often sad, thought. SYN thoughtful, reflective, contemplative, meditative, wistful. ANT thoughtless, carefree, unthinking, shallow. *Ex:* She sat in a pensive mood by the river.

Penury *(n)* চরম দারিদ্র্য — extreme poverty. SYN poverty, destitution, indigence, want, need. ANT wealth, affluence, opulence, prosperity, luxury. *Ex:* The poet died in penury.

Perennial *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী; বহুবর্ষজীবী — lasting a very long time; (of plants) living several years. SYN lasting, enduring, perpetual, constant, everlasting. ANT temporary, ephemeral, transient, annual. *Ex:* Traffic jams are a perennial problem in Dhaka.

Perfidious GRE *(adj)* বিশ্বাসঘাতক — deceitful and untrustworthy. SYN treacherous, disloyal, faithless, traitorous, false. ANT loyal, faithful, trustworthy, true. *Ex:* Mir Jafar's perfidious act led to the fall of Bengal.

Perfunctory GRE *(adj)* দায়সারা — carried out with minimum effort or care. SYN cursory, superficial, careless, hasty, token. ANT thorough, careful, painstaking, meticulous. *Ex:* The guard gave our bags a perfunctory check.

Peripheral *(adj)* প্রান্তিক, গৌণ — on the edge; of minor importance. SYN marginal, outer, minor, secondary, incidental. ANT central, core, main, essential, crucial. *Ex:* These are peripheral issues; let us focus on the main one.

Pernicious ★ GRE *(adj)* ক্ষতিকর, সর্বনাশা — having a harmful effect, especially gradually. SYN harmful, destructive, deleterious, damaging, baneful. ANT beneficial, harmless, benign, wholesome. *Ex:* Corruption has a pernicious effect on society.

Perpetual *(adj)* চিরস্থায়ী, অবিরাম — never ending or changing. SYN everlasting, eternal, permanent, continual, unending. ANT temporary, momentary, transient, brief. *Ex:* The Permanent Settlement made zamindari perpetual.

Perplex *(v)* বিভ্রান্ত করা — to make someone confused. SYN puzzle, baffle, bewilder, confuse, confound. ANT enlighten, clarify, explain. *Ex:* The question perplexed even the teacher.

Persevere *(v)* অধ্যবসায় চালিয়ে যাওয়া — to continue despite difficulty. SYN persist, continue, carry on, keep going, endure. ANT give up, quit, abandon, desist, falter. *Ex:* If you persevere, you will succeed.

Pertinent *(adj)* প্রাসঙ্গিক — relevant to the subject. SYN relevant, applicable, apposite, germane, apt. ANT irrelevant, inapplicable, unrelated, extraneous. *Ex:* She asked a very pertinent question.

Pessimistic *(adj)* নৈরাশ্যবাদী — expecting the worst. SYN gloomy, negative, cynical, despairing, defeatist. ANT optimistic, hopeful, positive, sanguine. *Ex:* Don't be so pessimistic about the result.

Philanthropist *(n)* জনহিতৈষী, মানবপ্রেমী — a person who helps others, especially by donating money. SYN benefactor, humanitarian, patron, donor, altruist. ANT misanthrope, miser, egoist. *Ex:* Haji Muhammad Mohsin was a great philanthropist.

Placid *(adj)* শান্ত, স্থির — calm and peaceful. SYN calm, tranquil, serene, peaceful, unruffled. ANT agitated, excitable, turbulent, stormy. *Ex:* The placid lake reflected the hills.

Plausible *(adj)* আপাতগ্রাহ্য, বিশ্বাসযোগ্য — seeming reasonable or probable. SYN credible, believable, reasonable, likely, convincing. ANT implausible, unlikely, improbable, unbelievable. *Ex:* He offered a plausible explanation.

Plethora GRE *(n)* প্রাচুর্য, আধিক্য — an excess of something. SYN excess, surplus, glut, surfeit, abundance. ANT shortage, lack, scarcity, dearth, paucity. *Ex:* There is a plethora of coaching centres in Dhaka.

Pliable *(adj)* নমনীয়; সহজে প্রভাবিত — easily bent; easily influenced. SYN flexible, pliant, malleable, supple; docile, compliant. ANT rigid, stiff, inflexible; stubborn, obstinate. *Ex:* Cane is pliable and good for furniture.

Pompous *(adj)* দাম্ভিক, আড়ম্বরপূর্ণ — self-important; grand but solemn. SYN self-important, pretentious, arrogant, conceited, bombastic. ANT modest, humble, unpretentious, simple. *Ex:* The pompous officer liked to hear himself talk.

Ponderous *(adj)* ভারী; একঘেয়ে — slow and clumsy because of great weight; dull. SYN heavy, cumbersome, unwieldy; laboured, dull, tedious. ANT light, graceful; lively, interesting. *Ex:* The essay was written in a ponderous style.

Potent *(adj)* শক্তিশালী — having great power or effect. SYN powerful, strong, effective, forceful, mighty. ANT impotent, weak, ineffective, powerless. *Ex:* This is a potent medicine.

Pragmatic ★ *(adj)* বাস্তববাদী — dealing with things sensibly and realistically. SYN practical, realistic, sensible, matter-of-fact, down-to-earth. ANT idealistic, impractical, unrealistic, romantic. *Ex:* We need a pragmatic solution to the traffic problem.

Precarious *(adj)* অনিশ্চিত, বিপজ্জনক — not secure; dangerously likely to fall. SYN insecure, unstable, risky, perilous, shaky. ANT secure, stable, safe, steady. *Ex:* Many day labourers live a precarious life.

Precocious *(adj)* অকালপক্ব — (of a child) developed earlier than usual. SYN advanced, gifted, mature, forward, talented. ANT backward, slow, retarded, immature. *Ex:* The precocious child could read at three.

Prejudice *(n)* কুসংস্কার, পূর্বধারণা — an unfair opinion not based on reason. SYN bias, partiality, preconception, bigotry, intolerance. ANT fairness, impartiality, tolerance, objectivity. *Ex:* We must fight racial prejudice.

Prevalent *(adj)* প্রচলিত, ব্যাপক — widespread in a particular area or time. SYN widespread, common, prevailing, current, rampant. ANT rare, uncommon, infrequent, scarce. *Ex:* Dengue is prevalent during the monsoon.

Prodigal ★ *(adj)* অমিতব্যয়ী — wasteful with money. SYN wasteful, extravagant, spendthrift, profligate, improvident. ANT thrifty, frugal, economical, careful, prudent. *Ex:* The prodigal son wasted his father's wealth.

Prodigious *(adj)* বিস্ময়কর, বিশাল — remarkably great in size or degree. SYN enormous, huge, colossal; amazing, phenomenal, extraordinary. ANT tiny, small; ordinary, unremarkable. *Ex:* She has a prodigious memory.

Profane *(adj/v)* অপবিত্র; অপবিত্র করা — not religious; disrespectful to sacred things. SYN secular, irreverent, blasphemous; desecrate, defile. ANT sacred, holy, religious; sanctify, consecrate. *Ex:* He was punished for using profane language.

Proficient *(adj)* দক্ষ — competent or skilled. SYN skilled, expert, adept, accomplished, competent. ANT incompetent, inept, unskilled, amateurish. *Ex:* She is proficient in three languages.

Profound ★ *(adj)* গভীর — very great; showing deep knowledge. SYN deep, intense, great; wise, learned, philosophical. ANT shallow, superficial, slight, trivial. *Ex:* Tagore's poems have profound meaning.

Profuse *(adj)* প্রচুর — abundant; plentiful. SYN abundant, copious, plentiful, lavish, prolific. ANT scanty, meagre, sparse, scarce. *Ex:* He offered profuse apologies.

Prolific ★ *(adj)* প্রচুর সৃষ্টিশীল, উর্বর — producing much fruit or many works. SYN productive, fertile, fruitful, abundant, creative. ANT unproductive, barren, sterile, unfruitful. *Ex:* Humayun Ahmed was a prolific writer.

Prompt *(adj/v)* তৎপর; প্ররোচিত করা — done without delay; to cause or encourage. SYN quick, immediate, punctual, swift; prompt, induce, provoke. ANT late, slow, tardy, delayed; deter. *Ex:* Thank you for your prompt reply.

Propagate *(v)* প্রচার করা; বংশবিস্তার করা — to spread an idea; to breed. SYN spread, disseminate, promote, circulate; breed, reproduce. ANT suppress, restrict, conceal; kill, destroy. *Ex:* They tried to propagate false news.

Propitious GRE *(adj)* অনুকূল, শুভ — giving or indicating a good chance of success. SYN favourable, auspicious, promising, advantageous, opportune. ANT unfavourable, inauspicious, ominous, adverse. *Ex:* It is a propitious time to invest.

Prosaic *(adj)* নীরস, গদ্যময় — lacking imagination or poetic beauty. SYN dull, ordinary, unimaginative, mundane, humdrum. ANT imaginative, poetic, interesting, exciting. *Ex:* He gave a prosaic description of a beautiful sunset.

Prosperity *(n)* সমৃদ্ধি — the state of being successful, especially financially. SYN wealth, affluence, success, riches, opulence. ANT poverty, adversity, failure, misfortune, penury. *Ex:* We wish for peace and prosperity.

Prudent ★ *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, বিবেচক — acting with care for the future. SYN wise, judicious, sensible, careful, circumspect, provident. ANT imprudent, rash, foolish, reckless, careless. *Ex:* It is prudent to save money for bad days.

Pugnacious GRE *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয়, ঝগড়াটে — eager to argue or fight. SYN combative, belligerent, aggressive, quarrelsome, bellicose. ANT peaceful, peaceable, conciliatory, mild. *Ex:* The pugnacious player was sent off.

Punctual *(adj)* সময়ানুবর্তী — happening or doing things at the agreed time. SYN on time, prompt, timely, regular. ANT late, tardy, unpunctual, delayed. *Ex:* Be punctual for the interview.

Pungent *(adj)* ঝাঁঝালো, তীক্ষ্ণ — having a sharp, strong taste or smell; biting. SYN strong, sharp, acrid, spicy; caustic, biting. ANT mild, bland, sweet; gentle. *Ex:* Mustard oil has a pungent smell.

Q

Quaint *(adj)* অদ্ভুত সুন্দর, সেকেলে আকর্ষণীয় — attractively unusual or old-fashioned. SYN charming, picturesque, old-fashioned, curious, unusual. ANT modern, ordinary, normal, commonplace. *Ex:* They stayed in a quaint old cottage.

Qualm *(n)* দ্বিধা, অস্বস্তি — an uneasy feeling of doubt or guilt. SYN misgiving, doubt, scruple, hesitation, unease. ANT confidence, certainty, assurance. *Ex:* He had no qualms about lying.

Quarrelsome *(adj)* কলহপ্রিয় — inclined to argue. SYN argumentative, belligerent, pugnacious, contentious, combative. ANT peaceful, peaceable, easy-going, friendly. *Ex:* The quarrelsome neighbour fought with everyone.

Quell *(v)* দমন করা — to put an end to a rebellion or disorder; to calm a fear. SYN suppress, crush, quash, subdue; allay, calm. ANT incite, provoke, encourage, foment, stir up. *Ex:* The police quelled the riot.

Querulous GRE *(adj)* খিটখিটে, অভিযোগপ্রবণ — complaining in a whining manner. SYN complaining, peevish, petulant, irritable, fretful. ANT contented, uncomplaining, cheerful, easy-going. *Ex:* The querulous patient annoyed the nurses.

Quiescent GRE *(adj)* নিষ্ক্রিয়, শান্ত — in a state of inactivity. SYN inactive, dormant, latent, passive, still. ANT active, busy, agitated, dynamic. *Ex:* The disease was quiescent for years.

Quixotic GRE *(adj)* অবাস্তব আদর্শবাদী — extremely idealistic and impractical. SYN idealistic, unrealistic, romantic, visionary, impractical. ANT practical, realistic, pragmatic, sensible. *Ex:* His plan to end poverty in a year was quixotic.

R

Rampant *(adj)* ব্যাপক, অনিয়ন্ত্রিত — (of something bad) flourishing and spreading unchecked. SYN widespread, unchecked, uncontrolled, rife, prevalent. ANT controlled, restrained, limited, rare. *Ex:* Corruption is rampant in some offices.

Rancour *(n)* বিদ্বেষ, তিক্ততা — bitterness or resentment, especially long-lasting. SYN bitterness, resentment, malice, animosity, spite. ANT goodwill, friendship, harmony, kindness. *Ex:* He spoke without rancour about his rivals.

Rapacious GRE *(adj)* লোভী, লুণ্ঠনপ্রবণ — aggressively greedy. SYN greedy, grasping, avaricious, predatory, voracious. ANT generous, unselfish, content, liberal. *Ex:* The rapacious landlord raised the rent again.

Rash *(adj)* হঠকারী — acting without careful thought. SYN reckless, hasty, impulsive, impetuous, foolhardy. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, considered. *Ex:* Don't take a rash decision.

Ravage *(v)* ধ্বংস করা — to cause severe damage. SYN devastate, destroy, ruin, wreck, despoil. ANT build, repair, restore, preserve. *Ex:* The cyclone ravaged the coastal area.

Rebuke *(v/n)* তিরস্কার করা — to express sharp disapproval. SYN reprimand, scold, reproach, admonish, chide. ANT praise, commend, compliment, approve. *Ex:* The boss rebuked him for being late.

Recalcitrant GRE *(adj)* অবাধ্য, একগুঁয়ে — uncooperative towards authority. SYN defiant, disobedient, intractable, unruly, refractory. ANT obedient, compliant, docile, amenable. *Ex:* The recalcitrant student refused to wear the uniform.

Reckless *(adj)* বেপরোয়া — without thinking about danger. SYN rash, careless, heedless, foolhardy, daredevil. ANT careful, cautious, prudent, wary. *Ex:* Reckless driving causes accidents.

Reconcile *(v)* মিলন ঘটানো, সামঞ্জস্য করা — to restore friendly relations; to make compatible. SYN reunite, conciliate, pacify; harmonise, square. ANT estrange, alienate, divide, separate. *Ex:* The brothers were finally reconciled.

Redundant *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাহুল্য — no longer needed; unnecessary. SYN superfluous, unnecessary, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, needed, required. *Ex:* Remove the redundant words from the sentence. (See Chapter 38.)

Refute *(v)* খণ্ডন করা — to prove a statement to be wrong. SYN disprove, rebut, deny, negate, invalidate. ANT prove, confirm, support, verify. *Ex:* The scientist refuted the old theory.

Relinquish ★ *(v)* ছেড়ে দেওয়া — to give up voluntarily. SYN give up, abandon, surrender, renounce, cede, waive. ANT retain, keep, hold, maintain, seize. *Ex:* He relinquished his claim to the property.

Remorse *(n)* অনুশোচনা — deep regret for a wrong committed. SYN regret, repentance, contrition, guilt, penitence. ANT indifference, satisfaction, pride, shamelessness. *Ex:* The killer showed no remorse.

Renounce *(v)* ত্যাগ করা — to formally give up. SYN give up, relinquish, abandon, forgo, abdicate. ANT claim, keep, retain, assert, embrace. *Ex:* Buddha renounced worldly pleasures.

Replenish *(v)* পুনরায় পূর্ণ করা — to fill up again. SYN refill, restock, top up, renew, restore. ANT empty, drain, deplete, exhaust. *Ex:* Rain replenishes the ponds.

Reprimand *(v/n)* ভর্ৎসনা করা — to rebuke formally. SYN rebuke, reproach, scold, admonish, censure. ANT praise, commend, applaud, compliment. *Ex:* The officer was reprimanded for negligence.

Repudiate *(v)* প্রত্যাখ্যান করা, অস্বীকার করা — to refuse to accept or be associated with. SYN reject, disown, renounce, deny, disavow. ANT accept, acknowledge, embrace, endorse. *Ex:* He repudiated the allegations.

Resilient *(adj)* স্থিতিস্থাপক, সহনশীল — able to recover quickly from difficulties. SYN tough, strong, hardy, buoyant, adaptable. ANT vulnerable, weak, fragile, delicate. *Ex:* The people of the coastal belt are resilient.

Reticent ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী, চাপা স্বভাবের — not revealing one's thoughts readily. SYN reserved, taciturn, quiet, uncommunicative, restrained. ANT talkative, communicative, open, loquacious, garrulous. *Ex:* She was reticent about her personal life.

Revere *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to respect deeply. SYN respect, venerate, admire, honour, worship. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, disdain. *Ex:* Nazrul is revered as our national poet.

Robust ★ *(adj)* বলিষ্ঠ, শক্তিশালী — strong and healthy; strongly built. SYN strong, sturdy, vigorous, healthy, hardy. ANT weak, frail, feeble, delicate, sickly. *Ex:* The country needs a robust economy.

Rudimentary *(adj)* প্রাথমিক, মৌলিক — involving only basic matters; undeveloped. SYN basic, elementary, fundamental, primitive, crude. ANT advanced, sophisticated, developed, complex. *Ex:* He has only a rudimentary knowledge of computers.

Ruthless *(adj)* নির্দয় — without pity or compassion. SYN merciless, pitiless, cruel, heartless, brutal. ANT merciful, compassionate, kind, humane, lenient. *Ex:* The dictator was ruthless towards his opponents.

S

Sagacious GRE *(adj)* বিচক্ষণ, প্রাজ্ঞ — having good judgement; wise. SYN wise, shrewd, astute, perceptive, judicious. ANT foolish, unwise, stupid, obtuse. *Ex:* We need a sagacious leader in times of crisis.

Salient *(adj)* প্রধান, উল্লেখযোগ্য — most noticeable or important. SYN main, chief, prominent, striking, principal, conspicuous. ANT minor, insignificant, inconspicuous, peripheral. *Ex:* Write the salient features of the budget.

Salubrious GRE *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর — health-giving; pleasant. SYN healthy, wholesome, beneficial, salutary, invigorating. ANT unhealthy, insalubrious, harmful, noxious. *Ex:* The hill tracts have a salubrious climate.

Sanguine GRE *(adj)* আশাবাদী — optimistic, especially in a bad situation. SYN optimistic, hopeful, confident, positive, buoyant. ANT pessimistic, gloomy, despondent, hopeless. *Ex:* He is sanguine about his chances of winning.

Sarcastic *(adj)* ব্যঙ্গাত্মক — using irony to mock or show contempt. SYN ironic, sardonic, mocking, caustic, satirical. ANT sincere, kind, complimentary, respectful. *Ex:* His sarcastic comments hurt her.

Scanty ★ *(adj)* অপ্রতুল, অল্প — small or insufficient in quantity. SYN meagre, sparse, insufficient, inadequate, scant. ANT abundant, plentiful, ample, copious, sufficient. *Ex:* Rainfall was scanty this year.

Scrupulous *(adj)* নীতিনিষ্ঠ; অতি যত্নশীল — careful about doing what is right; very thorough. SYN honest, principled, conscientious; meticulous, careful. ANT unscrupulous, dishonest; careless, slapdash. *Ex:* She is scrupulous in her accounts.

Scrutinise *(v)* সূক্ষ্মভাবে পরীক্ষা করা — to examine closely. SYN examine, inspect, study, analyse, investigate. ANT ignore, overlook, glance at, skim. *Ex:* The examiner scrutinised the documents.

Sedate *(adj/v)* শান্ত, ধীরস্থির; ঘুমের ঔষধ দেওয়া — calm and unhurried; to calm with drugs. SYN calm, composed, serene, staid, dignified. ANT excited, agitated, wild, lively. *Ex:* We walked at a sedate pace.

Serene *(adj)* শান্ত, প্রশান্ত — calm, peaceful and untroubled. SYN calm, tranquil, peaceful, placid, composed. ANT agitated, turbulent, stormy, troubled, noisy. *Ex:* The village looked serene in the moonlight.

Servile *(adj)* দাসসুলভ, হীন — too willing to serve or please others. SYN obsequious, subservient, sycophantic, fawning, submissive. ANT independent, assertive, proud, domineering. *Ex:* His servile attitude towards the boss was disgusting.

Shrewd *(adj)* চতুর, বিচক্ষণ — having sharp judgement. SYN astute, sharp, clever, canny, perceptive. ANT foolish, naive, stupid, gullible. *Ex:* He is a shrewd businessman.

Sinister *(adj)* অশুভ, অমঙ্গলজনক — giving the impression that something harmful will happen. SYN menacing, threatening, ominous, evil, malevolent. ANT auspicious, benign, harmless, favourable. *Ex:* There was something sinister about the stranger.

Slander *(n/v)* অপবাদ, কুৎসা — a false spoken statement damaging a person's reputation. SYN defamation, calumny, libel, vilification; defame, malign. ANT praise, commendation; extol, eulogise. *Ex:* He sued the newspaper for slander.

Sluggish *(adj)* মন্থর, ধীর — slow-moving; inactive. SYN slow, lethargic, inactive, lazy, torpid. ANT quick, active, brisk, energetic, lively. *Ex:* Exports were sluggish last quarter.

Solace *(n)* সান্ত্বনা — comfort in distress. SYN comfort, consolation, relief, support, succour. ANT distress, misery, torment, agony. *Ex:* Music was his only solace.

Sombre *(adj)* বিষণ্ণ, গম্ভীর; গাঢ় — dark; serious and sad. SYN dark, dull, drab; gloomy, grave, solemn, melancholy. ANT bright, colourful; cheerful, happy, joyful. *Ex:* The mood at the funeral was sombre.

Soporific GRE *(adj)* ঘুম পাড়ানো — tending to cause sleep. SYN sleep-inducing, sedative, hypnotic; boring, tedious. ANT stimulating, invigorating, exciting. *Ex:* The lecture was soporific.

Spontaneous *(adj)* স্বতঃস্ফূর্ত — done without planning; natural. SYN unplanned, impromptu, natural, voluntary, instinctive. ANT planned, deliberate, forced, contrived. *Ex:* The crowd gave a spontaneous round of applause.

Sporadic ★ *(adj)* বিক্ষিপ্ত, মাঝে মাঝে ঘটে এমন — occurring at irregular intervals. SYN occasional, intermittent, scattered, irregular, infrequent. ANT constant, regular, continuous, frequent, incessant. *Ex:* There were sporadic clashes in the city.

Spurious *(adj)* জাল, নকল — false or fake. SYN fake, false, counterfeit, bogus, forged. ANT genuine, authentic, real, true. *Ex:* Spurious medicines are a threat to public health.

Squander ★ *(v)* অপচয় করা — to waste money or time carelessly. SYN waste, fritter away, misspend, dissipate, lavish. ANT save, conserve, hoard, economise, husband. *Ex:* He squandered his inheritance on gambling.

Stagnant *(adj)* বদ্ধ; স্থবির — not flowing; showing no activity. SYN still, motionless, standing; inactive, static, sluggish. ANT flowing, moving; active, growing, dynamic. *Ex:* Mosquitoes breed in stagnant water.

Steadfast *(adj)* অটল, স্থির — resolutely firm and unwavering. SYN firm, resolute, constant, loyal, unwavering. ANT wavering, fickle, inconstant, disloyal. *Ex:* She remained steadfast in her beliefs.

Stingy *(adj)* কৃপণ — unwilling to spend or give. SYN miserly, mean, tight-fisted, parsimonious, niggardly. ANT generous, liberal, lavish, munificent. *Ex:* The stingy man never gave to charity.

Stoic *(adj)* সহিষ্ণু, নির্বিকার — enduring pain without complaint. SYN patient, uncomplaining, long-suffering, impassive, unflinching. ANT complaining, emotional, excitable, impatient. *Ex:* He remained stoic despite his injuries.

Stringent *(adj)* কঠোর — (of rules) strict and precise. SYN strict, rigorous, rigid, tough, severe. ANT lax, lenient, flexible, loose. *Ex:* Stringent laws are needed to stop food adulteration.

Subjugate *(v)* পরাধীন করা — to bring under control by force. SYN conquer, subdue, vanquish, enslave, oppress. ANT liberate, free, emancipate, release. *Ex:* The British subjugated the Indian subcontinent.

Substantial *(adj)* যথেষ্ট, উল্লেখযোগ্য — of considerable importance, size or worth. SYN considerable, significant, large, sizeable, ample. ANT insignificant, small, negligible, trivial. *Ex:* There has been a substantial increase in exports.

Succinct *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত ও সুস্পষ্ট — briefly and clearly expressed. SYN concise, brief, terse, compact, pithy. ANT verbose, wordy, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* Give a succinct answer.

Superficial ★ *(adj)* অগভীর, ভাসাভাসা — existing only on the surface; shallow. SYN shallow, surface, cursory, perfunctory, slight. ANT deep, profound, thorough, in-depth, comprehensive. *Ex:* He has only a superficial knowledge of history.

Superfluous ★ *(adj)* অপ্রয়োজনীয়, বাড়তি — unnecessary, more than enough. SYN unnecessary, redundant, surplus, excess, needless. ANT necessary, essential, required, needed, vital. *Ex:* Cut out superfluous words from your writing.

Surreptitious GRE *(adj)* গোপন, চুপিসারে — kept secret because it would not be approved. SYN secret, clandestine, covert, furtive, stealthy. ANT open, overt, public, blatant. *Ex:* He took a surreptitious look at his phone in class.

Sycophant GRE *(n)* চাটুকার, তোষামোদকারী — a person who flatters powerful people for gain. SYN flatterer, toady, bootlicker, yes-man, lackey. ANT critic, detractor, rebel, independent. *Ex:* The king was surrounded by sycophants.

T

Taciturn ★ GRE *(adj)* স্বল্পভাষী — saying very little. SYN reserved, silent, reticent, uncommunicative, laconic. ANT talkative, garrulous, loquacious, voluble, chatty. *Ex:* The taciturn farmer nodded but said nothing.

Tactful *(adj)* কৌশলী, বিচক্ষণ — careful not to offend people. SYN diplomatic, discreet, sensitive, considerate, politic. ANT tactless, indiscreet, blunt, insensitive. *Ex:* She gave a tactful reply to an awkward question.

Tangible *(adj)* স্পর্শযোগ্য, বাস্তব — able to be touched; real and clear. SYN touchable, palpable, concrete, real, material. ANT intangible, abstract, imaginary, vague. *Ex:* We need tangible results, not promises.

Tardy *(adj)* দেরি করা, বিলম্বিত — slow; late. SYN late, slow, delayed, belated, dilatory. ANT punctual, prompt, early, quick. *Ex:* He was punished for his tardy arrival.

Tedious ★ *(adj)* ক্লান্তিকর, একঘেয়ে — too long, slow or dull. SYN boring, monotonous, tiresome, dull, wearisome. ANT interesting, exciting, stimulating, lively. *Ex:* Copying the register was a tedious job.

Temerity GRE *(n)* দুঃসাহস, ধৃষ্টতা — excessive boldness; audacity. SYN audacity, nerve, boldness, effrontery, impudence. ANT timidity, caution, shyness, prudence. *Ex:* He had the temerity to question the judge's honesty.

Temperate *(adj)* মৃদু, নাতিশীতোষ্ণ; সংযমী — mild; moderate; self-controlled. SYN mild, moderate, clement; self-restrained, sober. ANT extreme, harsh; intemperate, excessive. *Ex:* Bangladesh has a temperate winter.

Tenacious ★ *(adj)* দৃঢ়প্রতিজ্ঞ, নাছোড়বান্দা — holding firmly; persistent. SYN persistent, determined, resolute, dogged, steadfast. ANT irresolute, weak, yielding, wavering. *Ex:* Her tenacious efforts finally paid off.

Tentative *(adj)* অস্থায়ী, পরীক্ষামূলক — not certain or fixed; hesitant. SYN provisional, experimental, uncertain; hesitant, cautious. ANT definite, final, certain; confident, decisive. *Ex:* Here is the tentative schedule of the exam.

Terse *(adj)* সংক্ষিপ্ত, রূঢ় — brief and abrupt. SYN curt, brusque, concise, laconic, short. ANT wordy, verbose, long-winded, rambling. *Ex:* He sent a terse email refusing the offer.

Thrifty *(adj)* মিতব্যয়ী — careful with money. SYN frugal, economical, careful, prudent, provident. ANT extravagant, wasteful, spendthrift, prodigal. *Ex:* Thrifty housewives save for the future.

Timid ★ *(adj)* ভীরু, লাজুক — lacking courage or confidence. SYN shy, fearful, timorous, diffident, nervous. ANT bold, brave, confident, daring, audacious. *Ex:* The timid child hid behind his mother.

Torpid GRE *(adj)* নিস্তেজ, জড় — mentally or physically inactive. SYN lethargic, sluggish, inactive, inert, listless. ANT active, energetic, lively, vigorous. *Ex:* The heat made the animals torpid.

Tranquil ★ *(adj)* শান্ত, নিরুদ্বেগ — free from disturbance; calm. SYN calm, peaceful, serene, placid, quiet. ANT turbulent, agitated, noisy, chaotic, disturbed. *Ex:* We spent a tranquil weekend in Sreemangal.

Transient ★ *(adj)* ক্ষণস্থায়ী — lasting only for a short time. SYN temporary, fleeting, ephemeral, short-lived, transitory, momentary. ANT permanent, lasting, enduring, perpetual, everlasting. *Ex:* Youth and beauty are transient.

Trepidation *(n)* উদ্বেগ, ভয় — a feeling of fear about something that may happen. SYN fear, anxiety, apprehension, dread, alarm. ANT calm, confidence, composure, courage. *Ex:* She entered the exam hall with trepidation.

Trite *(adj)* বহুল ব্যবহৃত, মামুলি — overused and lacking originality. SYN banal, hackneyed, clichéd, stale, commonplace. ANT original, fresh, novel, imaginative. *Ex:* The story ended with a trite moral.

Trivial *(adj)* তুচ্ছ, নগণ্য — of little value or importance. SYN unimportant, insignificant, petty, trifling, negligible. ANT important, significant, serious, crucial. *Ex:* They quarrelled over a trivial matter.

Truculent GRE *(adj)* আগ্রাসী, যুদ্ধংদেহী — eager to argue or fight. SYN aggressive, belligerent, hostile, defiant, combative. ANT gentle, cooperative, amiable, docile. *Ex:* The truculent prisoner attacked a guard.

Turbulent *(adj)* অশান্ত, বিক্ষুব্ধ — characterised by conflict, disorder or confusion. SYN stormy, rough, violent; chaotic, unstable, tumultuous. ANT calm, peaceful, tranquil, stable. *Ex:* The 1960s were turbulent years in East Pakistan.

U

Ubiquitous ★ GRE *(adj)* সর্বব্যাপী, সর্বত্র বিরাজমান — present everywhere. SYN omnipresent, pervasive, universal, everywhere, widespread. ANT rare, scarce, uncommon, absent. *Ex:* Mobile phones are ubiquitous today.

Unanimous *(adj)* সর্বসম্মত — fully in agreement. SYN united, agreed, concordant, of one mind, uncontested. ANT divided, split, disputed, contested. *Ex:* The decision was unanimous.

Unkempt *(adj)* অপরিচ্ছন্ন, এলোমেলো — (of appearance) untidy. SYN untidy, messy, dishevelled, scruffy, slovenly. ANT neat, tidy, groomed, smart, trim. *Ex:* He came to the interview with unkempt hair.

Unscrupulous *(adj)* নীতিহীন — having no moral principles. SYN unprincipled, dishonest, corrupt, immoral, shameless. ANT scrupulous, honest, principled, ethical. *Ex:* Unscrupulous traders hoard goods before Ramadan.

Upbraid *(v)* তিরস্কার করা — to scold. SYN scold, reproach, rebuke, berate, reprimand. ANT praise, commend, compliment. *Ex:* She upbraided her son for coming home late.

Urbane *(adj)* মার্জিত, ভদ্র — (of a man) courteous and refined. SYN suave, sophisticated, polished, refined, cultivated. ANT boorish, crude, uncouth, rude. *Ex:* The urbane diplomat charmed the guests.

Usurp *(v)* জোর করে দখল করা — to take a position of power illegally or by force. SYN seize, take over, commandeer, appropriate, grab. ANT restore, return, give up, abdicate. *Ex:* The general usurped power in a coup.

Utopian *(adj)* কাল্পনিক আদর্শ — idealistic, perfect but impractical. SYN idealistic, visionary, perfect, fanciful, quixotic. ANT realistic, practical, pragmatic, dystopian. *Ex:* A society without crime is a utopian dream.

V

Vacillate ★ GRE *(v)* দোদুল্যমান থাকা — to waver between opinions. SYN waver, hesitate, dither, fluctuate, oscillate. ANT decide, resolve, persist, stand firm. *Ex:* He vacillated between law and medicine.

Vague *(adj)* অস্পষ্ট — not clear or definite. SYN unclear, indistinct, hazy, ambiguous, obscure. ANT clear, definite, precise, explicit, distinct. *Ex:* He gave a vague answer.

Valiant *(adj)* সাহসী, বীর — showing courage. SYN brave, courageous, heroic, gallant, valorous. ANT cowardly, timid, fearful, craven. *Ex:* The valiant soldier saved his comrades.

Vanity *(n)* অহংকার; অসারতা — excessive pride; futility. SYN conceit, pride, arrogance, egotism; futility, emptiness. ANT modesty, humility; worth, usefulness. *Ex:* Her vanity made her spend hours before the mirror.

Vehement *(adj)* তীব্র, প্রবল — showing strong feeling. SYN forceful, passionate, intense, fervent, ardent. ANT mild, calm, half-hearted, feeble, subdued. *Ex:* The proposal met with vehement opposition.

Venal GRE *(adj)* ঘুষখোর, অর্থলোভী — open to bribery. SYN corrupt, bribable, mercenary, dishonest, crooked. ANT honest, incorruptible, upright, principled. *Ex:* Venal officials sold licences for money. (Do not confuse with *venial* = forgivable.)

Venerate *(v)* শ্রদ্ধা করা — to regard with great respect. SYN revere, respect, honour, worship, esteem. ANT despise, scorn, disrespect, dishonour. *Ex:* We venerate the martyrs of 1952.

Verbose ★ *(adj)* শব্দবহুল — using more words than needed. SYN wordy, long-winded, prolix, garrulous, loquacious. ANT concise, brief, succinct, laconic, terse. *Ex:* The report was verbose and repetitive.

Versatile *(adj)* বহুমুখী প্রতিভাসম্পন্ন — able to adapt to many activities. SYN adaptable, all-round, flexible, multitalented, resourceful. ANT limited, inflexible, specialised, one-dimensional. *Ex:* Nazrul was a versatile genius.

Vex *(v)* বিরক্ত করা — to annoy or worry. SYN annoy, irritate, anger, trouble, exasperate. ANT please, soothe, calm, delight. *Ex:* It vexes me to see people littering.

Viable *(adj)* কার্যকর, টেকসই — capable of working successfully. SYN feasible, workable, practicable, sustainable, possible. ANT unworkable, impractical, unfeasible, impossible. *Ex:* Solar power is a viable alternative energy.

Vigilant ★ *(adj)* সতর্ক, সজাগ — watchful for possible danger. SYN watchful, alert, wary, attentive, observant. ANT careless, negligent, inattentive, heedless. *Ex:* Citizens must be vigilant against terrorism.

Vigorous *(adj)* তেজস্বী, জোরালো — strong, healthy and full of energy. SYN energetic, robust, strong, lively, dynamic. ANT weak, feeble, lethargic, frail, languid. *Ex:* Take vigorous exercise every day.

Vilify *(v)* কুৎসা রটানো — to speak or write about in an abusive way. SYN defame, malign, slander, denigrate, disparage. ANT praise, extol, laud, glorify. *Ex:* He was vilified by the press.

Vindicate *(v)* নির্দোষ প্রমাণ করা; সঠিক প্রমাণ করা — to clear of blame; to show to be right. SYN exonerate, acquit, clear; justify, support, confirm. ANT accuse, convict, blame; disprove, refute. *Ex:* The new evidence vindicated him.

Virtuous *(adj)* গুণী, সৎ — having high moral standards. SYN good, moral, righteous, upright, honourable. ANT wicked, immoral, corrupt, vicious, sinful. *Ex:* He was a virtuous ruler.

Vivacious *(adj)* প্রাণবন্ত — attractively lively and animated. SYN lively, animated, spirited, bubbly, sparkling. ANT dull, lifeless, listless, languid, boring. *Ex:* She is a vivacious young woman.

Vociferous *(adj)* উচ্চকণ্ঠ, সোচ্চার — expressing opinions loudly and forcefully. SYN loud, vocal, clamorous, outspoken, strident. ANT quiet, silent, reticent, soft-spoken. *Ex:* There were vociferous protests against price hikes.

Volatile *(adj)* উদ্বায়ী; অস্থির — evaporating easily; likely to change suddenly. SYN unstable, explosive, unpredictable, erratic, mercurial. ANT stable, calm, constant, steady. *Ex:* The political situation is volatile.

Voluntary *(adj)* স্বেচ্ছামূলক — done of one's own free will. SYN optional, willing, discretionary, unforced, spontaneous. ANT compulsory, mandatory, obligatory, forced. *Ex:* Blood donation is a voluntary service.

Voracious *(adj)* অতি ক্ষুধার্ত, পেটুক; অতি আগ্রহী — wanting great quantities of food; very eager. SYN ravenous, greedy, insatiable, gluttonous; avid, enthusiastic. ANT sated, satisfied; indifferent, apathetic. *Ex:* He is a voracious reader.

Vulnerable *(adj)* ঝুঁকিপূর্ণ, অরক্ষিত — exposed to harm or attack. SYN exposed, defenceless, susceptible, unprotected, weak. ANT invulnerable, protected, safe, secure, resilient. *Ex:* Bangladesh is vulnerable to climate change.

W

Wane *(v)* ক্ষয় পাওয়া, হ্রাস পাওয়া — to decrease in size, power or extent. SYN decrease, decline, diminish, ebb, fade. ANT wax, grow, increase, strengthen. *Ex:* His influence began to wane.

Wanton *(adj)* অকারণ, উচ্ছৃঙ্খল — deliberate and unprovoked (of a cruel act); immoral. SYN wilful, gratuitous, malicious, senseless; dissolute. ANT justified, provoked; moral, chaste. *Ex:* The wanton destruction of trees must stop.

Wary *(adj)* সতর্ক, সাবধানী — cautious about possible dangers. (Do not confuse with *weary* = tired.) SYN cautious, careful, alert, vigilant, suspicious. ANT careless, unwary, trusting, reckless. *Ex:* Be wary of strangers offering free gifts.

Wax *(v)* বৃদ্ধি পাওয়া (বিশেষত চাঁদ) — to grow larger or stronger. *Wax* and *wane* are a classic antonym pair. SYN increase, grow, expand, swell, enlarge. ANT wane, decrease, diminish, shrink. *Ex:* The moon waxes and wanes every month.

Weary *(adj)* ক্লান্ত — very tired. SYN tired, exhausted, fatigued, worn out, jaded. ANT fresh, energetic, refreshed, lively. *Ex:* The weary traveller rested under a banyan tree.

Whimsical *(adj)* খামখেয়ালি — playfully unusual; acting on sudden ideas. SYN fanciful, capricious, playful, quirky, fickle. ANT serious, sober, steady, predictable. *Ex:* The story has a whimsical charm.

Wholesome *(adj)* স্বাস্থ্যকর; নৈতিকভাবে ভালো — good for health or morals. SYN healthy, nutritious, beneficial; moral, decent, clean. ANT unhealthy, unwholesome, harmful; immoral, corrupt. *Ex:* Children need wholesome food and entertainment.

Wicked *(adj)* দুষ্ট, পাপী — evil or morally wrong. SYN evil, sinful, vicious, villainous, nefarious. ANT good, virtuous, righteous, moral, kind. *Ex:* The wicked stepmother mistreated Cinderella.

Wily *(adj)* ধূর্ত — skilled at gaining an advantage by deceit. SYN cunning, crafty, sly, shrewd, artful. ANT naive, ingenuous, honest, simple. *Ex:* The wily fox tricked the crow.

Witty *(adj)* রসিক, বুদ্ধিদীপ্ত — showing quick and clever humour. SYN humorous, clever, amusing, droll, funny. ANT dull, boring, humourless, stupid. *Ex:* Syed Mujtaba Ali was a witty writer.

X · Y · Z

Xenophobia *(n)* বিদেশিভীতি — dislike or fear of people from other countries. SYN racism, chauvinism, intolerance, nativism. ANT xenophilia, tolerance, hospitality, cosmopolitanism. *Ex:* Xenophobia is rising in some parts of Europe.

Yearn *(v)* আকুলভাবে কামনা করা — to have an intense longing for. SYN long, crave, pine, hanker, desire. ANT dislike, spurn, be indifferent to. *Ex:* Migrant workers yearn for home during Eid.

Yield *(v/n)* ফলন দেওয়া; নতি স্বীকার করা — to produce; to give way; the amount produced. SYN produce, generate; surrender, submit, give in; harvest, output. ANT withhold; resist, defy, withstand. *Ex:* The new rice variety yields more crops. / He refused to yield to pressure.

Zany *(adj)* হাস্যকর রকমের অদ্ভুত — amusingly unconventional. SYN eccentric, comical, wacky, crazy, madcap. ANT serious, sober, conventional, sensible. *Ex:* He is known for his zany sense of humour.

Zeal ★ *(n)* উদ্যম, উৎসাহ — great energy or enthusiasm for a cause. SYN enthusiasm, passion, fervour, ardour, eagerness. ANT apathy, indifference, lethargy, half-heartedness. *Ex:* She worked with great zeal for the poor.

Zealous *(adj)* উদ্যমী, উৎসাহী — having great zeal. SYN fervent, ardent, passionate, enthusiastic, eager. ANT apathetic, indifferent, lukewarm, unenthusiastic. *Ex:* He is a zealous supporter of environmental causes.

Zenith ★ *(n)* সর্বোচ্চ বিন্দু, শীর্ষ — the highest point. SYN peak, summit, acme, pinnacle, apex, climax. ANT nadir, bottom, base, lowest point. *Ex:* The Mughal Empire reached its zenith under Akbar.